

The State of India 2026

The full-year synthesis across every indicator India Insight Lab tracks — population to prices, health to housing.

16 CHAPTERS	88 INDICATORS	27 WITH STATE DATA	1951–2036 PERIOD COVERED
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Generated 21 Aug 2026 · assembled from 75 sources

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report assembles 88 indicators across 16 chapters, drawn from 75 sources and covering 1951–2036.

Of those indicators, 27 carry state-level detail and can be mapped across India's states. The remaining 61 are published at national level only by their source, and are shown here as national series without a sub-national breakdown.

Coverage limits. This report contains no district- or city-level figures. Comparable district data is not currently integrated into India Insight Lab, and no value here has been estimated, interpolated or carried down from a higher geography to fill that gap. Where a number is absent, it is absent.

KEY FINDINGS

Each finding below is computed directly from the state values in this report — the highest and lowest recorded state for that indicator. None are authored interpretations.

1 Literacy rate by state

Ranges from 94.0% in Kerala to 61.8% in Bihar — a spread of 32.2% across the 26 states reported.

Census of India 2011

2 **Multidimensional poverty by state**

Ranges from 33.76% in Bihar to 0.55% in Kerala — a spread of 33.21% across the 25 states reported.

NITI Aayog National MPI — A Progress Review 2023

3 **Forest cover by state**

Ranges from 85.4% in Mizoram to 3.6% in Haryana — a spread of 81.8% across the 8 states reported.

India State of Forest Report, Forest Survey of India

4 **State-wise merchandise exports**

Ranges from 90\$bn in Maharashtra to 22\$bn in Uttar Pradesh — a spread of 68\$bn across the 6 states reported.

Trade Intelligence and Analytics portal, Department of Commerce

5 **SDG India Index by state**

Ranges from 79 in Kerala to 57 in Bihar — a spread of 22 across the 18 states reported.

NITI Aayog SDG India Index 2023–24

6 **Crimes against women by state**

Ranges from 112.9 per lakh in Odisha to 45.1 per lakh in Uttar Pradesh — a spread of 67.8 per lakh across the 7 states reported.

NCRB, Crime in India 2020

7 **Slum population share by state**

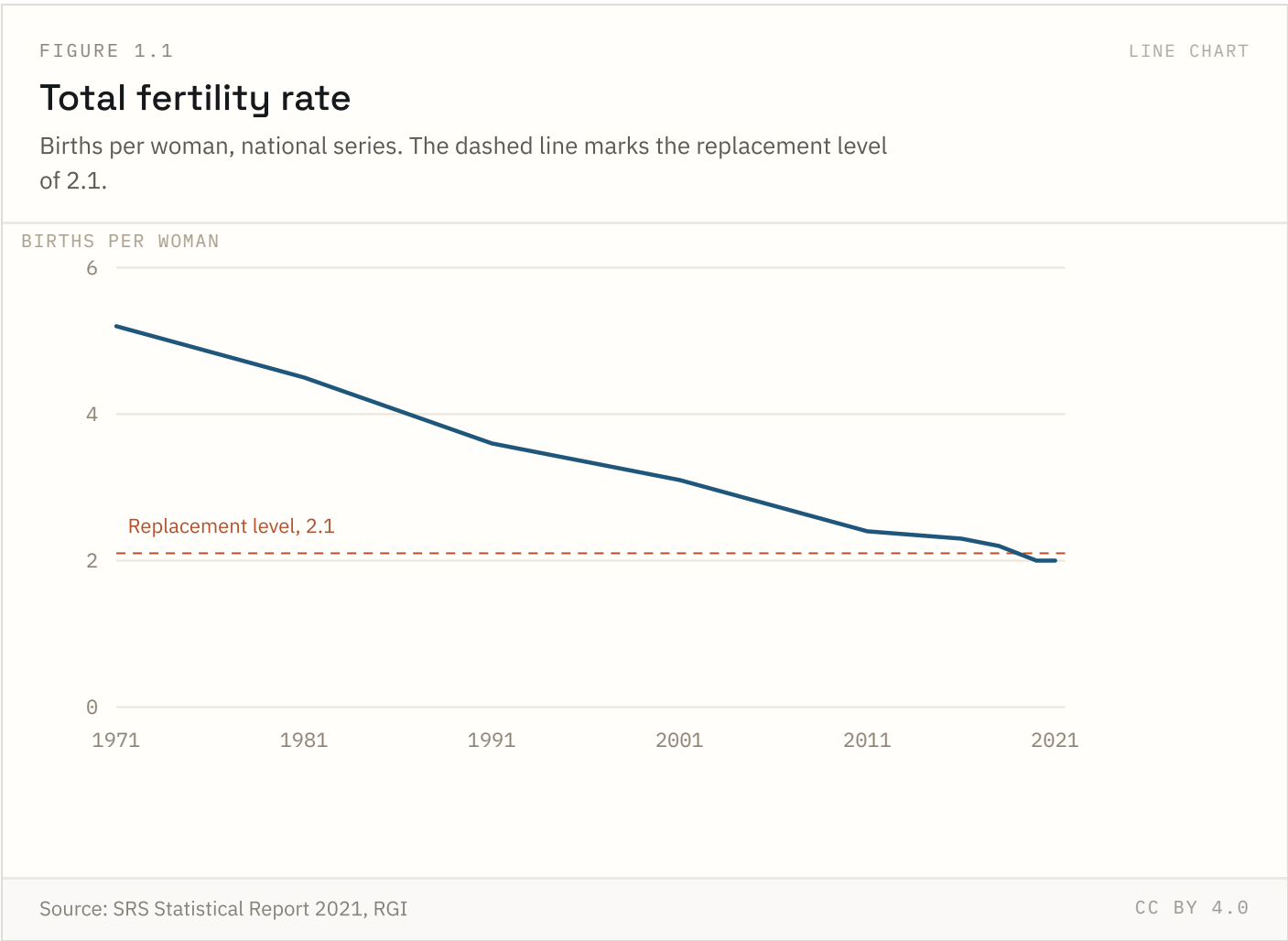
Ranges from 24.0% in Andhra Pradesh to 4.9% in Kerala — a spread of 19.1% across the 15 states reported.

Census of India 2011, Primary Census Abstract for Slum

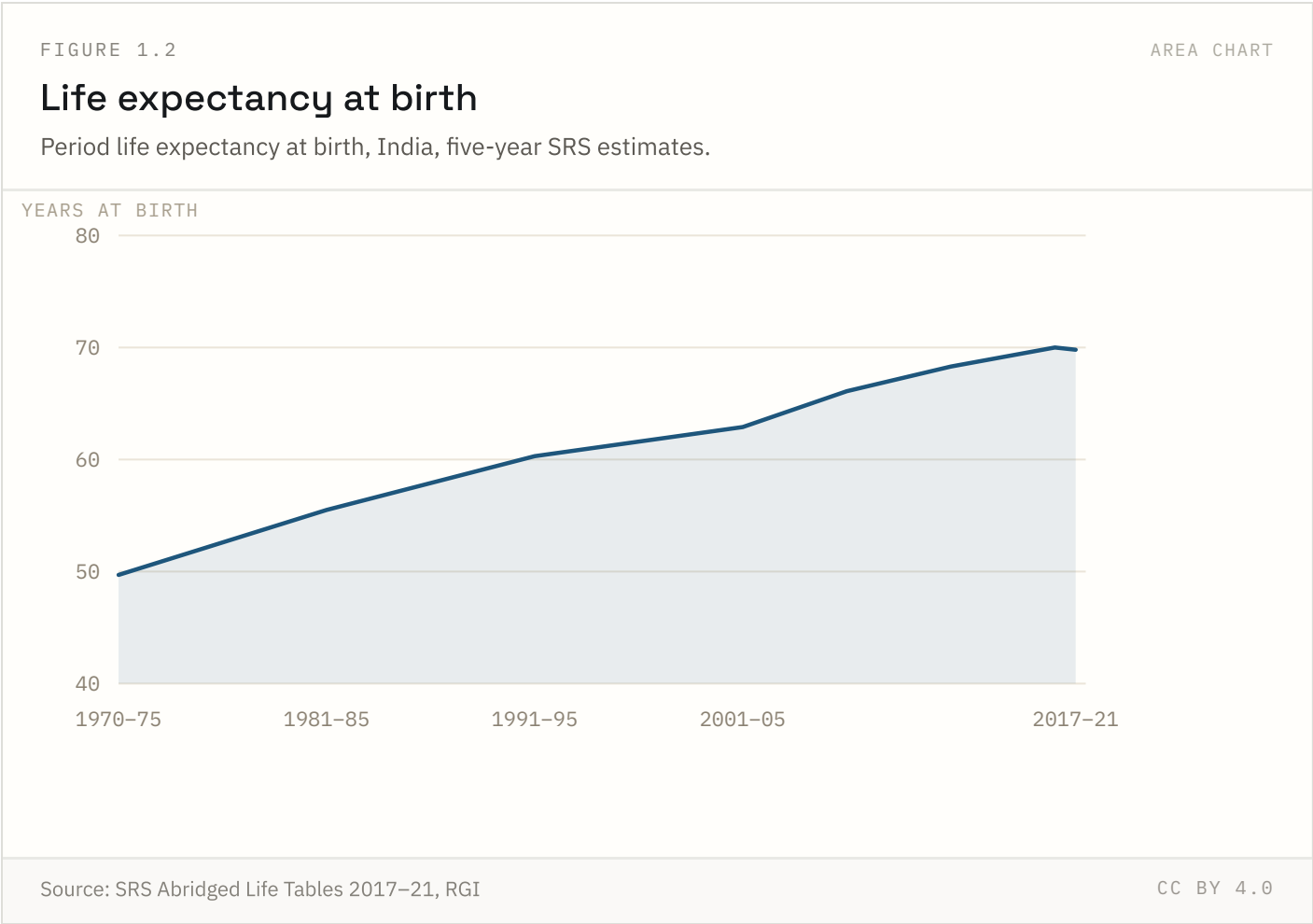
Population & demography

4 of 10 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 1.1 NATIONAL + STATE



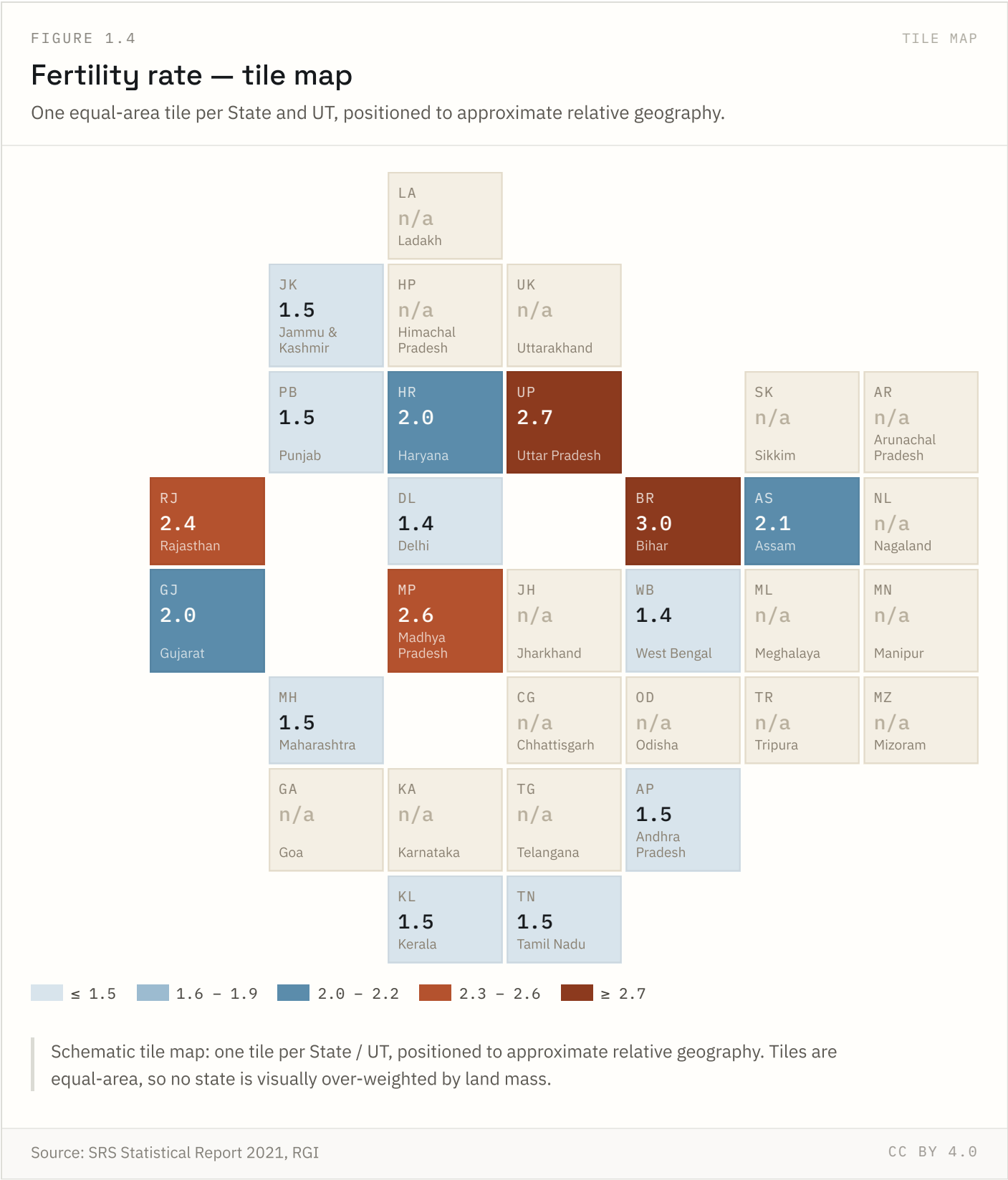
The total fertility rate is the number of children a woman would bear if she experienced current age-specific fertility rates throughout her reproductive life. We splice decennial Census-based estimates to 1991 with the annual Sample Registration System thereafter; NFHS rounds are shown where they differ by more than 0.1.



Period life expectancy at birth assumes a newborn experiences current mortality rates at every age for life. It is not a forecast of any individual cohort. The 2021 fall is real and reflects pandemic excess mortality; estimates of its size still vary across sources by several years.

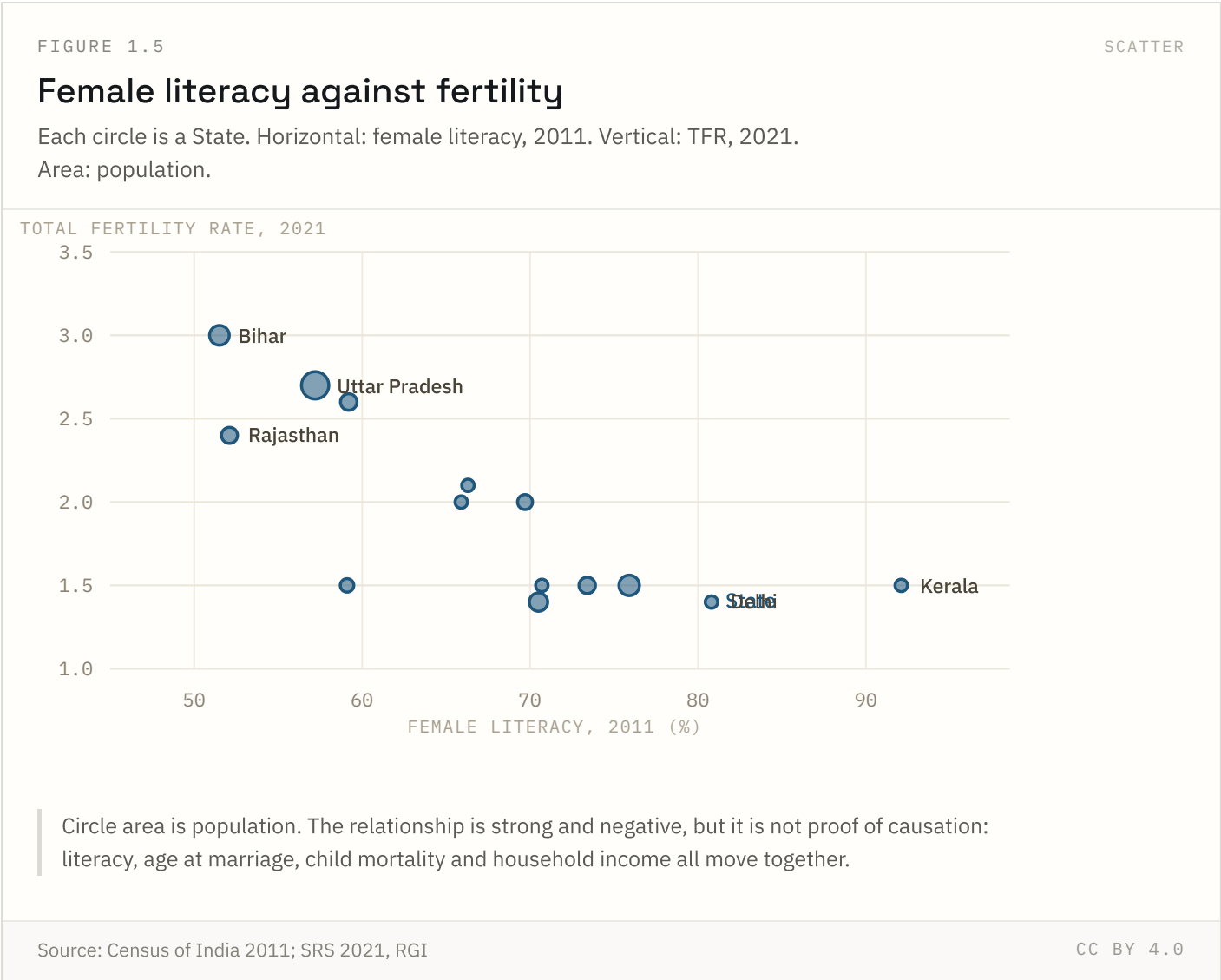


City-proper population excludes adjoining outgrowths and satellite towns, so it understates real metropolitan size — Delhi's urban agglomeration (16.3 million) is roughly 48% larger than its city-proper figure. We use city-proper because it is the more consistently defined boundary across cities.

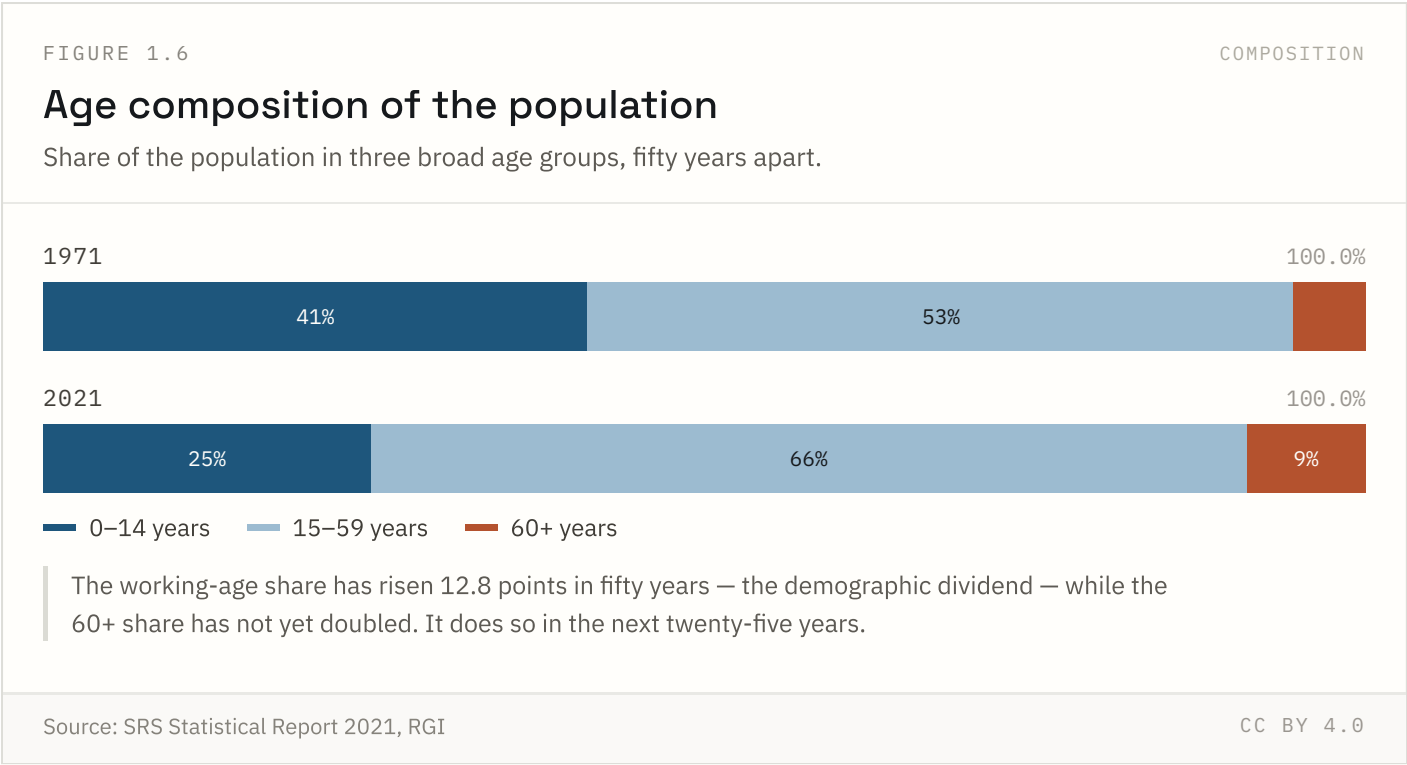


A tile map removes the visual bias of land area: Rajasthan does not shout louder than Kerala. Tiles marked n/a are States and UTs for which the SRS 2021 report does not publish a separate TFR estimate.

FIGURE 1.5 NATIONAL + STATE

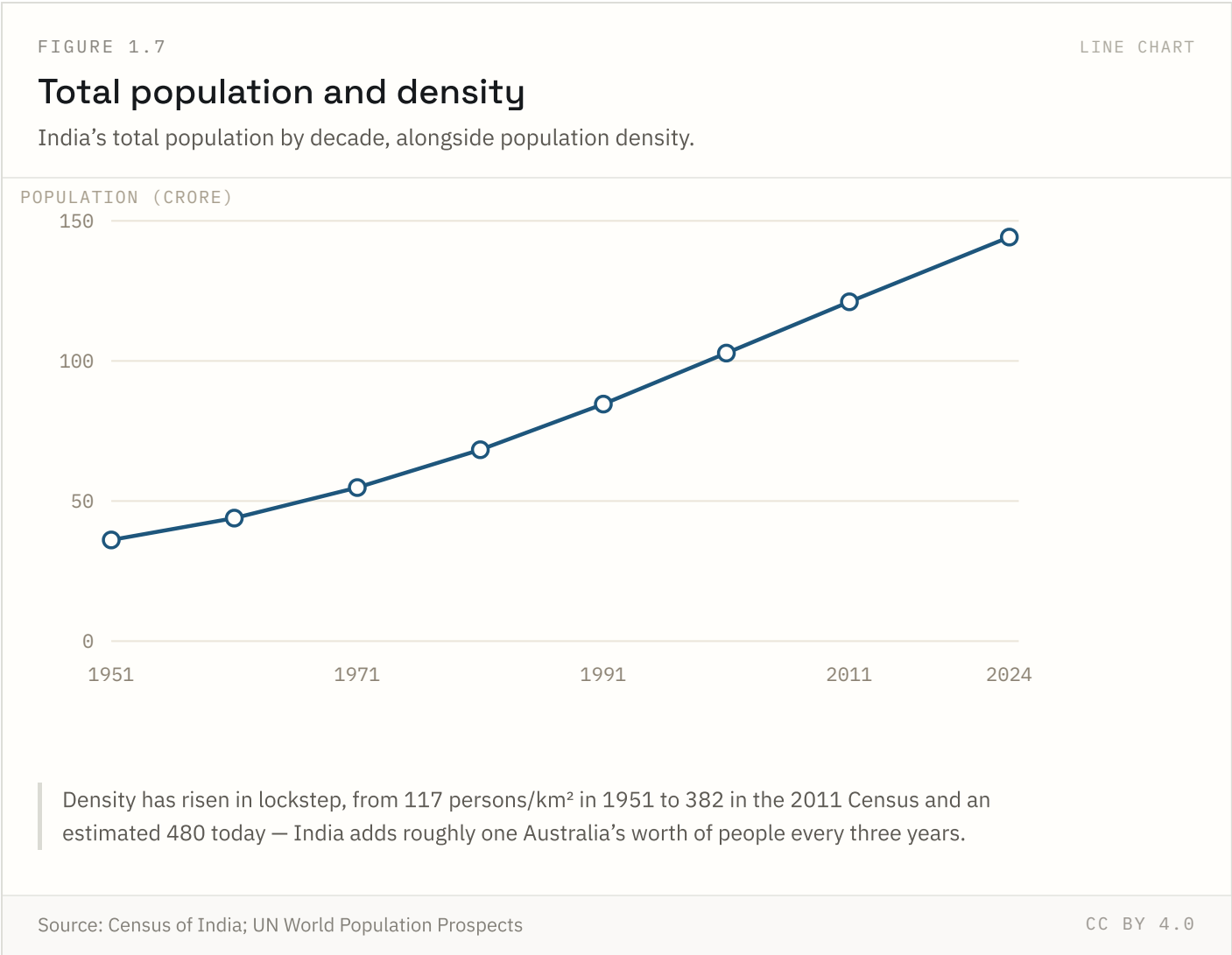


The negative relationship is strong across States, but it is not evidence of causation on its own — literacy, age at marriage, child mortality and household income all move together. Read it as a description of the fertility map, not a mechanism.



The 0–14 share fell from 41.2% to 24.8% between 1971 and 2021 while the working-age share rose to 66.2%. That gap is the demographic dividend; it closes as the 60+ share, now 9.0%, roughly doubles by 2050.

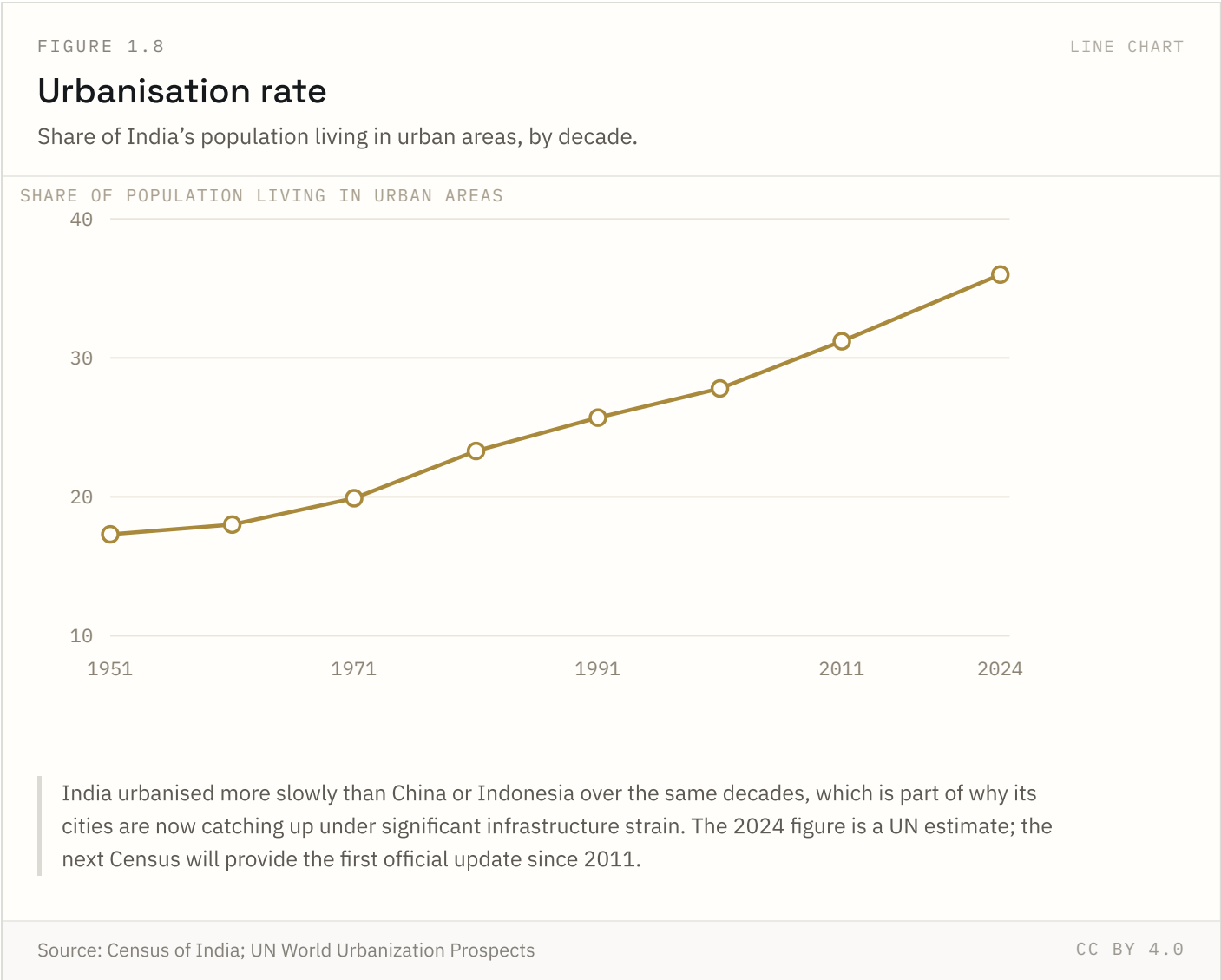
FIGURE 1.7 NATIONAL ONLY



India crossed 1 billion people around 2000 and an estimated 1.44 billion by 2024, having overtaken China as the world's most populous country in 2023. Density figures assume a fixed land area, so they track population growth almost exactly.

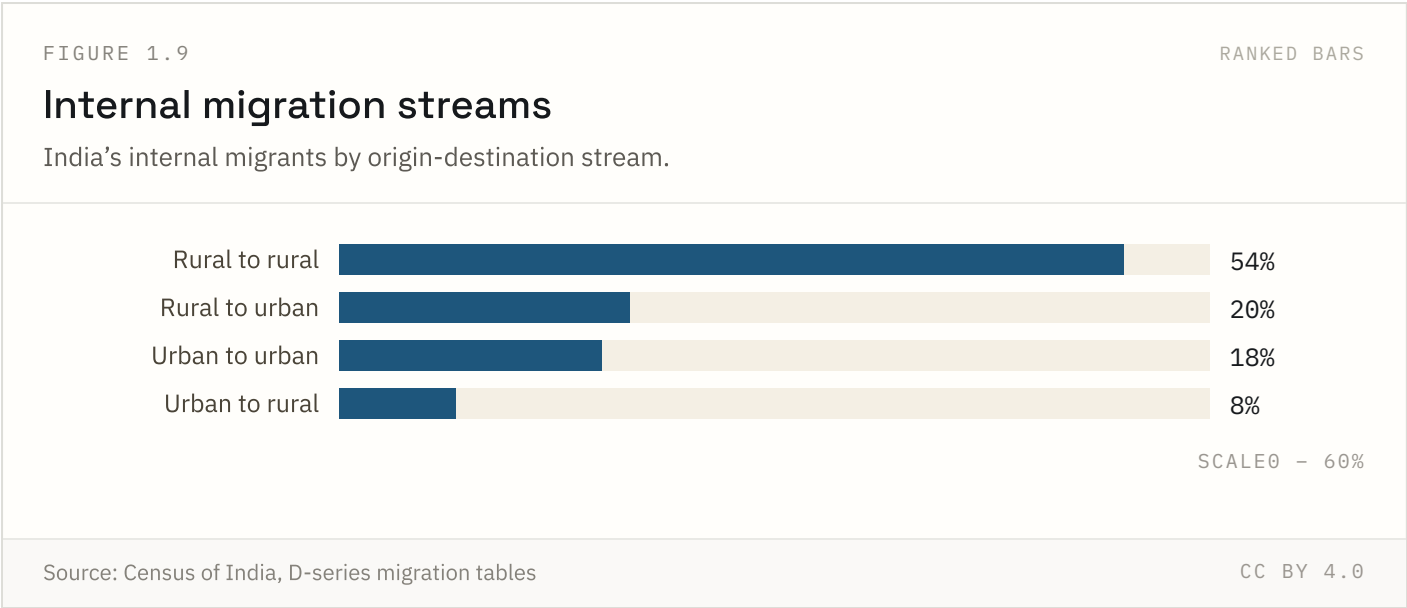
Source: Census of India; UN World Population Prospects Coverage: 1951–2024 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 1.8 NATIONAL ONLY



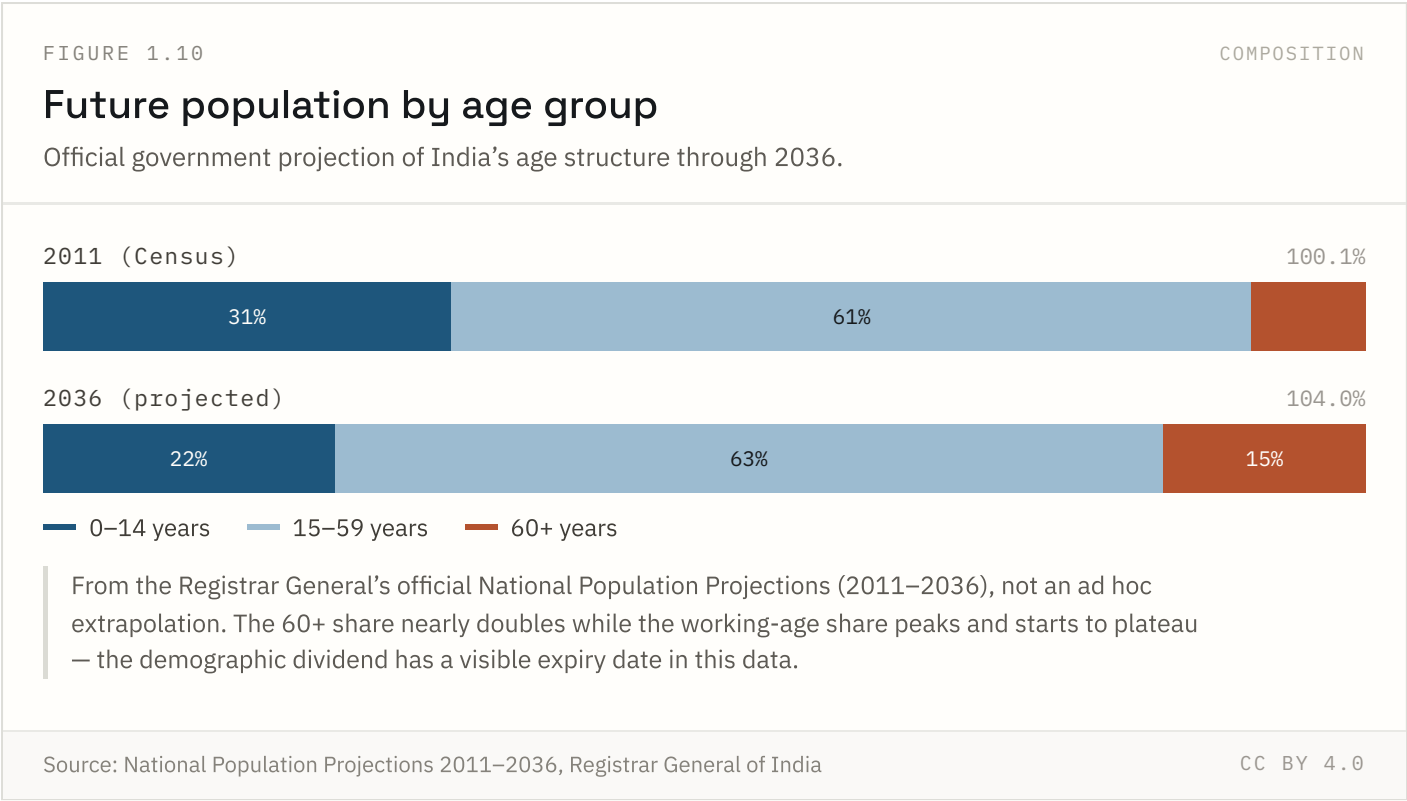
India’s urbanisation has been notably gradual compared to East Asian peers — a mixed blessing that avoided some of the informal-settlement crises seen elsewhere, but also means the next wave of urban growth, now underway, is arriving on infrastructure built for a smaller urban population.

FIGURE 1.9 NATIONAL ONLY



Rural-to-rural migration, mostly marriage-related moves by women, is the largest stream by volume — rural-to-urban labour migration, the stream most associated with India's growth story, is actually the second largest, not the biggest.

Source: Census of India, D-series migration tables Coverage: 2011 Updated: 18 Aug 2026



This is RGI's own published projection, not an extrapolation built for this site. It shows the demographic dividend has a visible expiry date: the working-age share is projected to plateau around the mid-2030s as the 60+ share nearly doubles from its 2011 level.

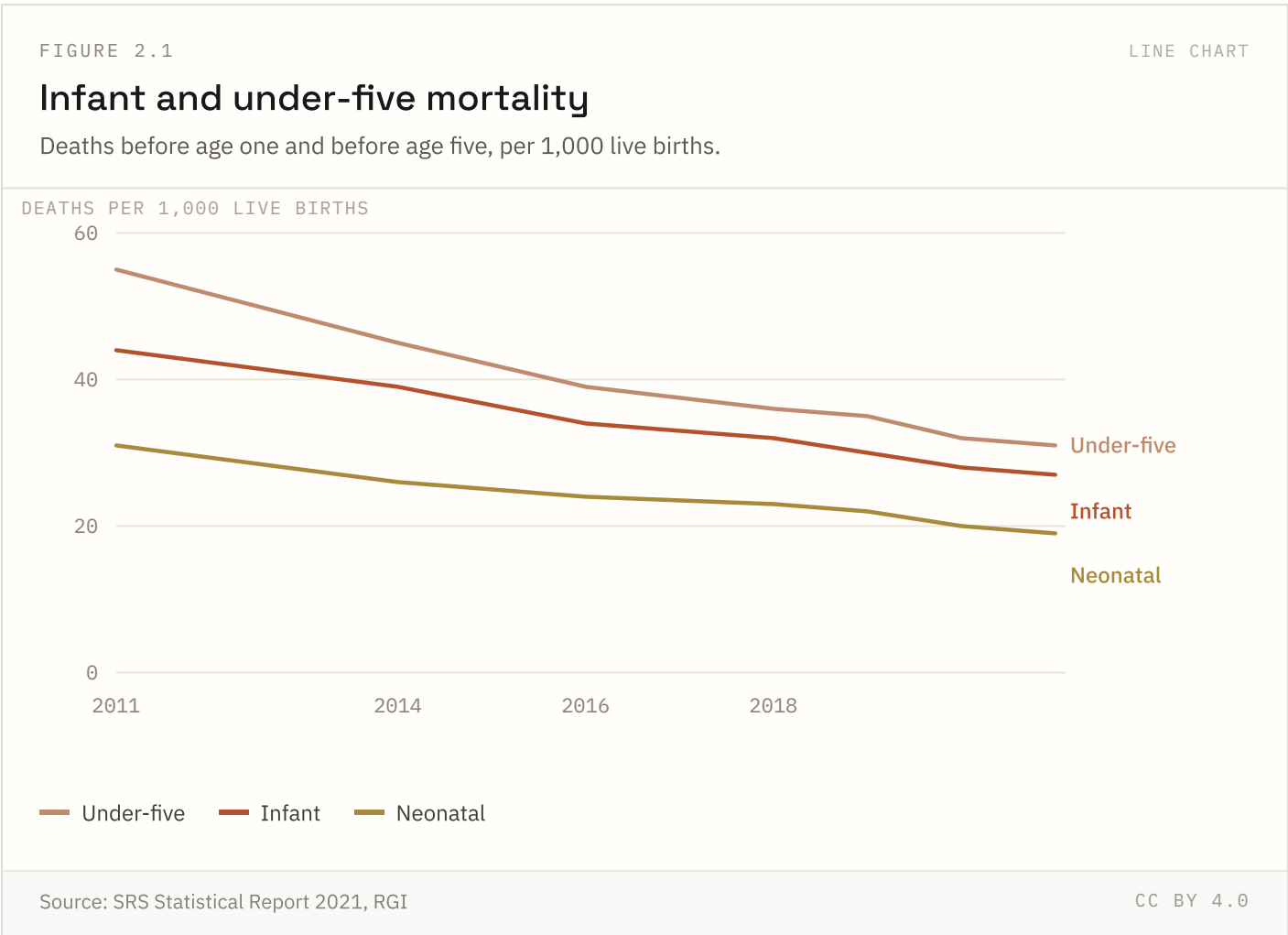
Source: National Population Projections 2011–2036, Registrar General of India

Coverage: 2011 to 2036 (projected) Updated: 18 Aug 2026

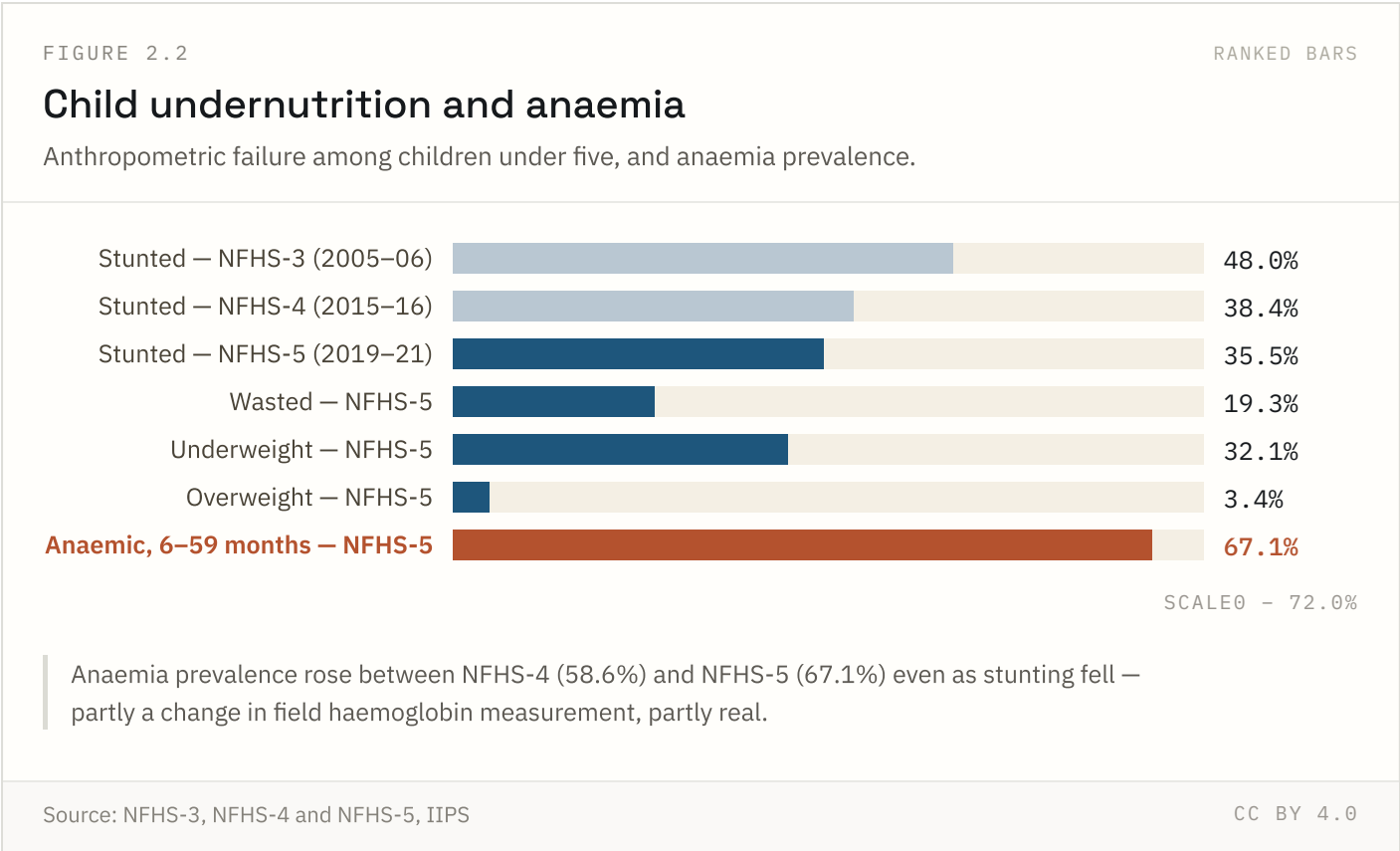
Health & nutrition

3 of 4 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 2.1 NATIONAL + STATE

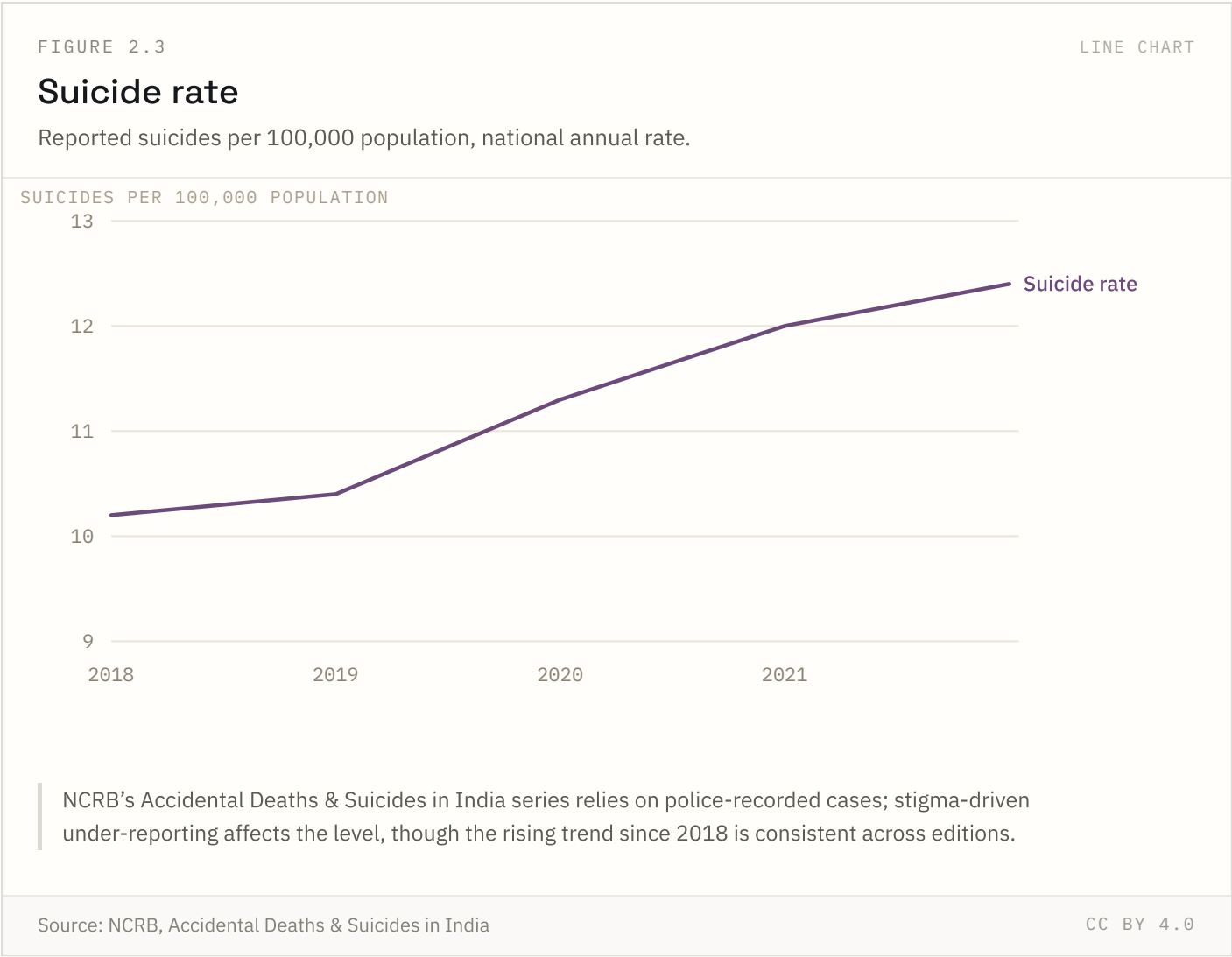


India accounted for roughly a fifth of global under-five deaths in 2022, down from a third in 1990. The decline is steepest in states that expanded institutional delivery fastest after 2005.



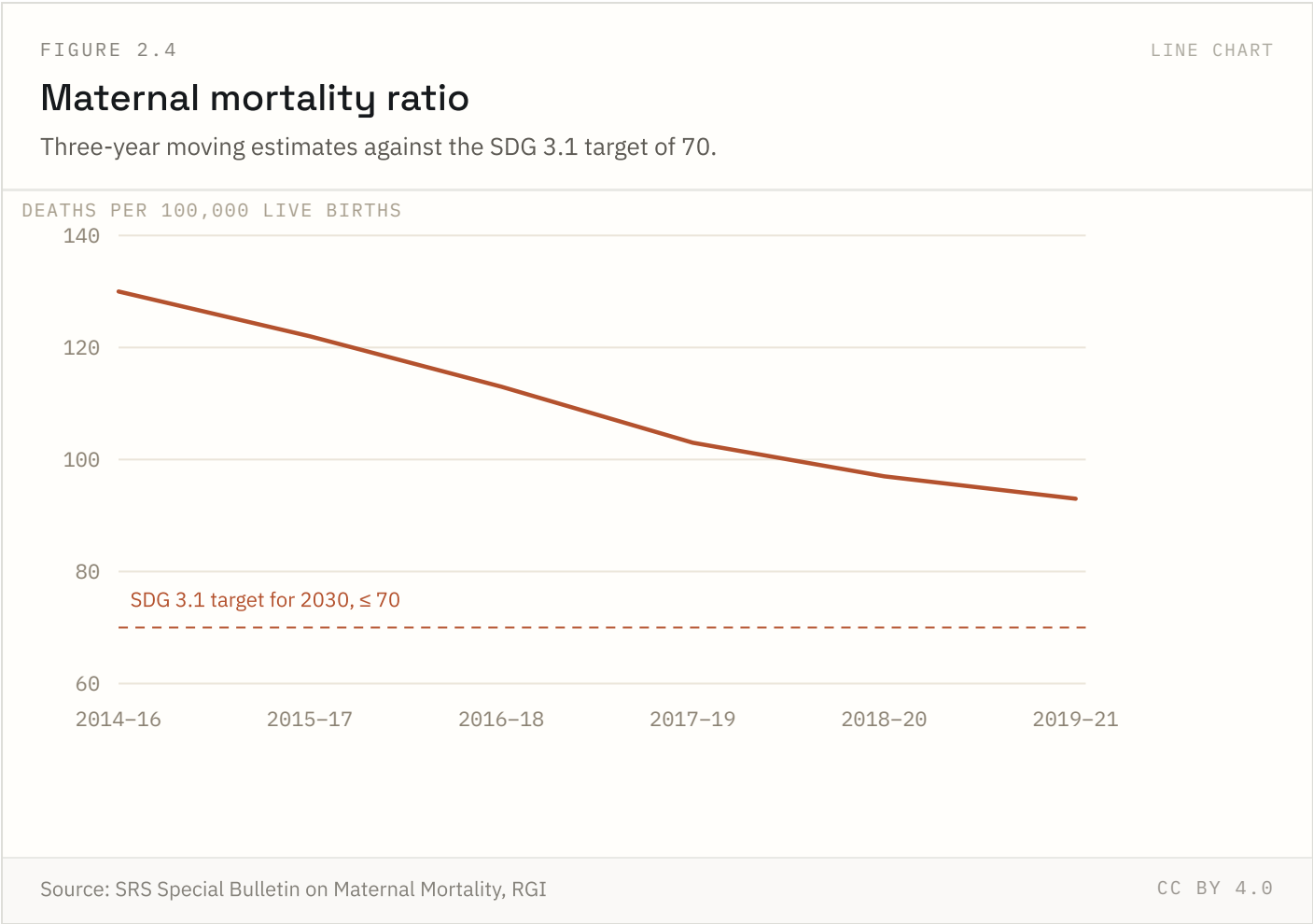
Stunting (low height-for-age) reflects chronic undernutrition; wasting (low weight-for-height) reflects acute deficits. Anaemia prevalence rose between NFHS-4 and NFHS-5 even as stunting fell — partly a measurement change, partly real.

FIGURE 2.3 NATIONAL ONLY



The rate has risen every year since 2018. NCRB figures are police-recorded cases; stigma and, until 2017, the criminal status of attempted suicide are known sources of under-reporting, so levels are likely understated even where the trend is real.

Source: NCRB, Accidental Deaths & Suicides in India Coverage: 2018–2022 Updated: 18 Aug 2026



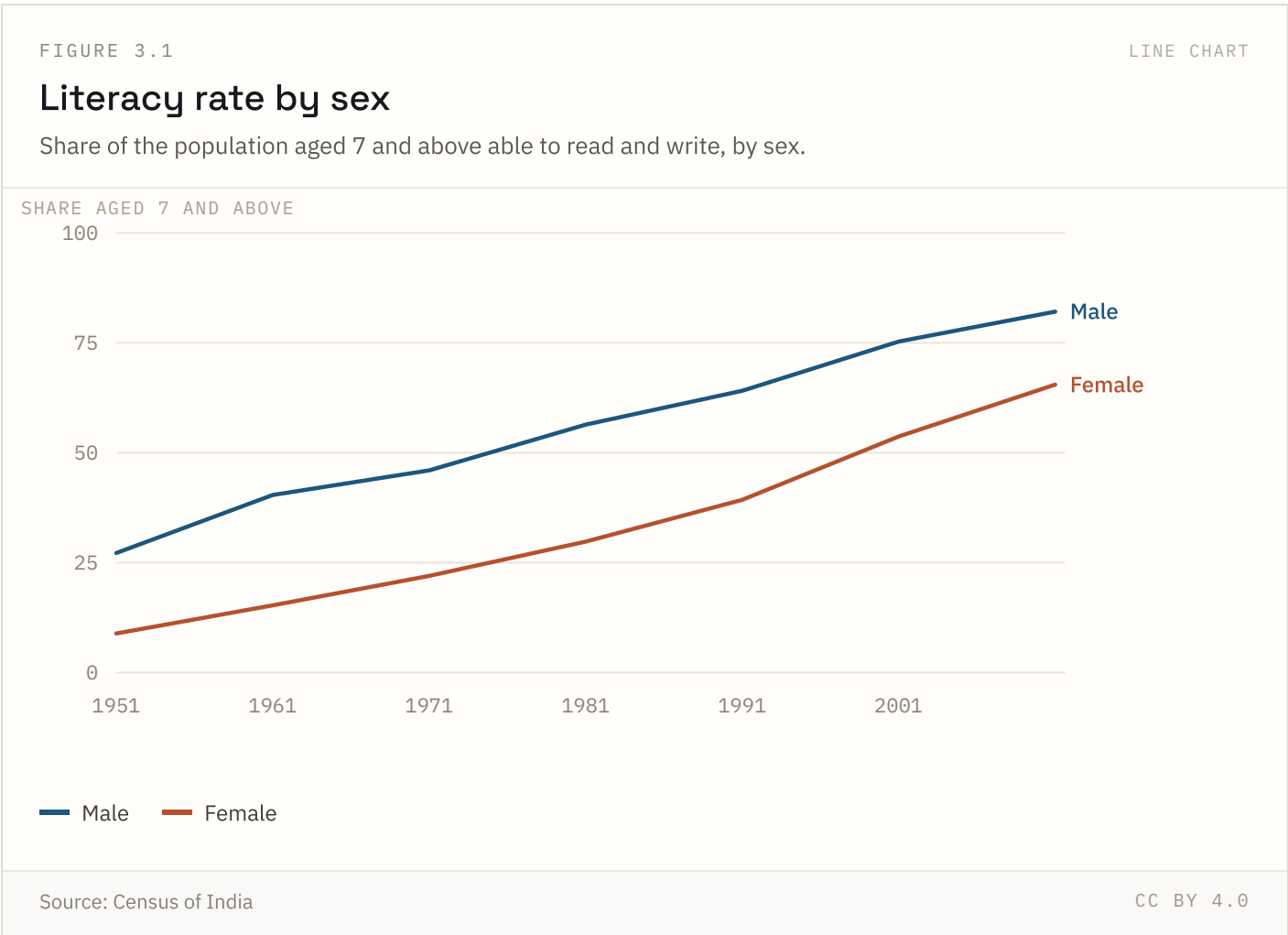
MMR fell from 130 in 2014–16 to 93 in 2019–21. Eight States have already met the SDG target; Assam, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh and Bihar remain furthest from it.

Source: SRS Special Bulletin on Maternal Mortality, RGI Coverage: 2014–16 to 2019–21 Updated: 02 Jun 2026

Education & literacy

3 of 4 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 3.1 NATIONAL + STATE



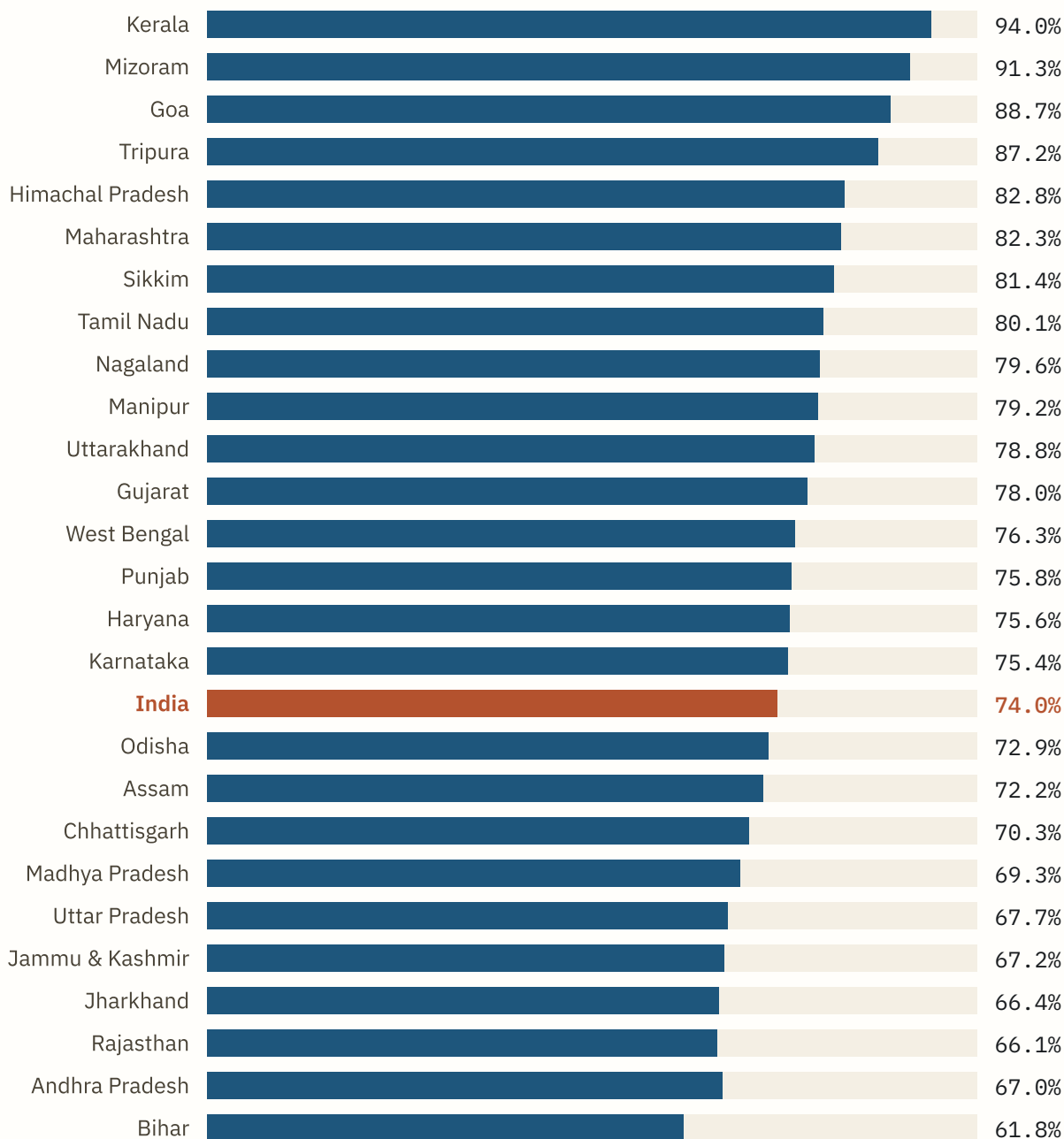
The Census definition — able to read and write with understanding in any language — is self-reported and generous. Survey-based functional literacy measures run 8–14 points lower. The series ends in 2011 because the 2021 Census was postponed.

FIGURE 3.2

RANKED BARS

Literacy rate by state

Census 2011 literacy rates. The national figure is shown in rust.



SCALE 0 - 100.0%

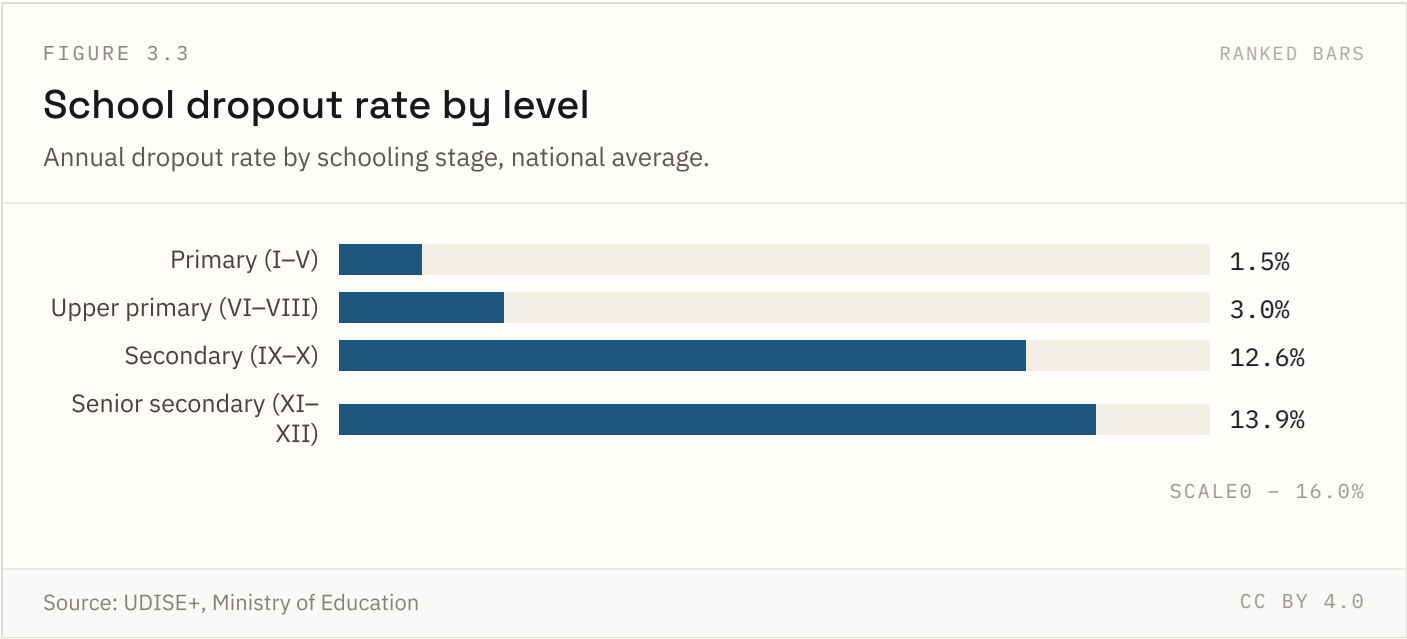
Source: Census of India 2011

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Kerala has led every Census round since 1951. The bottom of the ranking has been more stable than the top: Bihar has been last or second-last in every round since 1961.

Highest: **Kerala** at 94.0%. Lowest: **Bihar** at 61.8%.

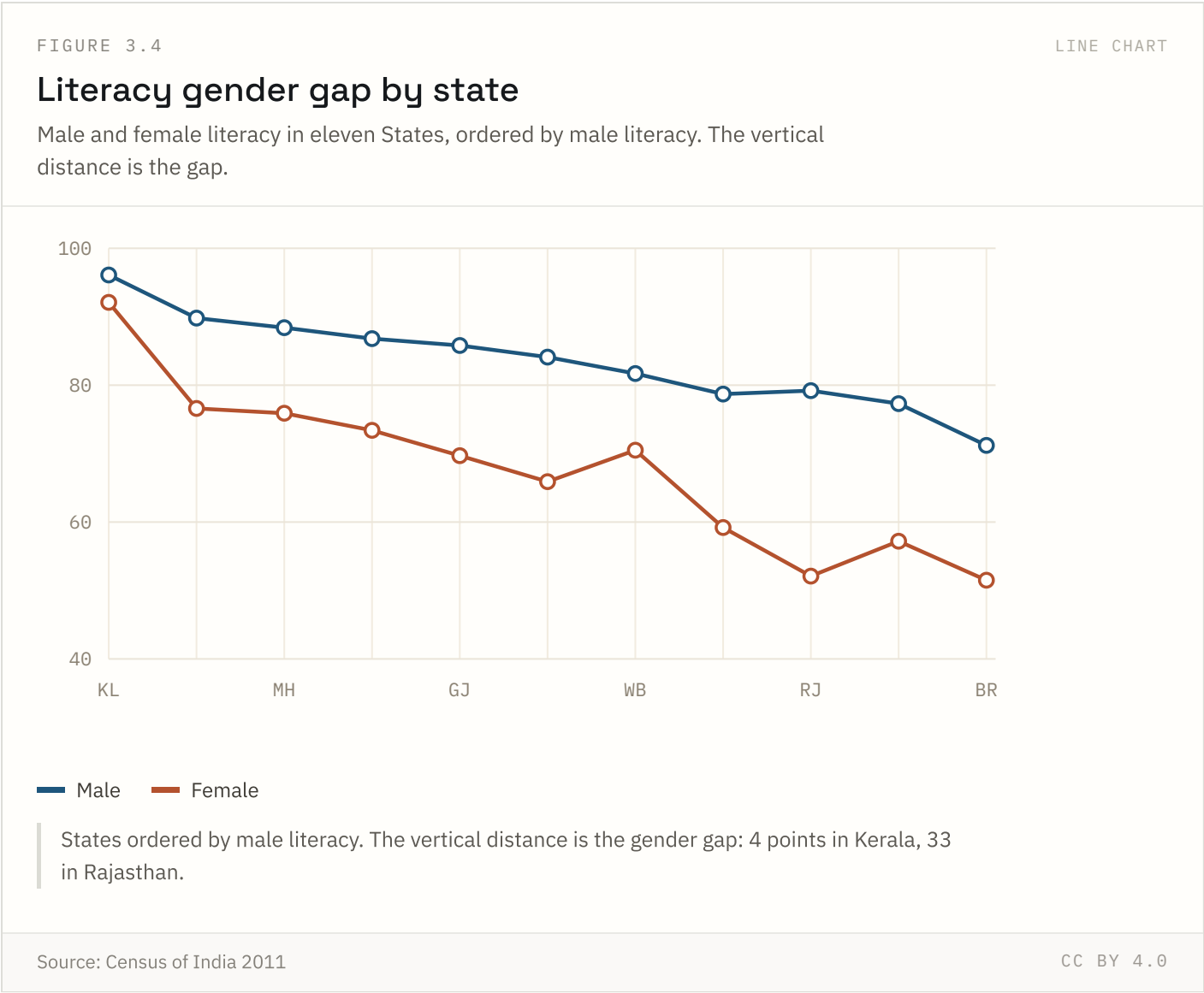
FIGURE 3.3 NATIONAL ONLY



Dropout is heavily concentrated at the secondary stage, roughly the age children are pulled into work or, for girls in some states, marriage. Primary-stage dropout is now low nationally, though state variation is much wider than the national figure suggests.

Source: UDISE+, Ministry of Education Coverage: 2021–22 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 3.4 NATIONAL + STATE

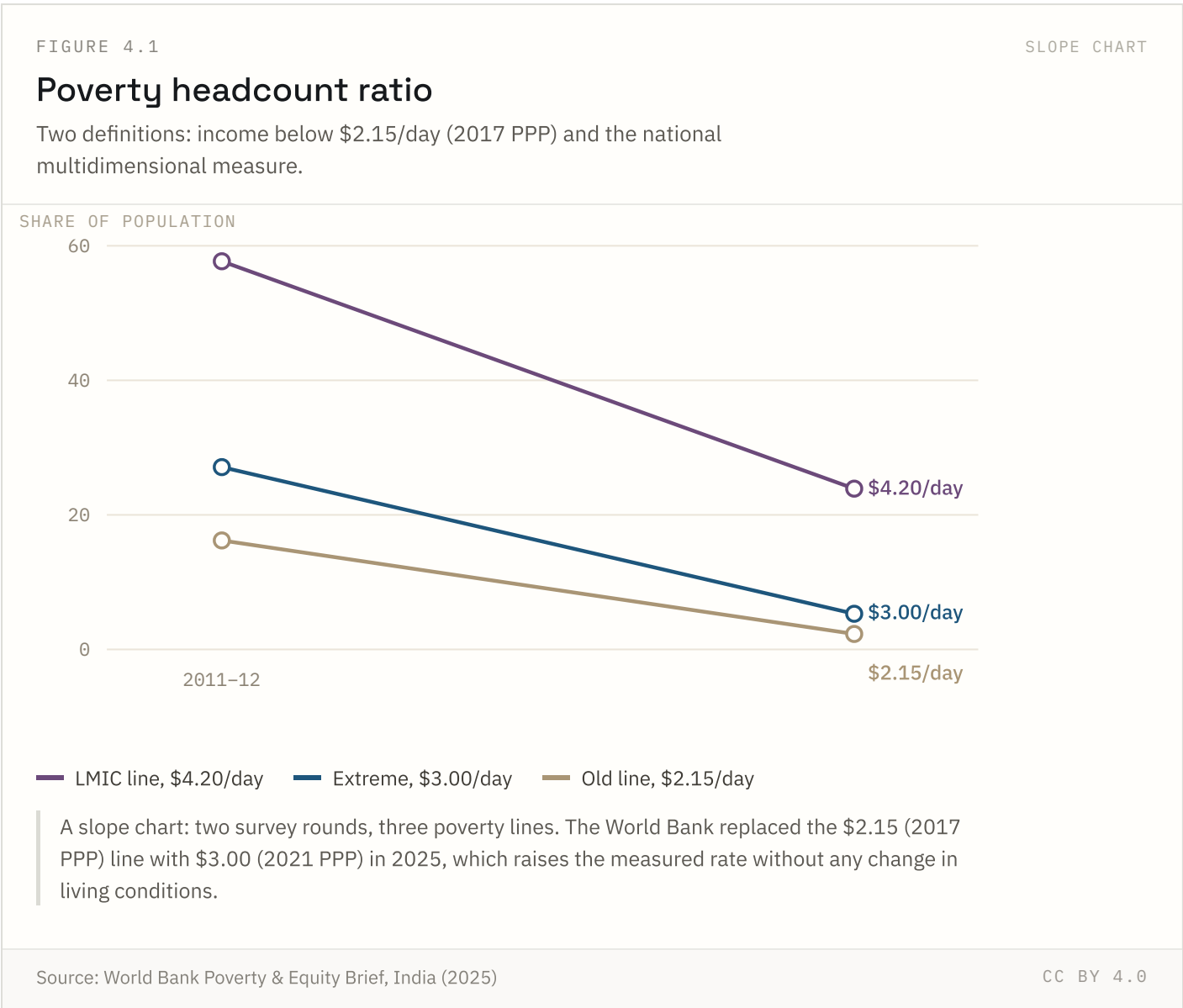


The gap is 4 points in Kerala and 33 in Rajasthan. States with high male literacy do not automatically have small gaps: West Bengal and Madhya Pradesh have similar male rates and very different female ones.

Poverty & incomes

3 of 7 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 4.1 NATIONAL + STATE



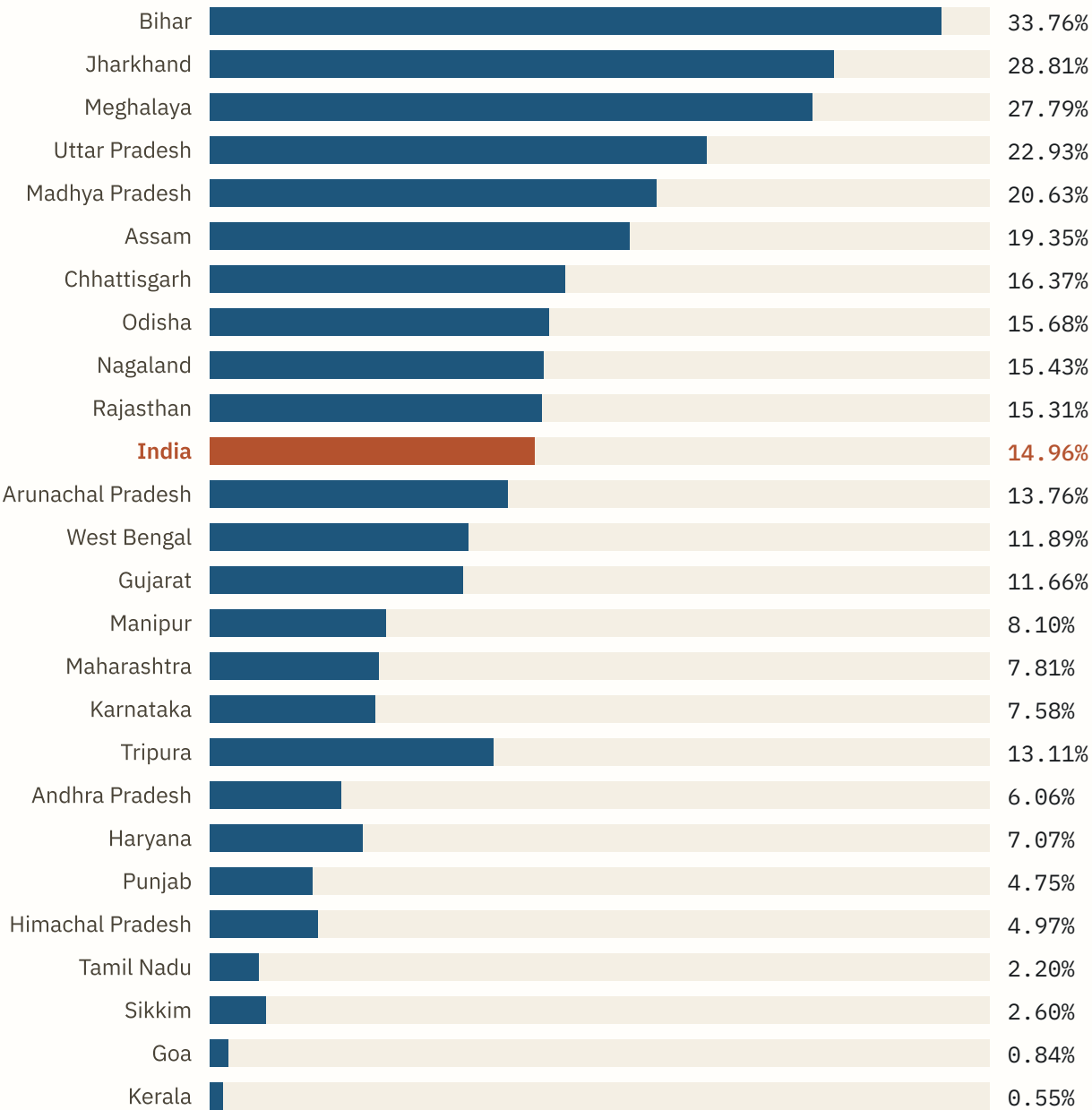
Income poverty and multidimensional poverty answer different questions. The MPI counts deprivations in nutrition, schooling, sanitation, fuel, housing and assets; a household can escape the income line while remaining multidimensionally poor, and often does.

FIGURE 4.2

RANKED BARS

Multidimensional poverty by state

Share of the population identified as multidimensionally poor, NFHS-5 round.



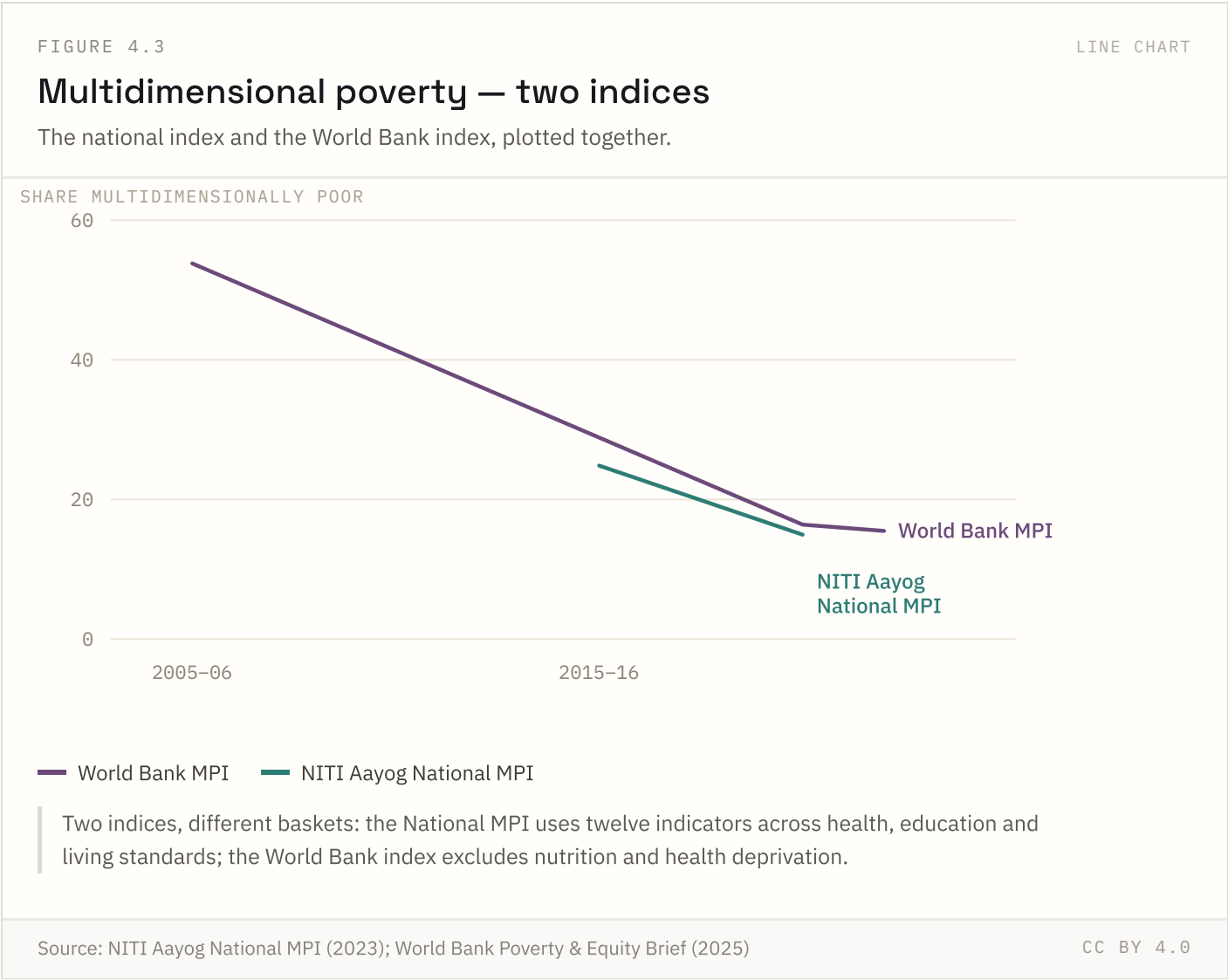
SCALE 0 - 36.00%

Source: NITI Aayog National MPI – A Progress Review 2023

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The National MPI uses twelve indicators across health, education and living standards. Bihar, Jharkhand and Uttar Pradesh together account for roughly half of India’s multidimensionally poor population.

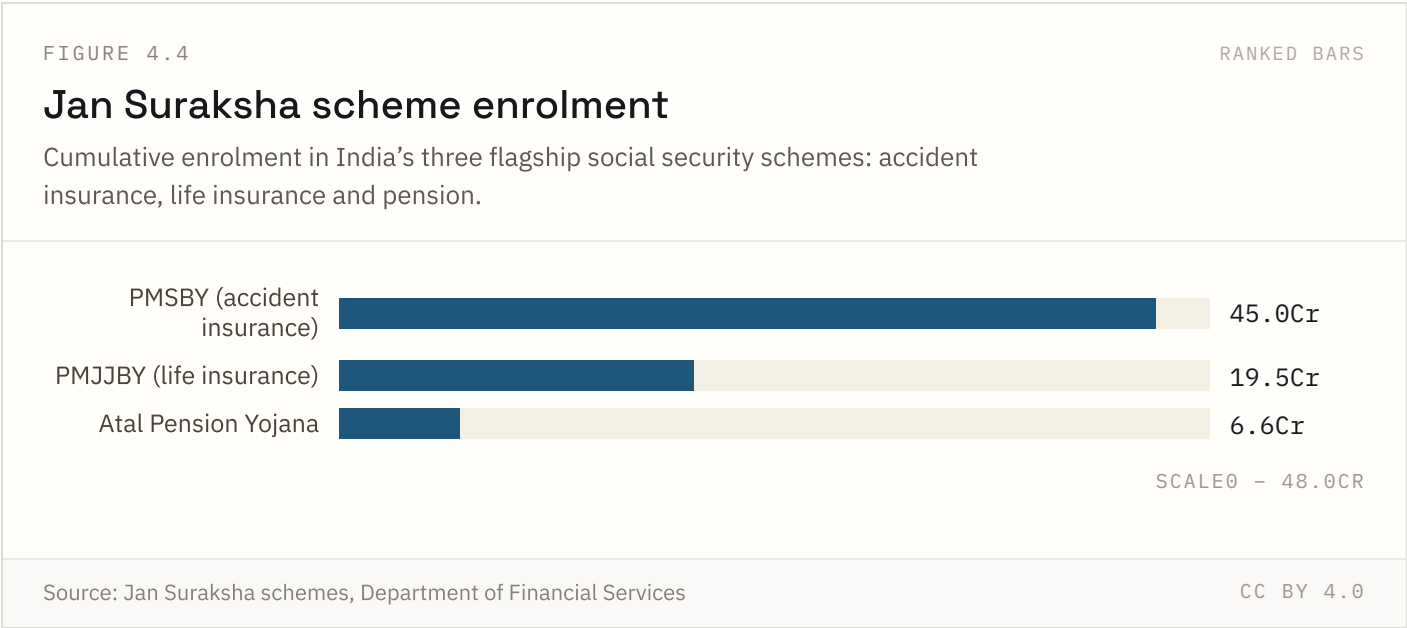
Highest: **Bihar** at 33.76%. Lowest: **Kerala** at 0.55%.



The two indices use different baskets — the National MPI counts twelve indicators including nutrition and maternal health, the World Bank version excludes them — so they should be read as bounds rather than as competing estimates of one quantity.

Source: NITI Aayog National MPI (2023); World Bank Poverty & Equity Brief (2025) Coverage: 2005-06 to 2022-23

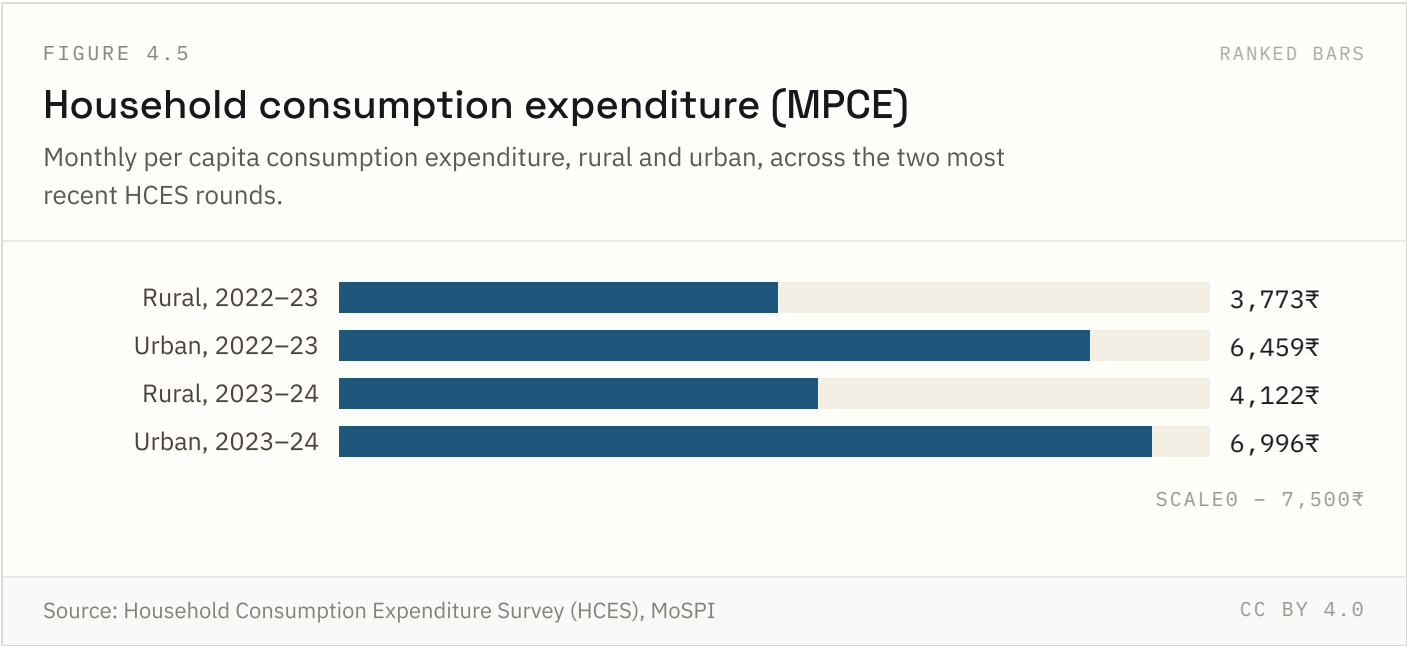
Updated: 24 Jul 2026



PMSBY’s low annual premium (₹20) drives far higher enrolment than the pension scheme, which requires a recurring contribution. Enrolment counts include lapsed and inactive accounts in most published figures, so active coverage is somewhat lower than these cumulative totals suggest.

Source: Jan Suraksha schemes, Department of Financial Services Coverage: Cumulative to 2024

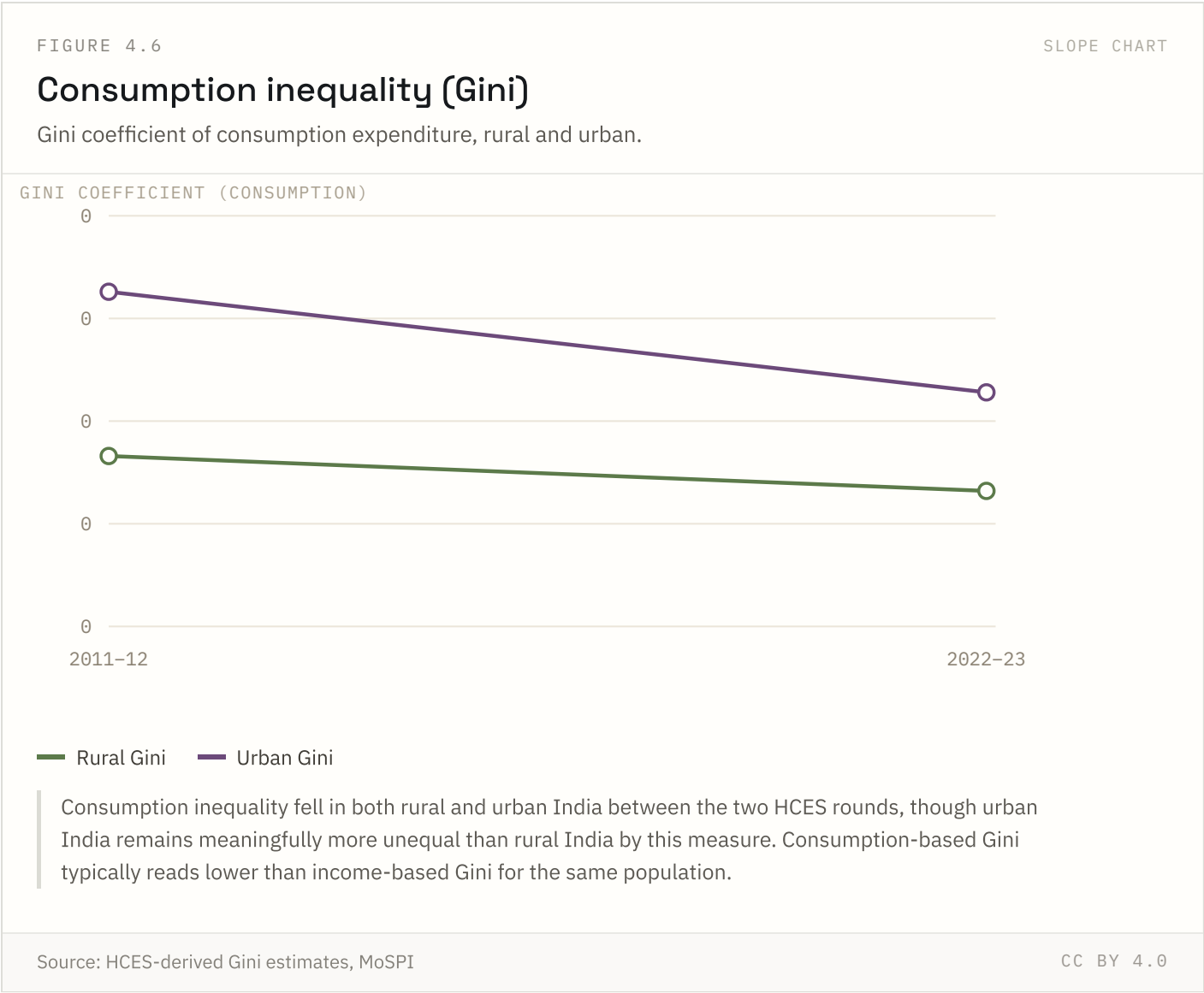
Updated: 18 Aug 2026



MPCE is the bridge between GDP growth and how households actually live — it is the base data used to estimate poverty and inequality. The urban-rural gap (roughly 70%) has narrowed only slightly across the two rounds.

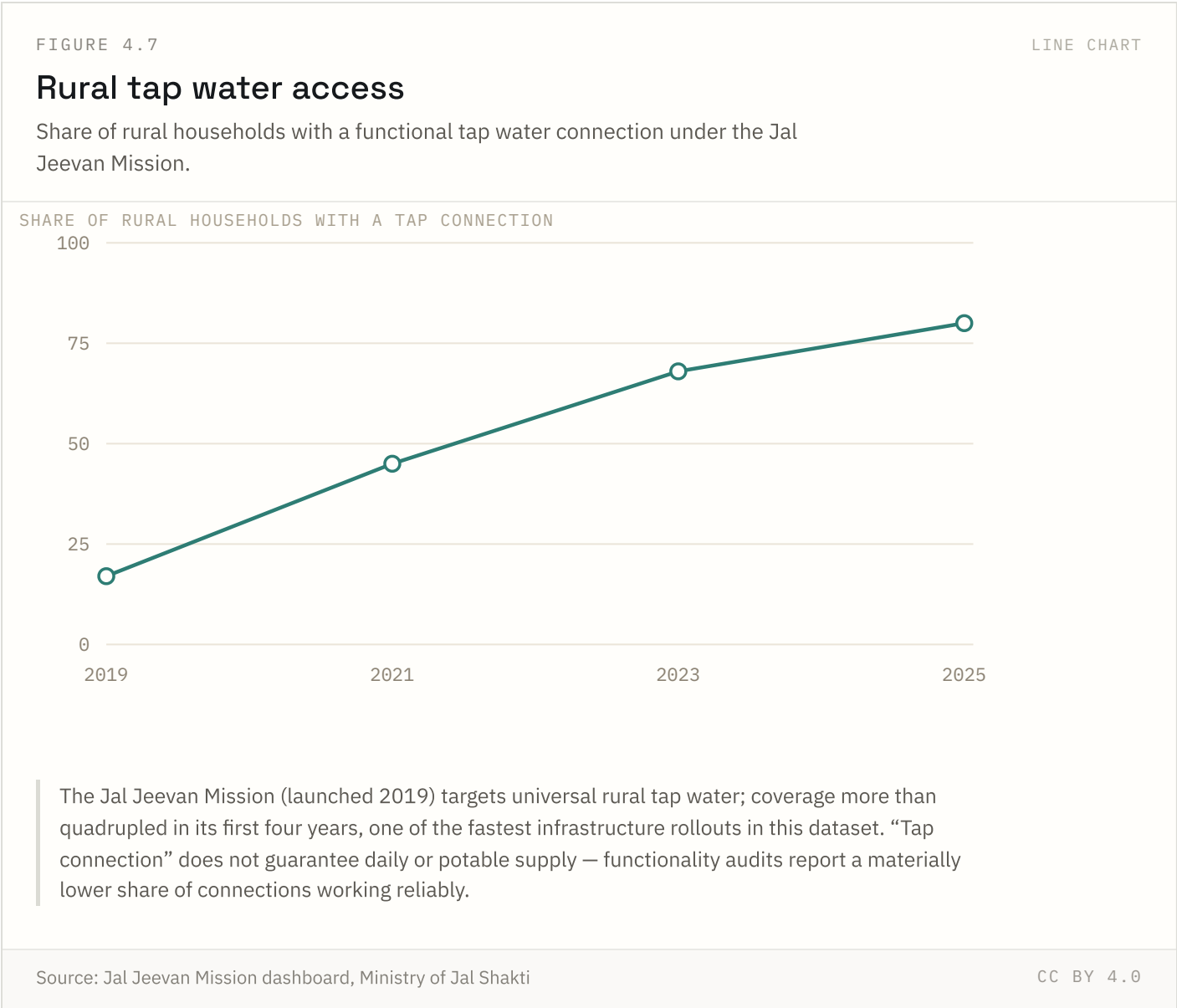
Source: Household Consumption Expenditure Survey (HCES), MoSPI Coverage: 2022-23 to 2023-24

Updated: 18 Aug 2026



Both rural and urban inequality fell between the two survey rounds. Consumption-based Gini is structurally lower than income-based Gini for the same population, since consumption smooths over income volatility — comparisons with countries that report income Gini should account for this.

FIGURE 4.7 NATIONAL ONLY

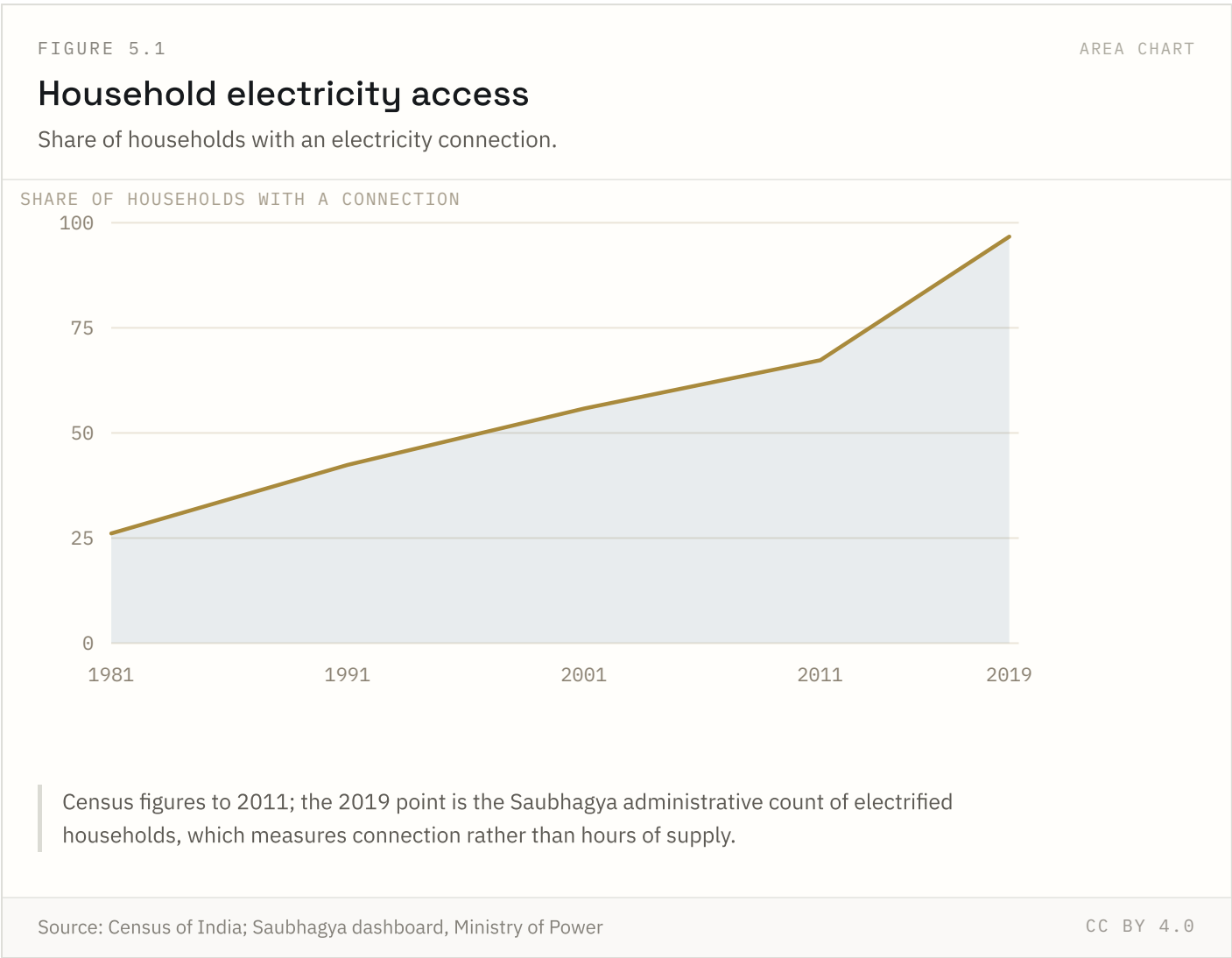


Coverage rose from under a fifth of rural households in 2019 to roughly four-fifths by 2025, one of the fastest rural infrastructure rollouts in this dataset. A reported connection does not guarantee daily supply or potability — independent functionality audits typically report a lower working share.

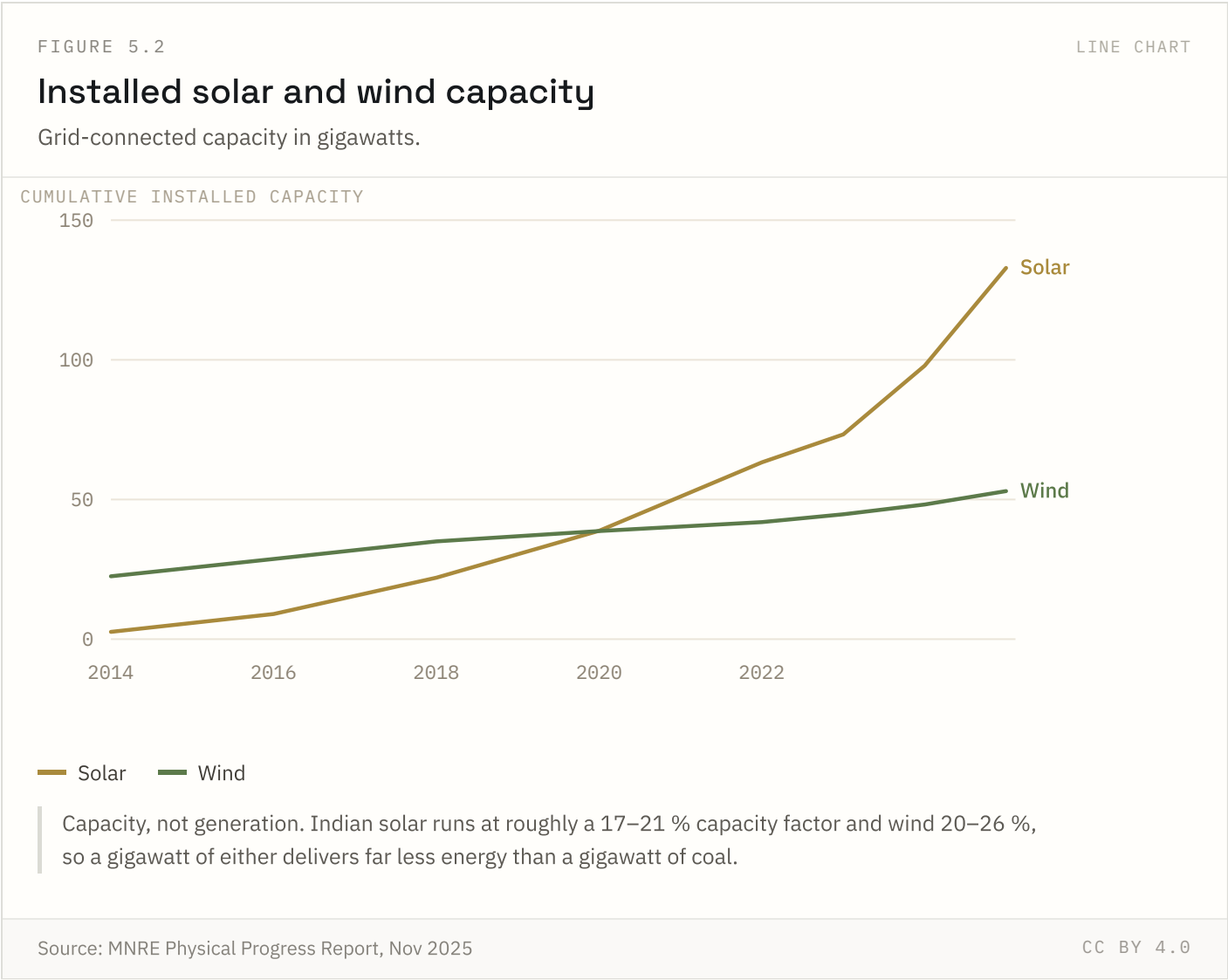
Energy & electricity

2 of 5 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

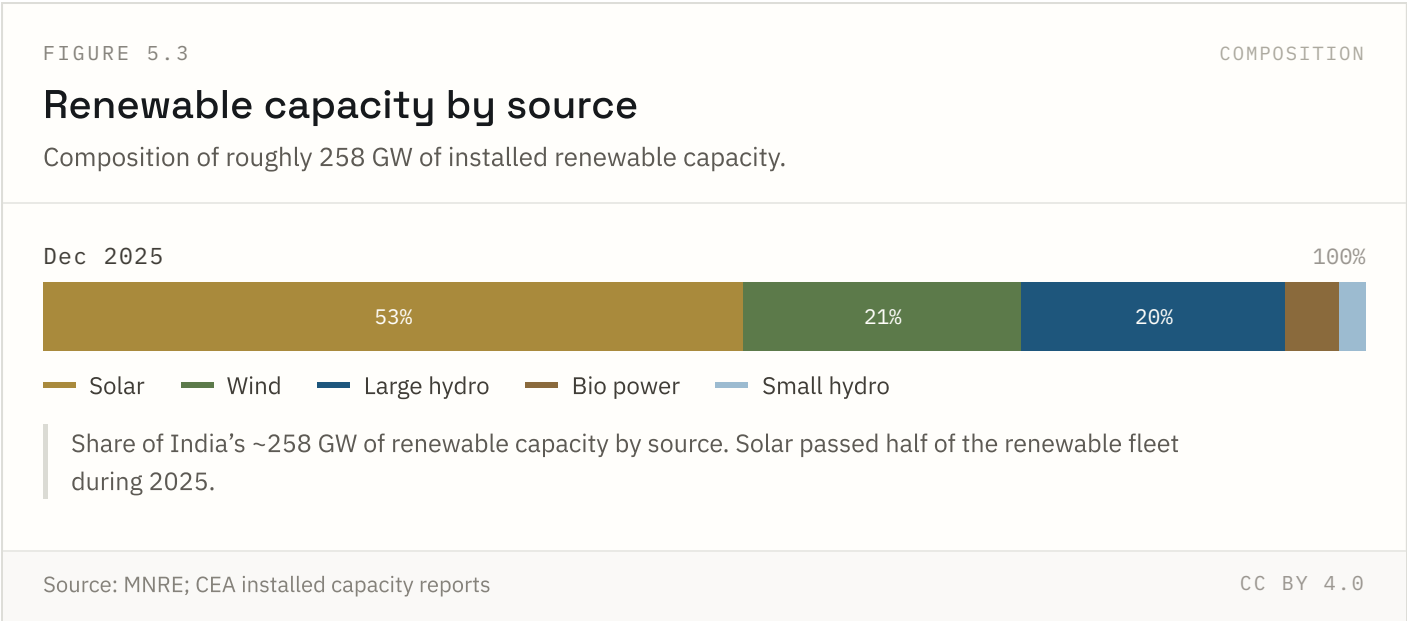
FIGURE 5.1 NATIONAL + STATE



Connection is not the same as supply. Administrative data reports near-universal connection since 2019, but survey data on hours of supply shows large rural shortfalls, especially in Bihar, Jharkhand and Uttar Pradesh.

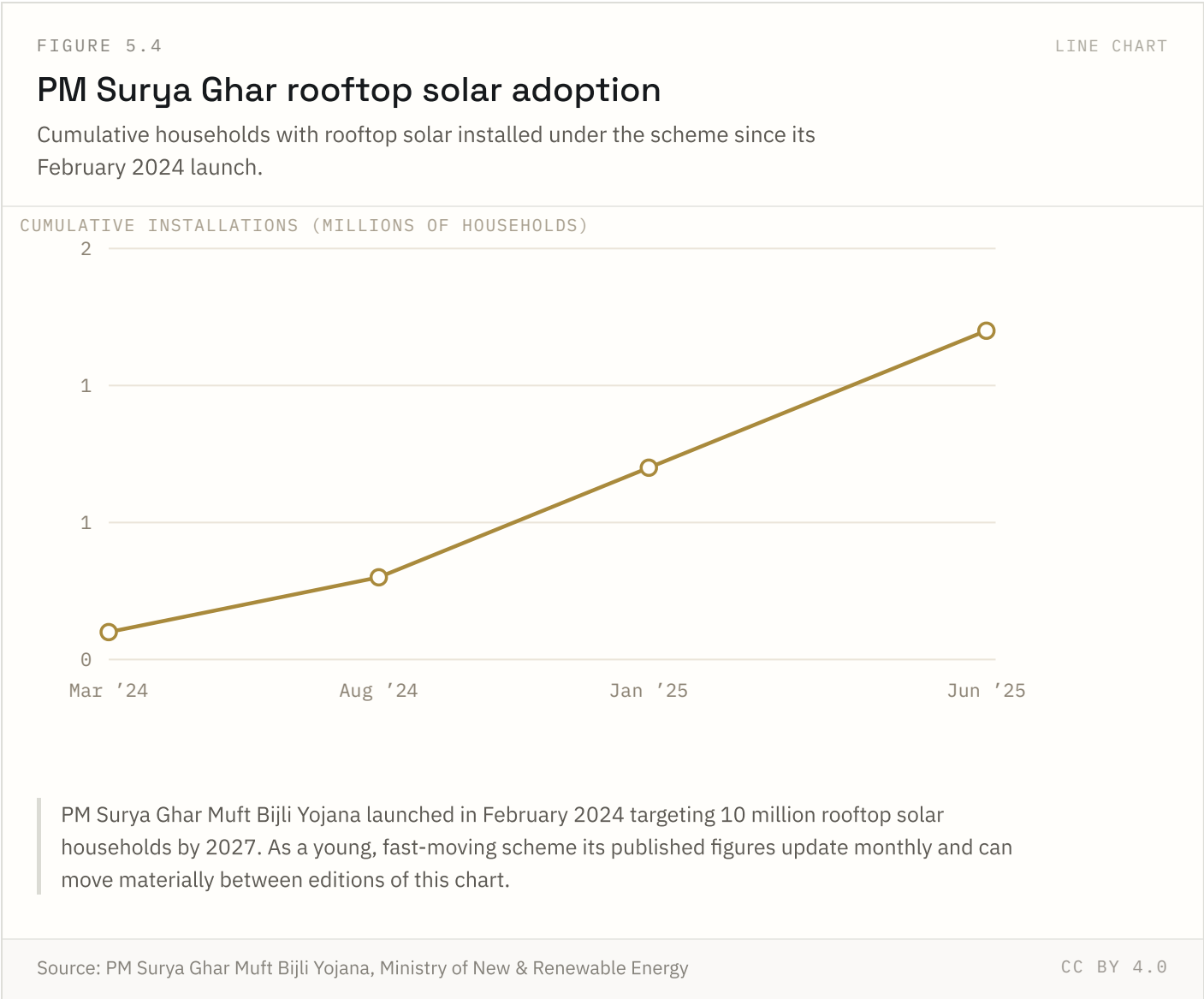


Capacity is not generation. Solar capacity factors in India run 17–21 per cent, wind 20–26 per cent, so a gigawatt of each delivers far less energy than a gigawatt of coal. Both series are ahead of the trajectory implied by the 2015 targets.



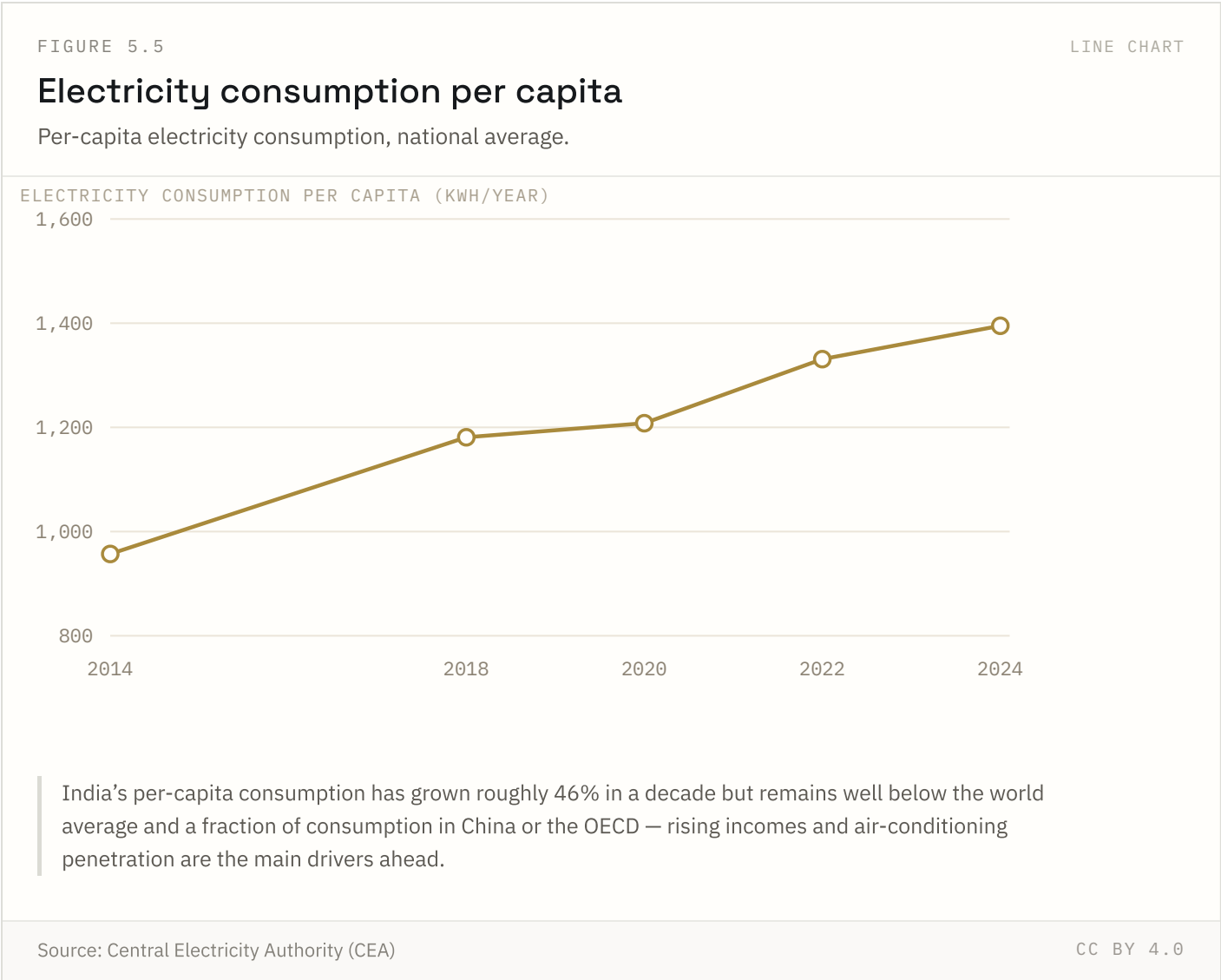
Solar passed half the renewable fleet during 2025. Large hydro, which took seven decades to build, is now smaller than solar, which took eleven years.

FIGURE 5.4 NATIONAL ONLY



The scheme targets 10 million rooftop-solar households by 2027; adoption so far is a small fraction of that target and figures update frequently as installation data is reconciled with subsidy disbursement.

FIGURE 5.5 NATIONAL ONLY



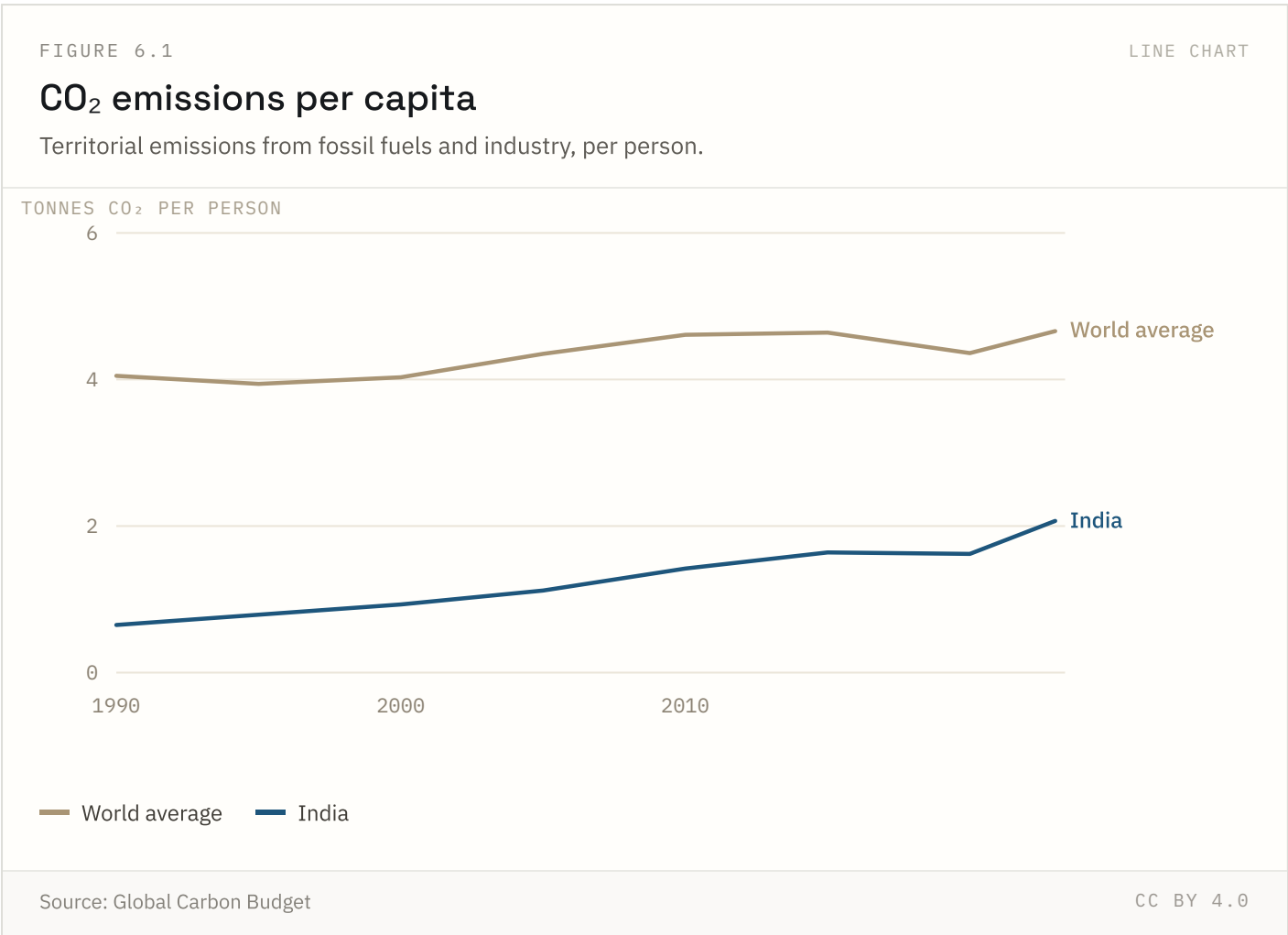
This is a different question from your household electricity access indicator: access asks whether a connection exists; this asks how much power the average person actually uses — a better proxy for living standards and industrial activity than connection rates alone.

Source: Central Electricity Authority (CEA) Coverage: 2014–2024 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

Climate & air quality

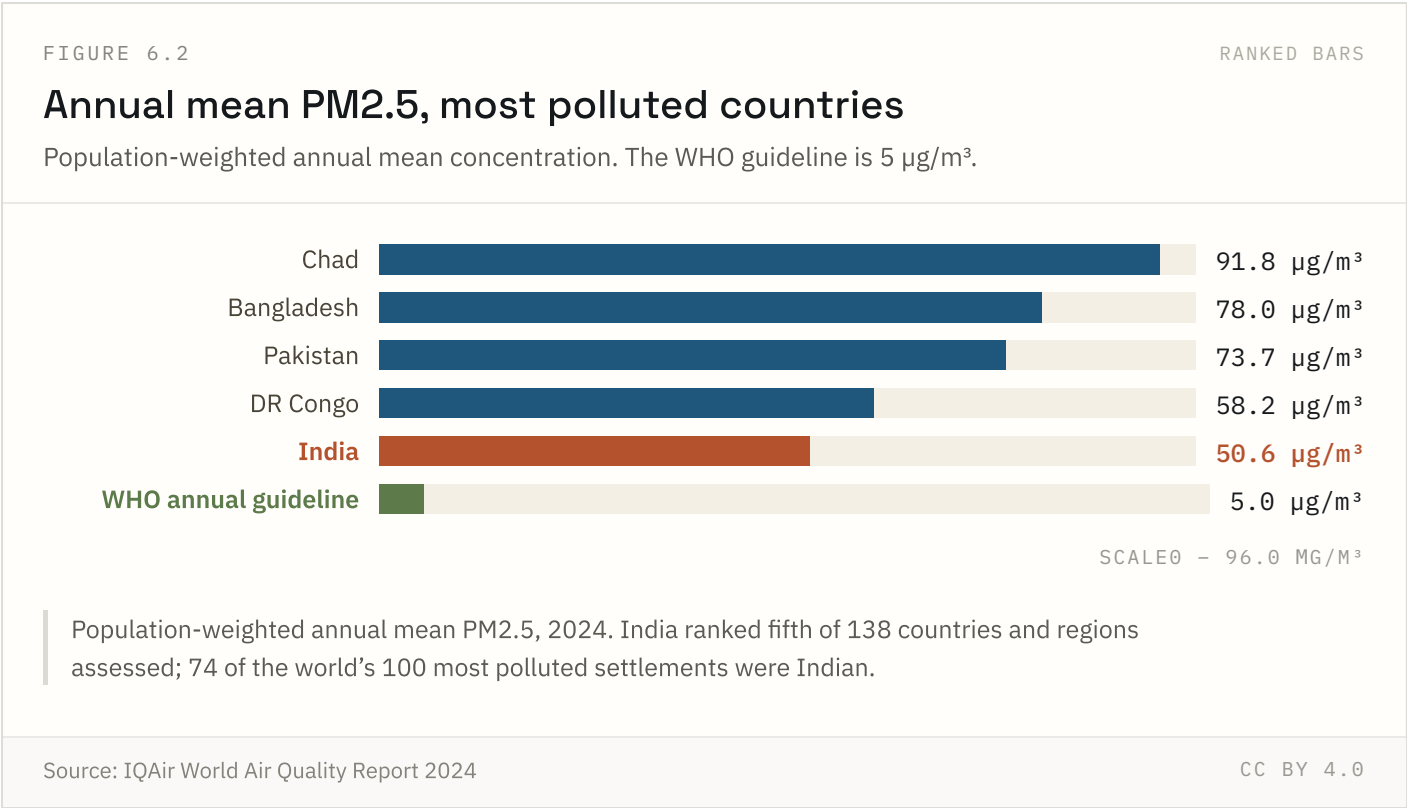
1 of 10 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 6.1 NATIONAL ONLY



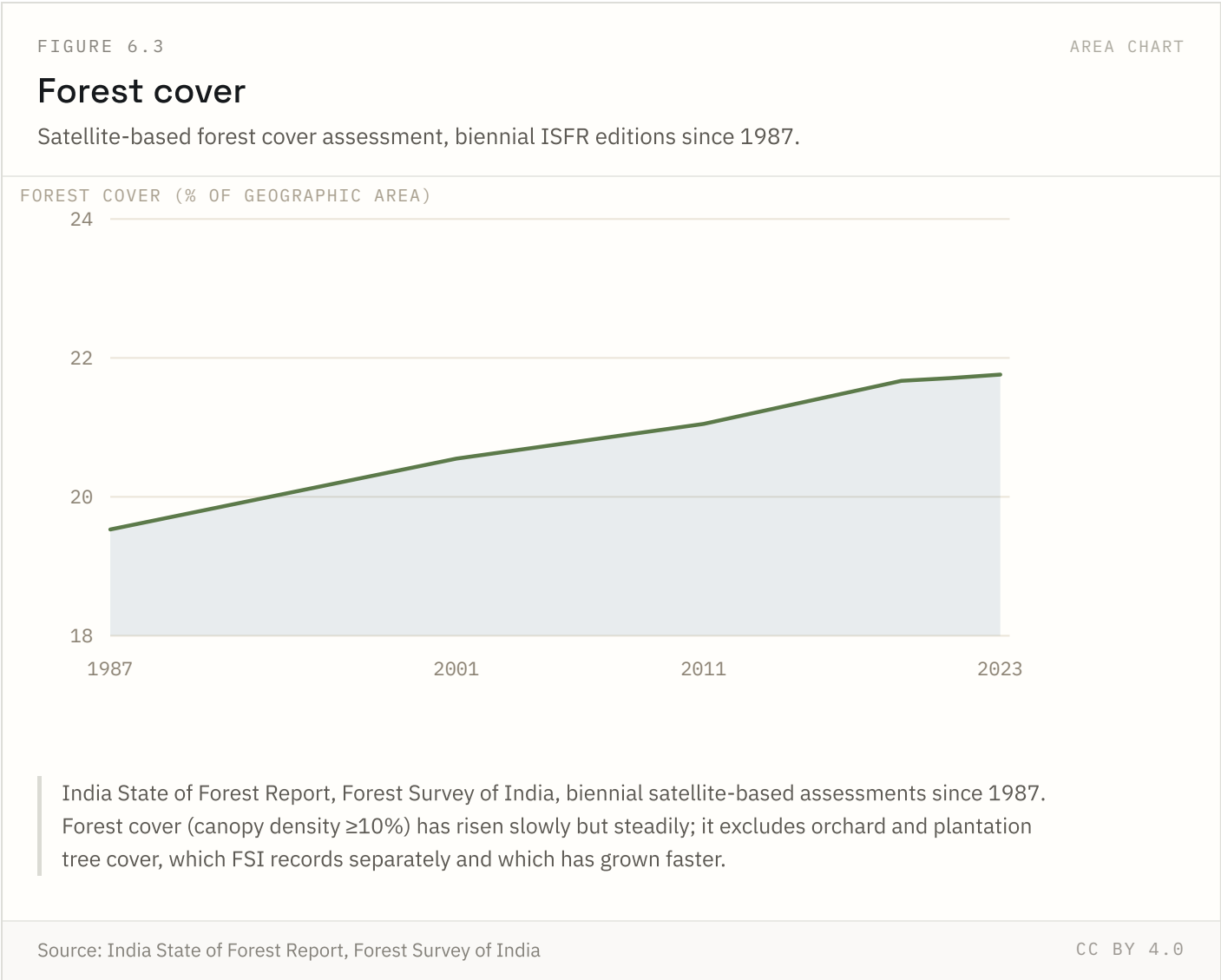
India is the third-largest emitter in absolute terms and among the lowest per person of any major economy — roughly 45 per cent of the world average. Cumulative emissions since 1850 are about 3 per cent of the global total.

FIGURE 6.2 NATIONAL ONLY



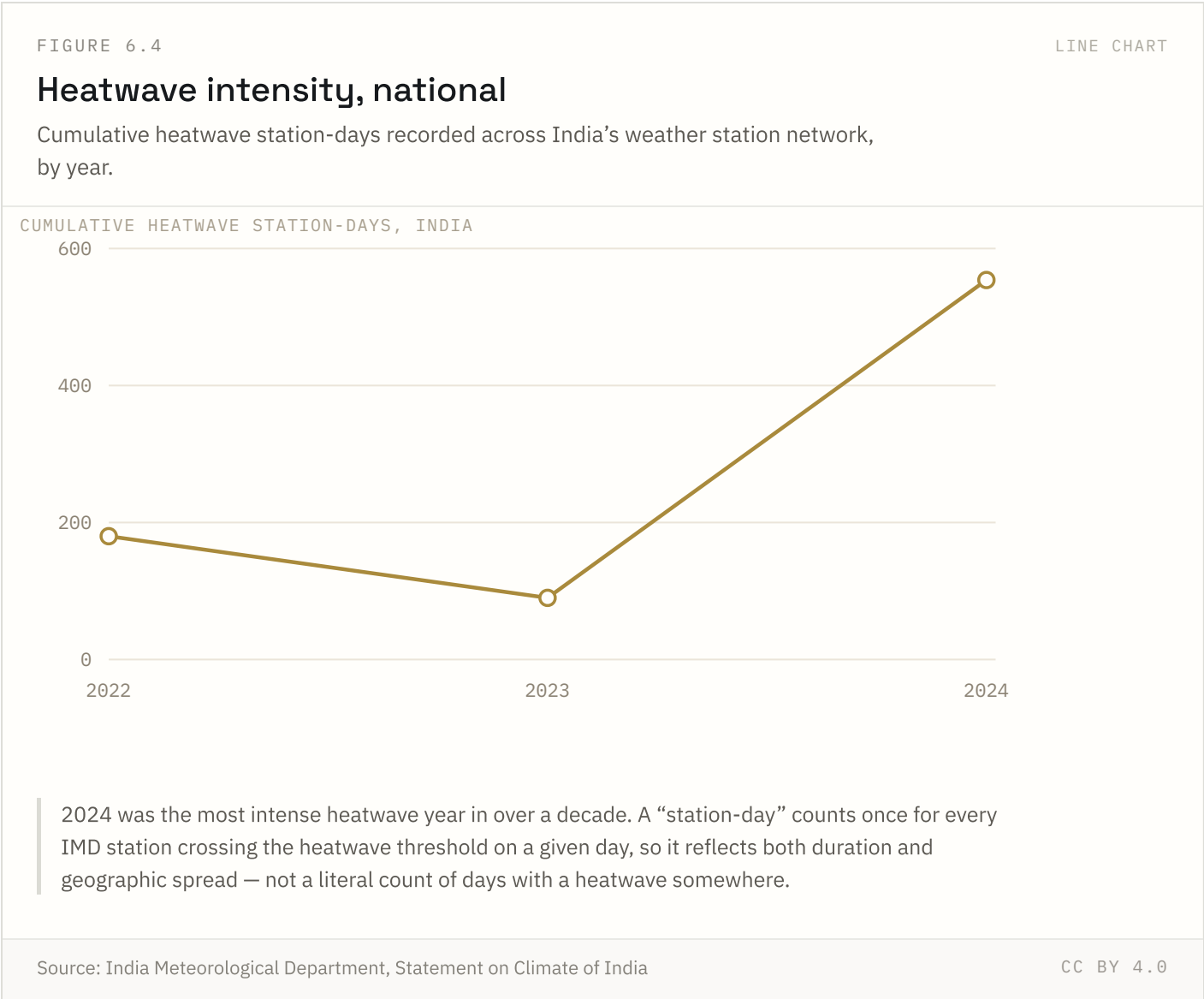
Every city shown exceeds the WHO annual guideline of 5 µg/m³, and all but one exceed India’s own standard of 40. Monitor coverage is uneven: much of central and eastern India has fewer than one continuous monitor per million people.

Source: IQAir World Air Quality Report 2024 Coverage: 2024 Updated: 14 Apr 2026



Forest cover has risen slowly but steadily, from 19.53% of geographic area in 1987 to 21.76% in 2023 — still short of the National Forest Policy target of 33%. The figure excludes orchard and plantation tree cover, tracked separately, which has grown faster than natural forest.

FIGURE 6.4 NATIONAL ONLY

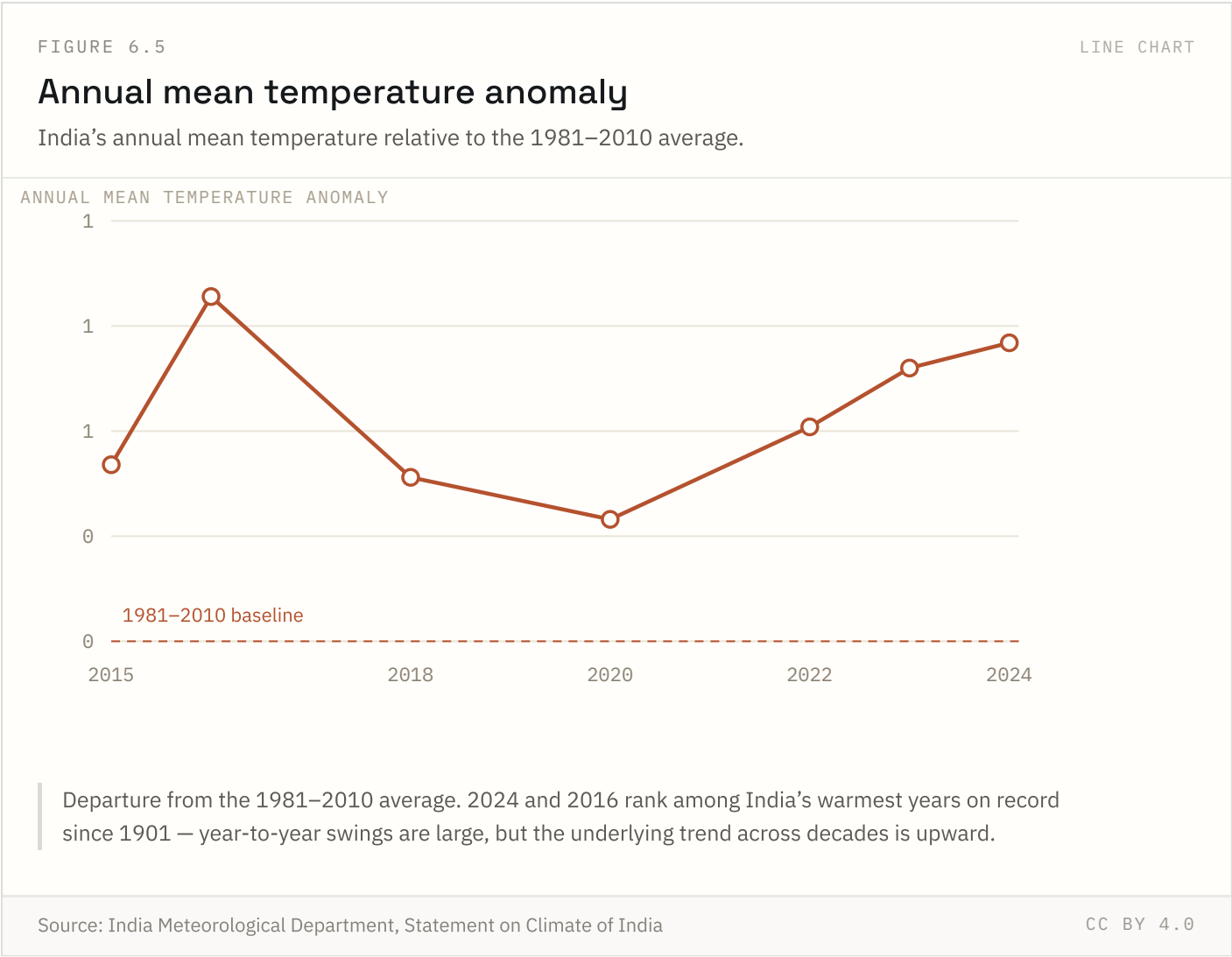


2024 was widely reported as India’s most intense heatwave year in over a decade, with several cities recording temperatures above 45°C. The station-day metric rewards both longer heatwaves and wider geographic spread, so a single very hot, very long event in a densely monitored region can dominate the national total.

Source: India Meteorological Department, Statement on Climate of India Coverage: 2022–2024

Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 6.5 NATIONAL ONLY

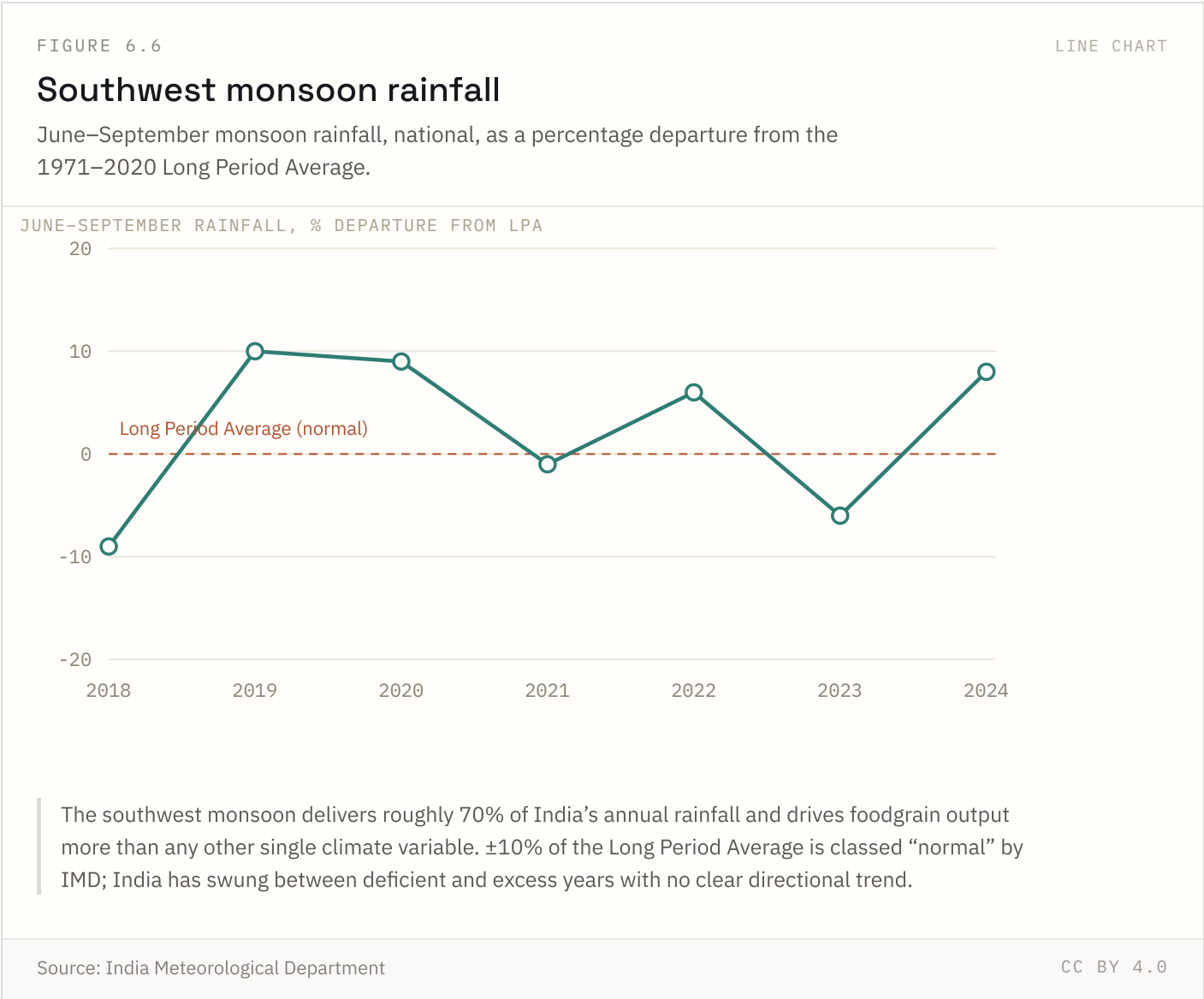


IMD has ranked several recent years among the warmest since national records began in 1901. Annual figures are noisy year to year — a single cool year does not reverse the multi-decade warming trend visible in the underlying data.

Source: India Meteorological Department, Statement on Climate of India Coverage: 2015–2024

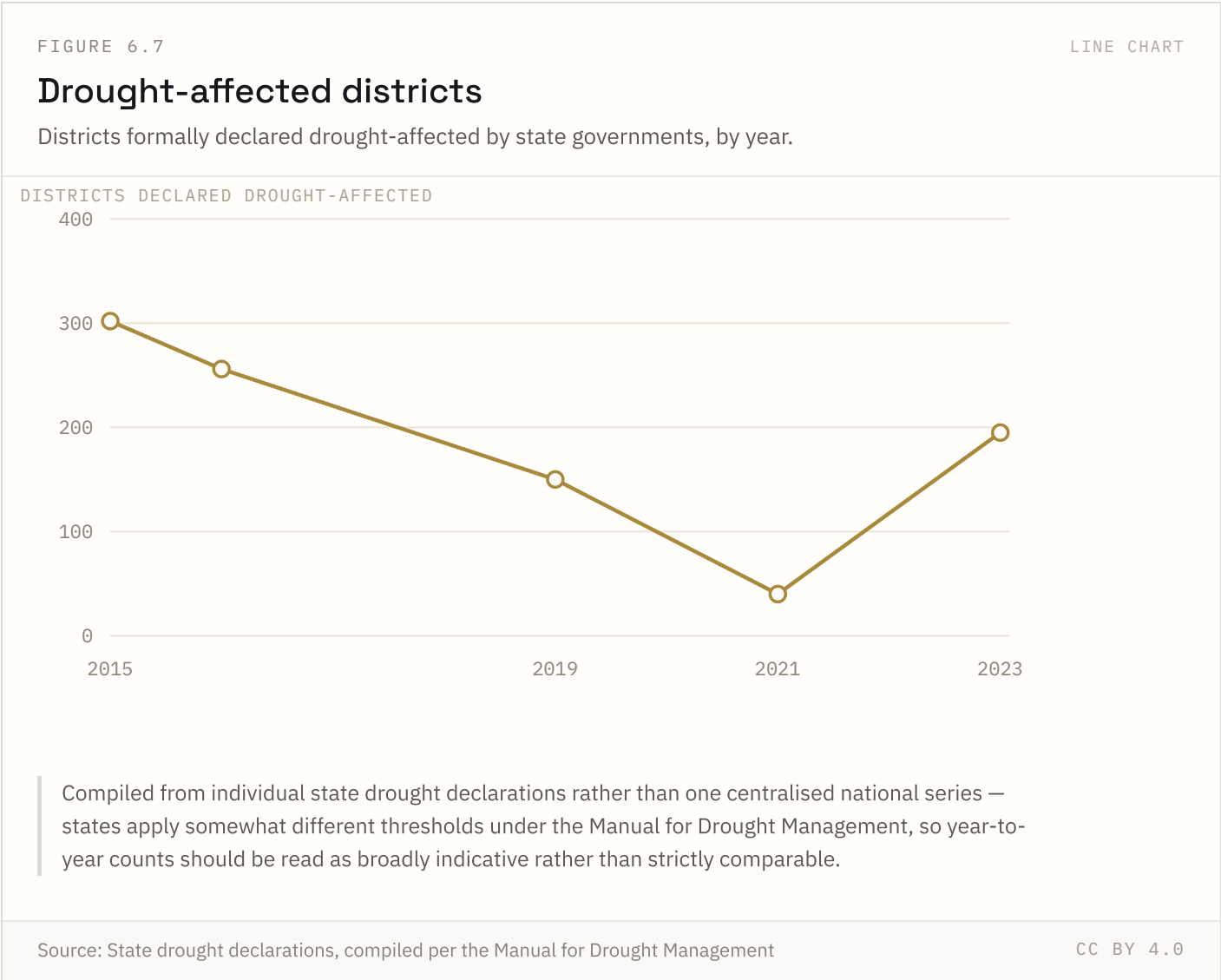
Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 6.6 NATIONAL ONLY



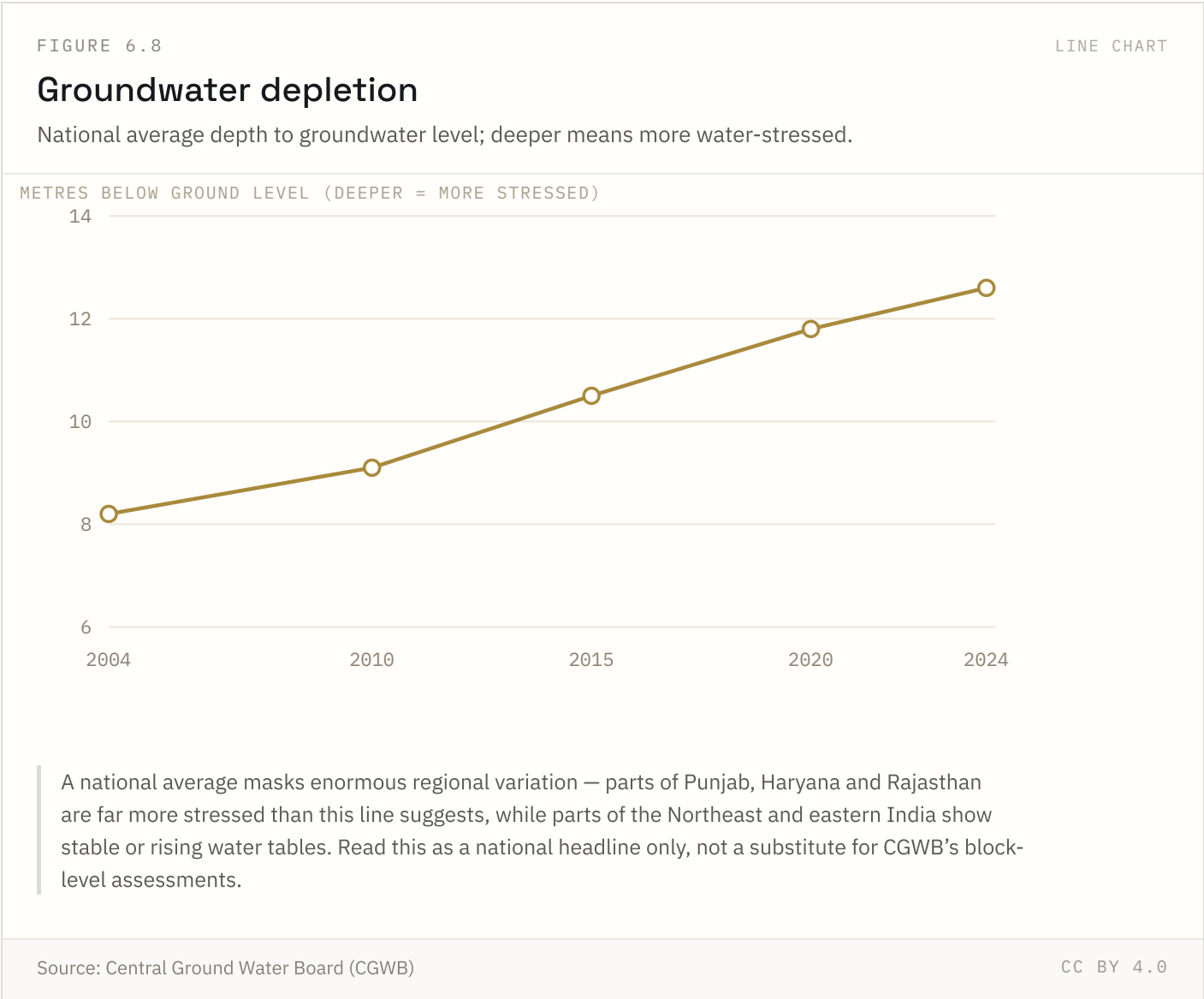
IMD classes $\pm 10\%$ of the LPA as “normal.” The monsoon’s national total can mask sharply uneven regional distribution — a “normal” year on paper can still combine drought in one region with flooding in another.

FIGURE 6.7 NATIONAL ONLY

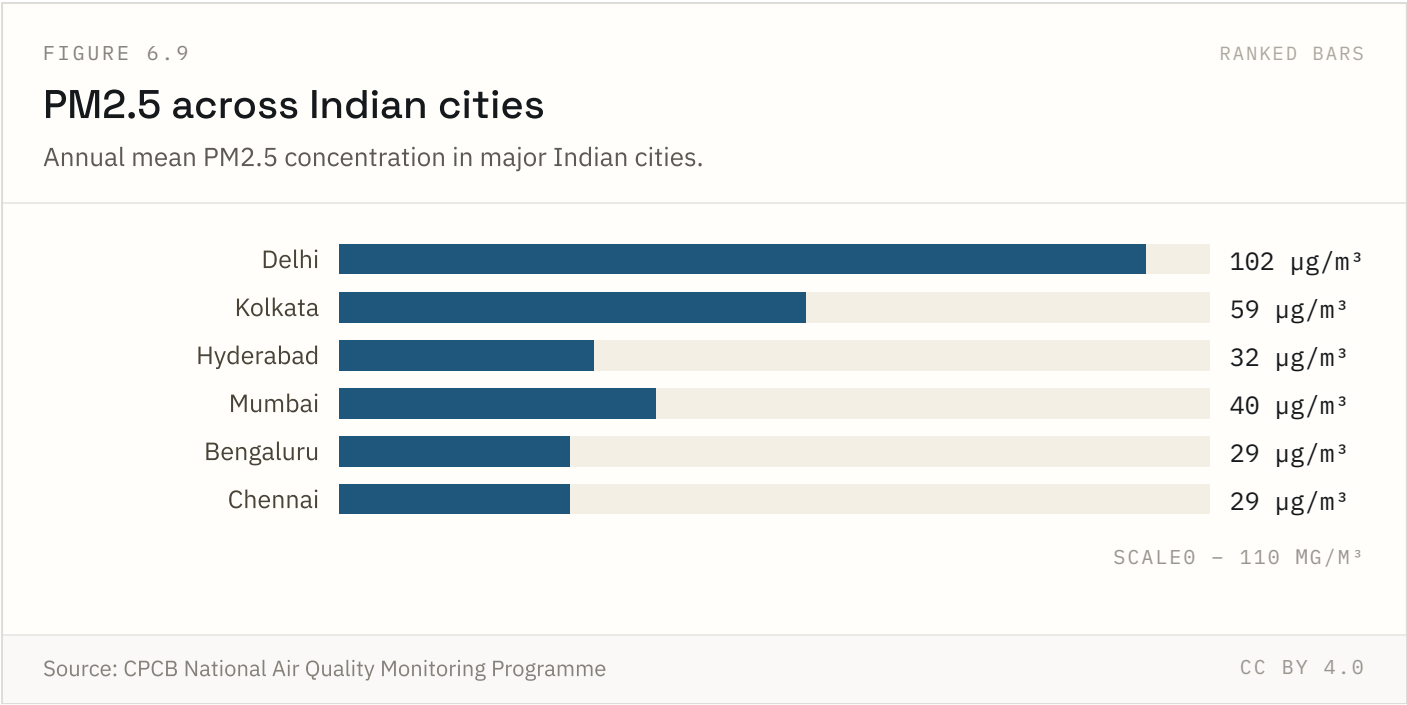


There is no single centralised national drought register — this compiles individual state declarations, which apply the Manual for Drought Management’s criteria with some local discretion. Treat trends as broadly indicative; exact counts vary by source and reporting date.

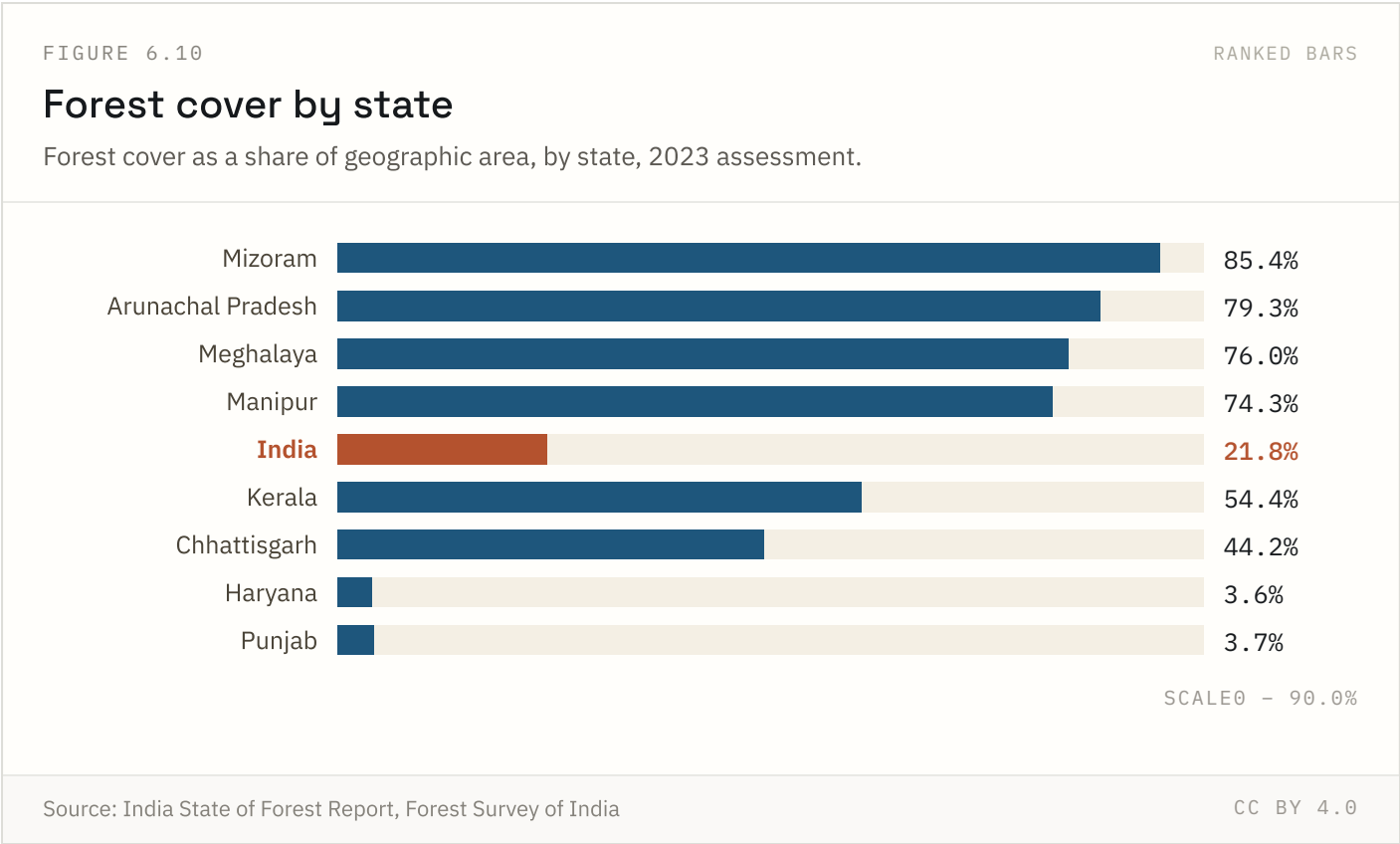
FIGURE 6.8 NATIONAL ONLY



India is the world’s largest extractor of groundwater, used mainly for irrigation. A national average conceals sharp regional divergence — Punjab, Haryana and Rajasthan are critically over-extracted, while parts of eastern India show stable or even rising water tables.



Every city shown exceeds both the WHO guideline ($5\text{ }\mu\text{g}/\text{m}^3$) and India’s own national standard ($40\text{ }\mu\text{g}/\text{m}^3$). Delhi’s winter inversion and regional stubble-burning make its annual average an outlier even among India’s other large, heavily polluted cities.



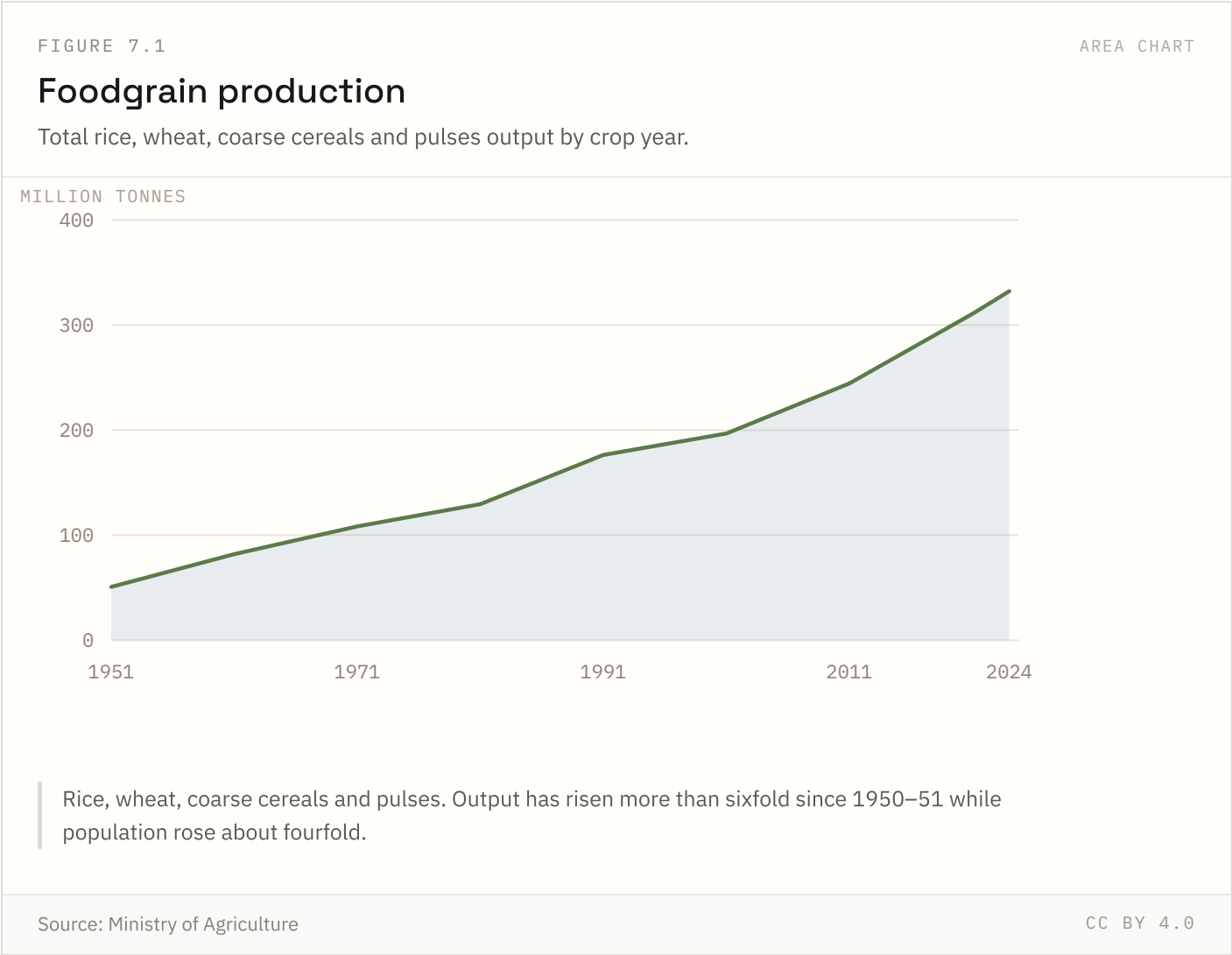
The gap between India’s most and least forested major states spans more than 80 percentage points. Northeastern states carry a hugely disproportionate share of India’s forest cover relative to their land area’s share of the country.

Highest: **Mizoram** at 85.4%. Lowest: **Haryana** at 3.6%.

Agriculture & food

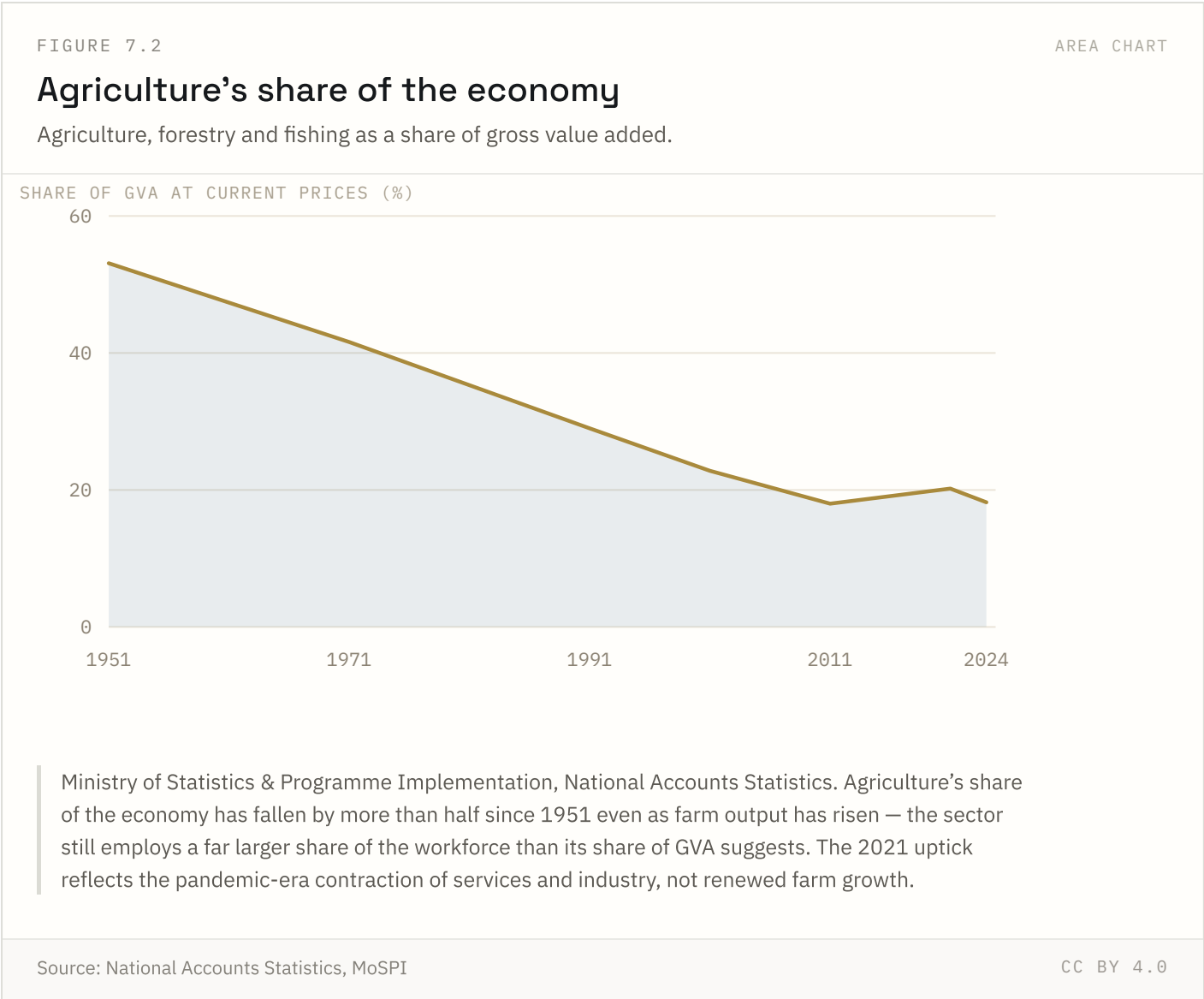
1 of 2 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 7.1 NATIONAL + STATE



Output has risen more than sixfold since 1951 while the population rose about fourfold. Yield growth, not area expansion, accounts for nearly all of the gain since 1980 – and it has slowed markedly since 2015.

FIGURE 7.2 NATIONAL ONLY

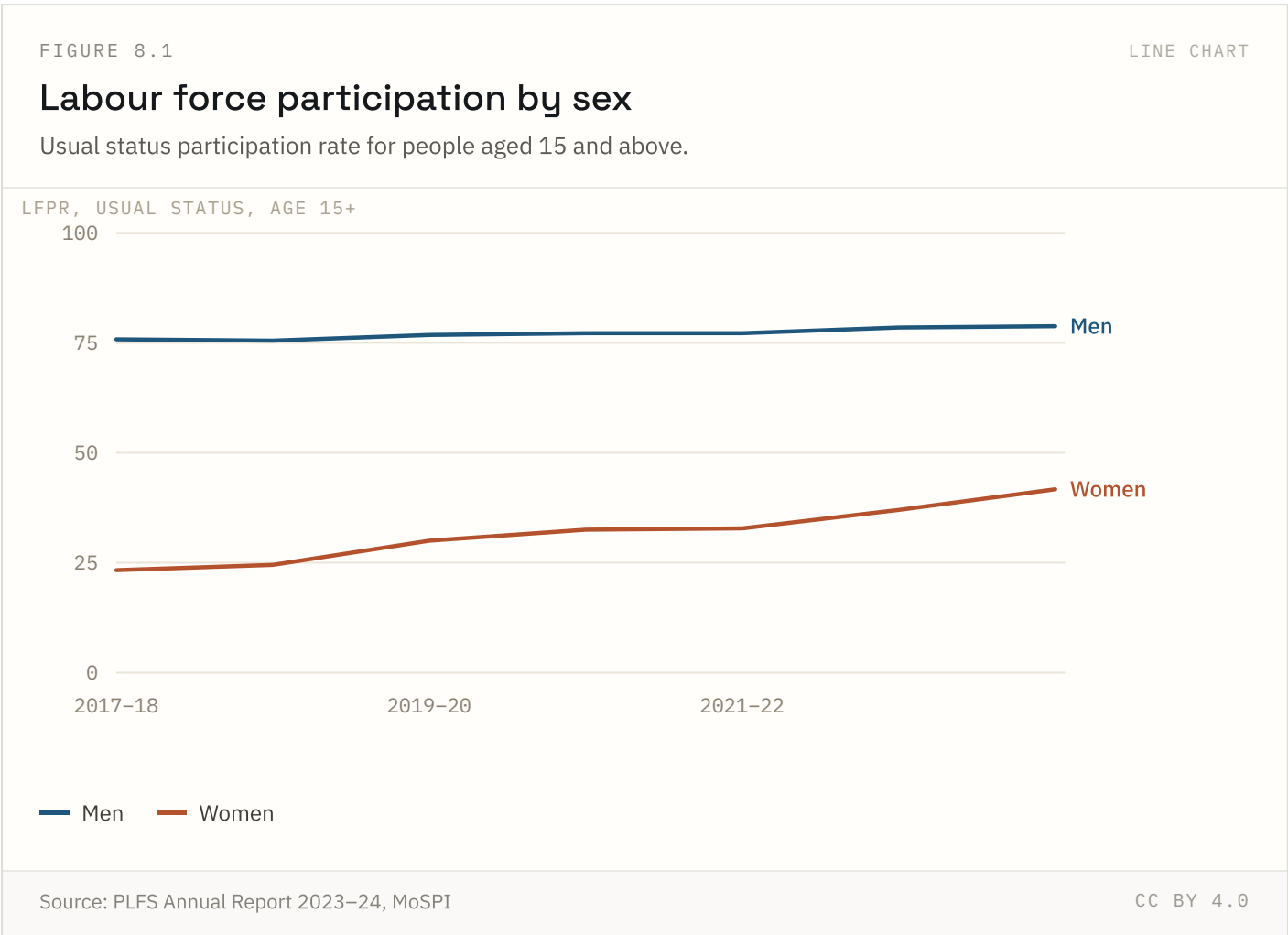


Agriculture's share of the economy has fallen by more than half since 1951, from 53% to around 18%, even as output kept rising — the sector still employs a far larger share of the workforce than its economic share suggests. The 2021 uptick reflects the pandemic-era contraction of services and industry, not a farm revival.

Employment & labour

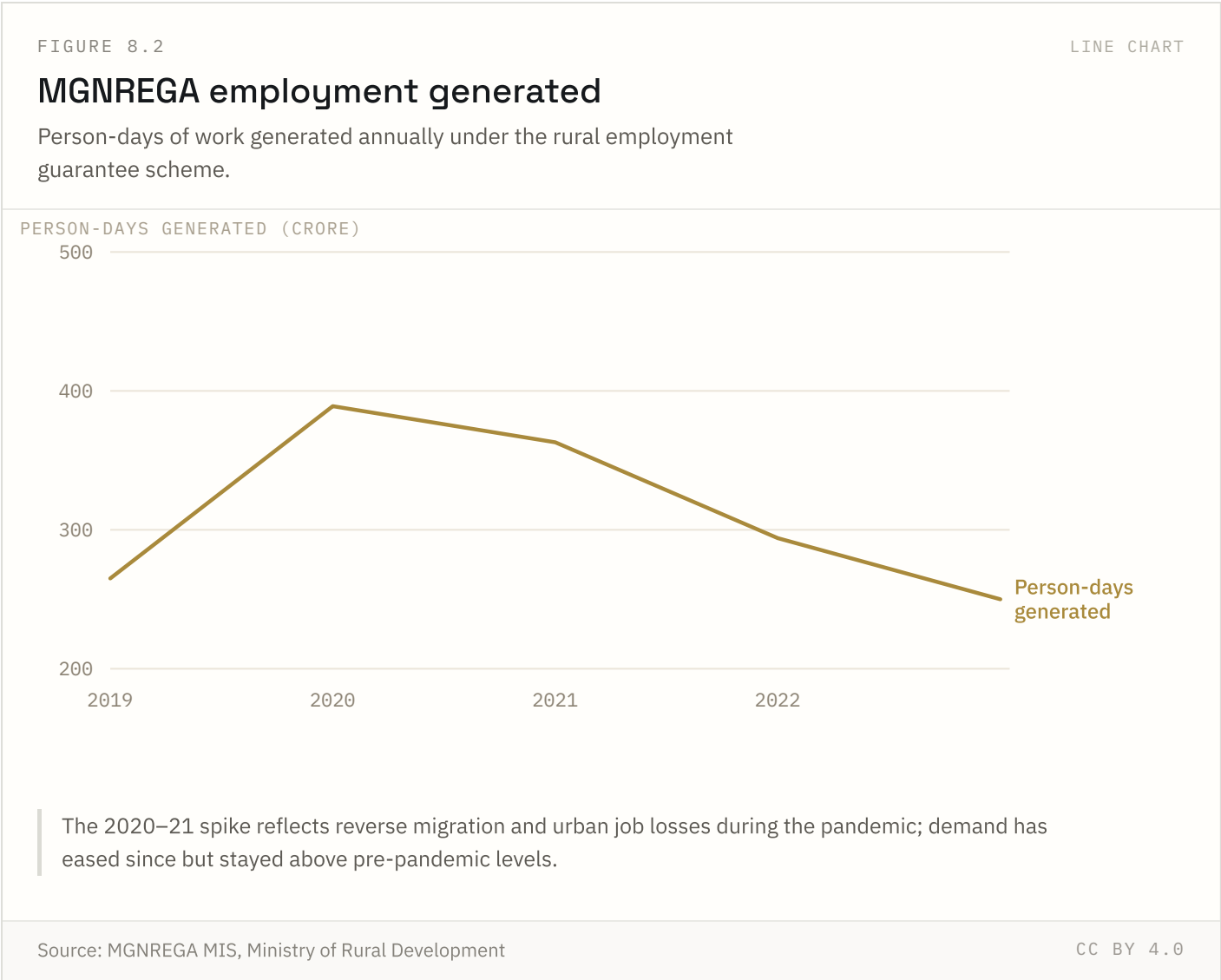
2 of 3 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 8.1 NATIONAL + STATE



Female participation has risen sharply since 2018 on the PLFS usual-status definition, but most of the increase is in unpaid work on family farms and enterprises. Salaried employment for women has grown far more slowly.

FIGURE 8.2 NATIONAL ONLY



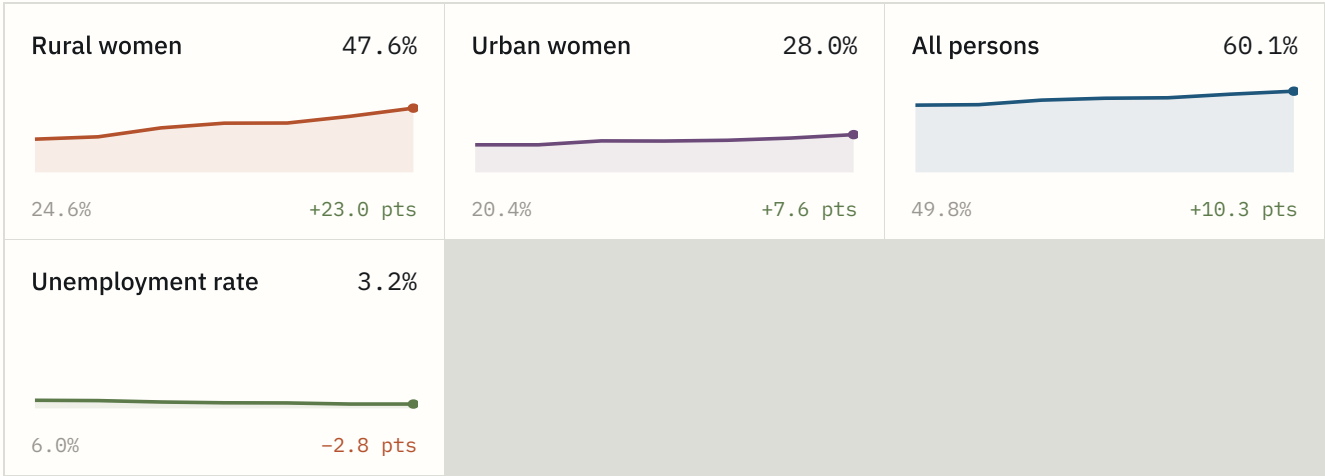
The scheme acts as an automatic stabiliser: person-days jumped 47% in 2020–21 as migrant workers returned to villages during the pandemic, then eased as urban labour markets recovered.

FIGURE 8.3

SMALL MULTIPLES

Labour force participation — small multiples

Four series on one shared 0–65% scale, so the panels can be compared directly.



2017-18 → 2023-24, EACH PANEL ON THE SAME 0-65 % SCALE

Same scale in every panel, so the panels are directly comparable. Rural women drive almost the whole national increase.

Source: PLFS Annual Reports 2017-18 to 2023-24, MoSPI

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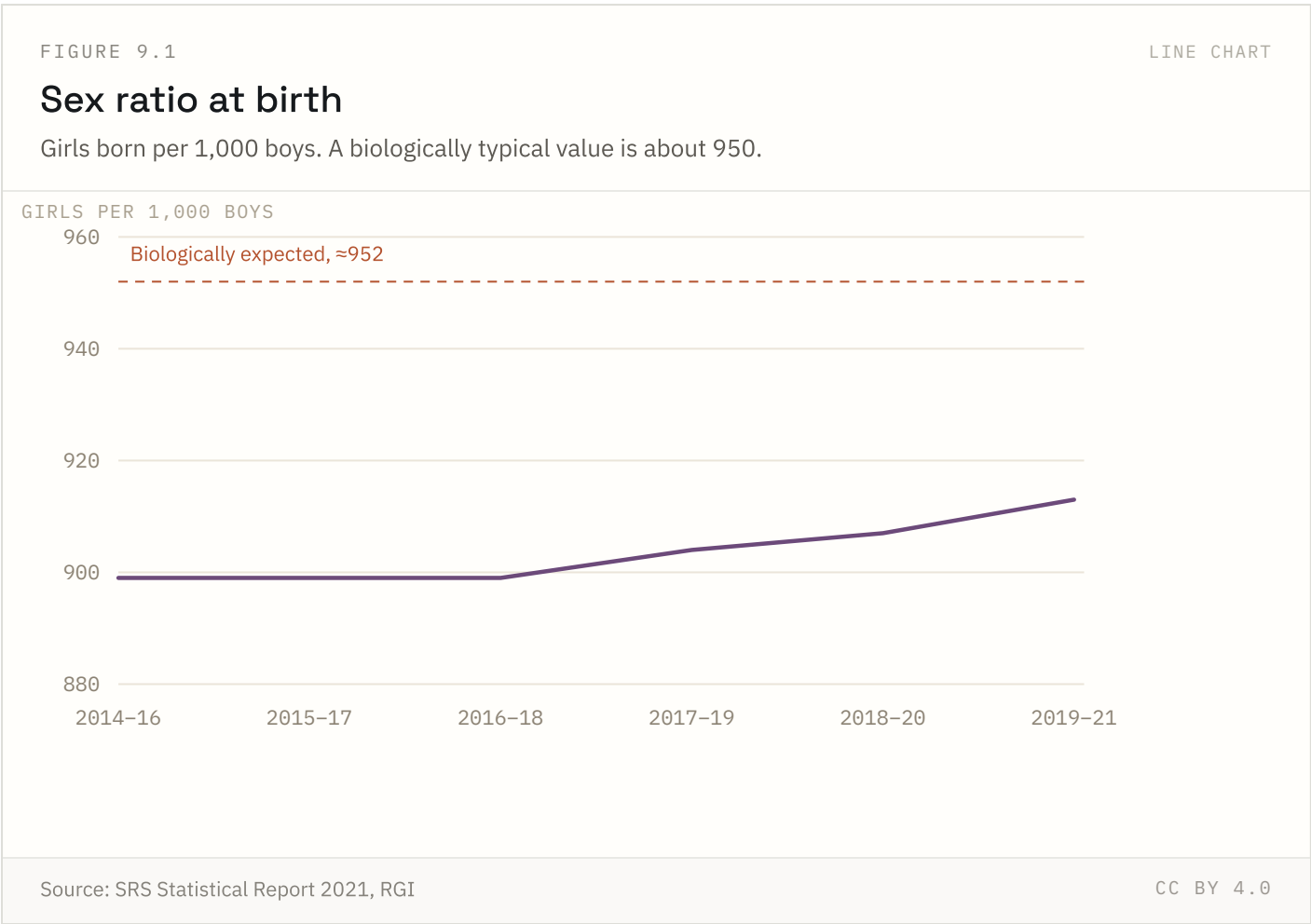
Rural women account for almost the entire national increase: their LFPR nearly doubled from 24.6% to 47.6%, while urban women moved from 20.4% to 28.0%. Part of the change is measurement — PLFS probes unpaid work in family enterprises more carefully than the surveys it replaced.

Source: PLFS Annual Reports 2017-18 to 2023-24, MoSPI Coverage: 2017-18 to 2023-24 Updated: 21 Jul 2026

Gender

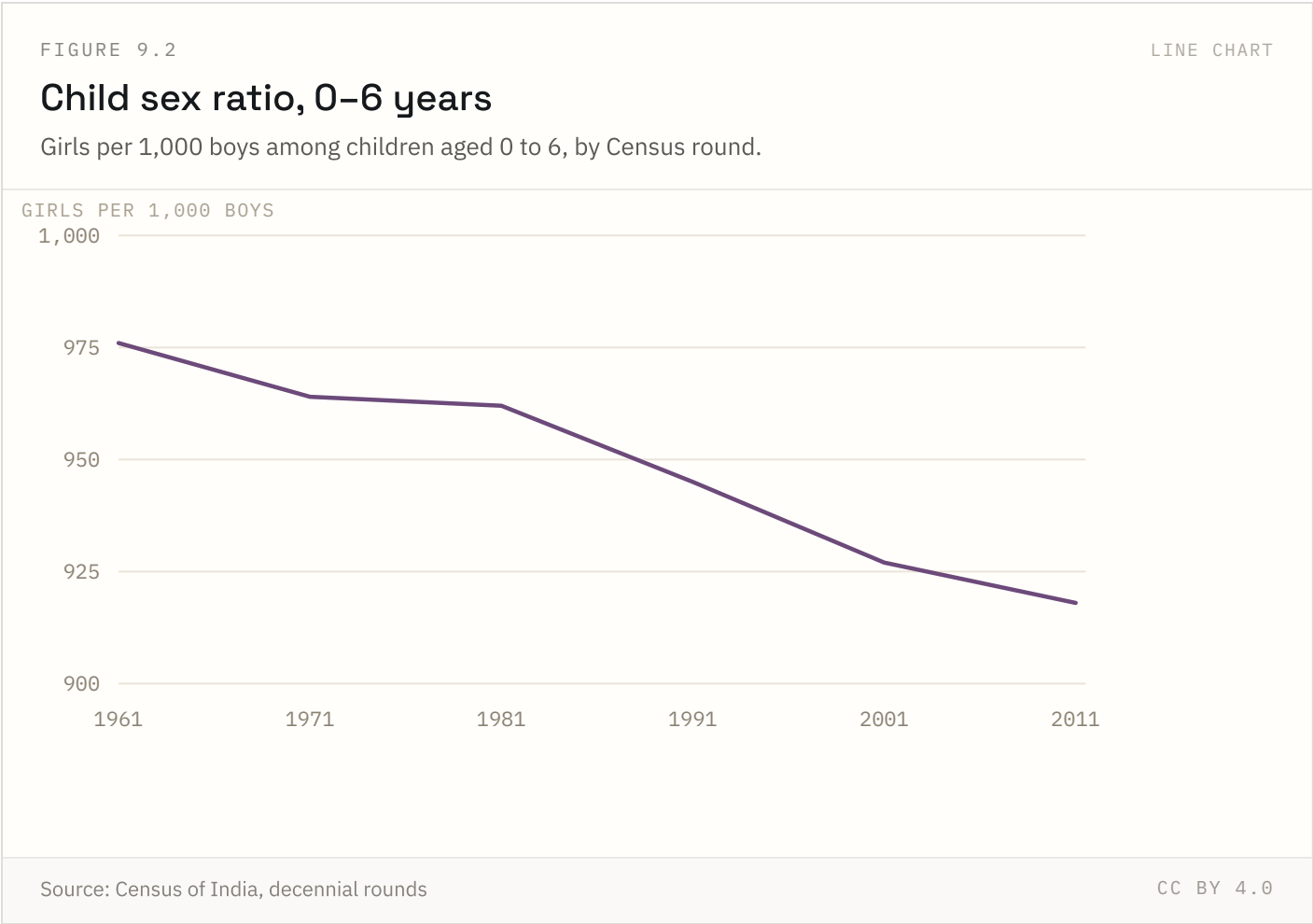
2 of 4 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 9.1 NATIONAL + STATE



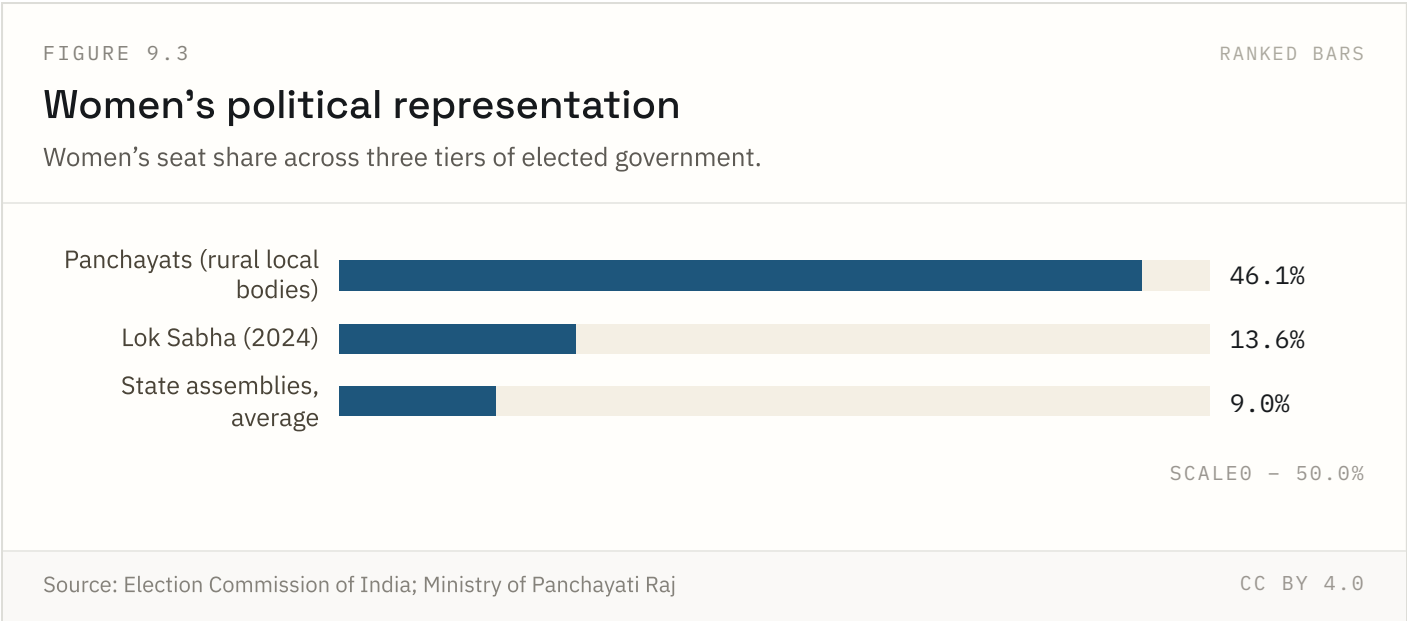
The ratio fell through the 1990s as ultrasound diagnosis spread, bottomed around 2011, and has partially recovered. Recovery is concentrated in Punjab, Haryana and Himachal Pradesh — the states where the deficit was worst.

Source: SRS Statistical Report 2021, RGI Coverage: 1991-2023 Updated: 21 Jul 2026



The child sex ratio fell in every round from 1961 to 2011, most sharply in the 1990s as ultrasound diagnosis spread. Unlike the sex ratio at birth, it also absorbs excess female mortality in early childhood.

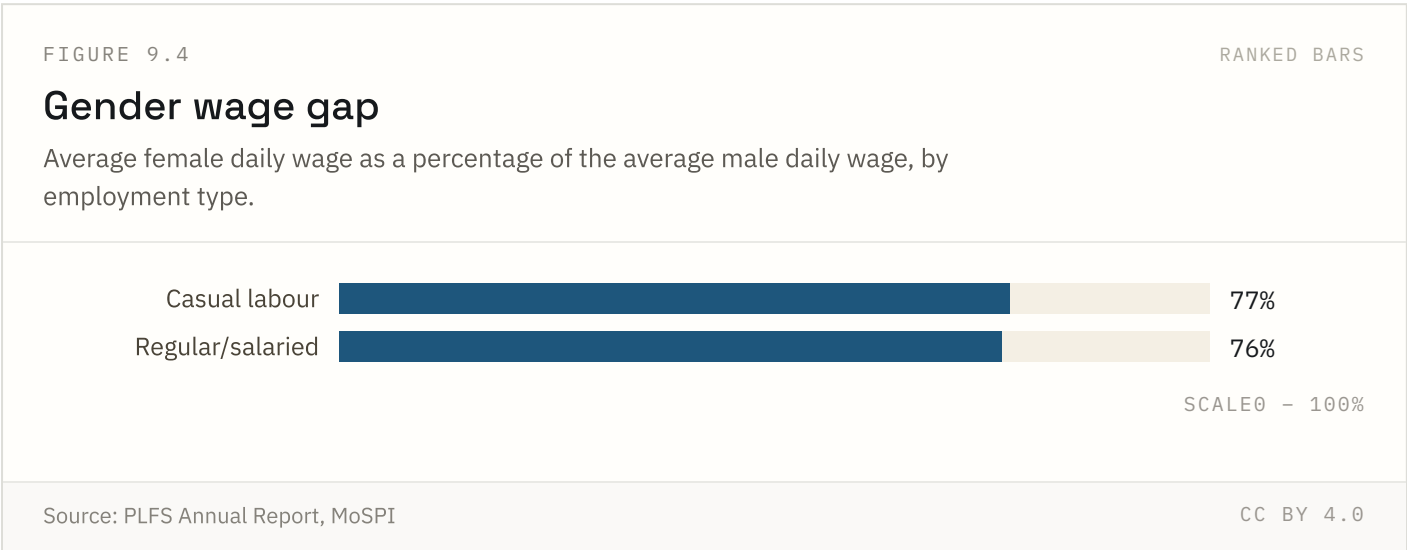
FIGURE 9.3 NATIONAL ONLY



Constitutional reservation (33–50% depending on state) drives the far higher Panchayat figure; no equivalent reservation exists yet for the Lok Sabha or most state assemblies, though a Women’s Reservation Act passed in 2023 is due to apply from the next delimitation.

Source: Election Commission of India; Ministry of Panchayati Raj Coverage: 2024 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 9.4 NATIONAL ONLY



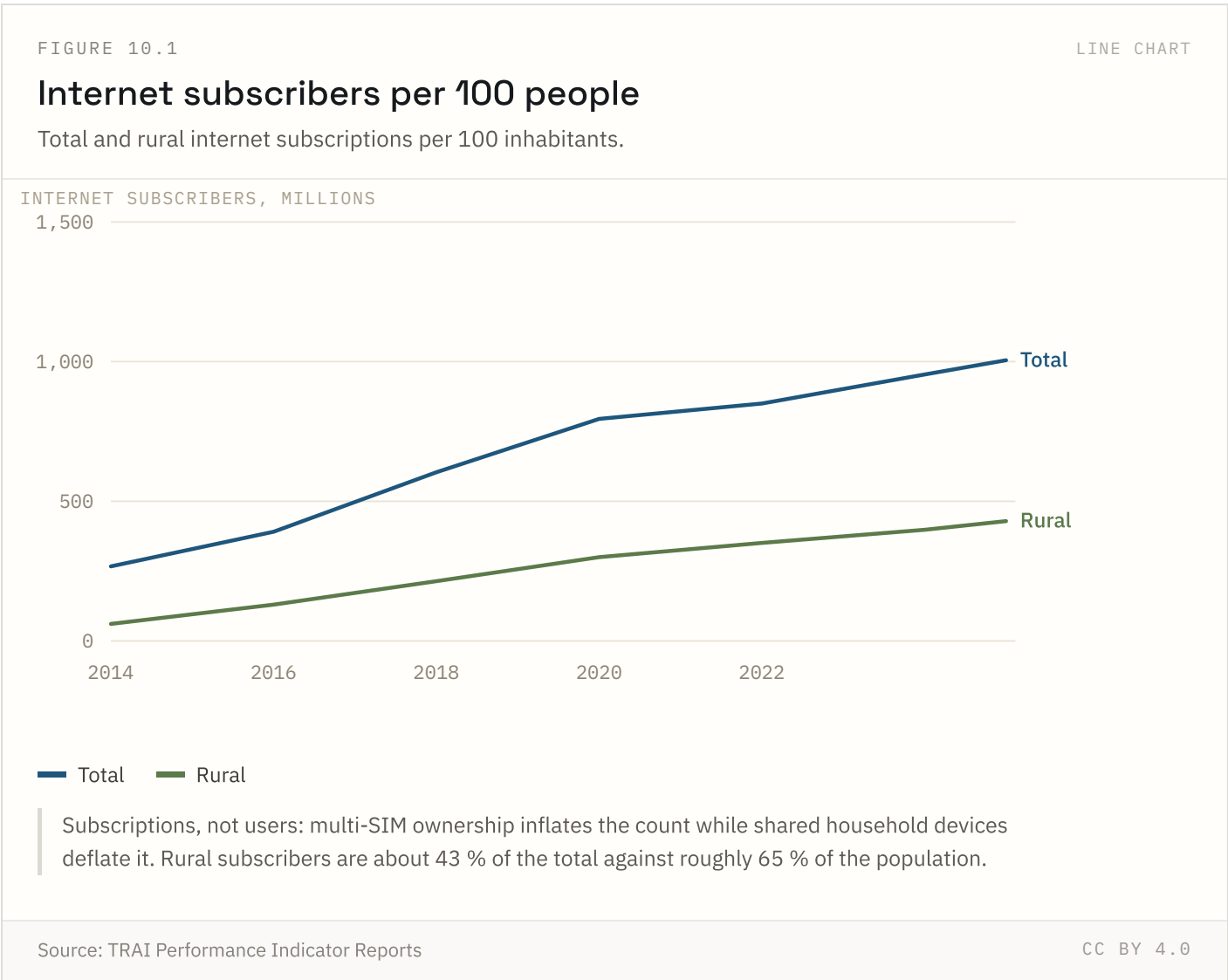
The gap has narrowed slowly over the past decade but persists across both casual and regular/salaried work, even after accounting for differences in sector and hours — unexplained gaps of this kind are consistent with occupational segregation and direct wage discrimination.

Source: PLFS Annual Report, MoSPI Coverage: 2023–24 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

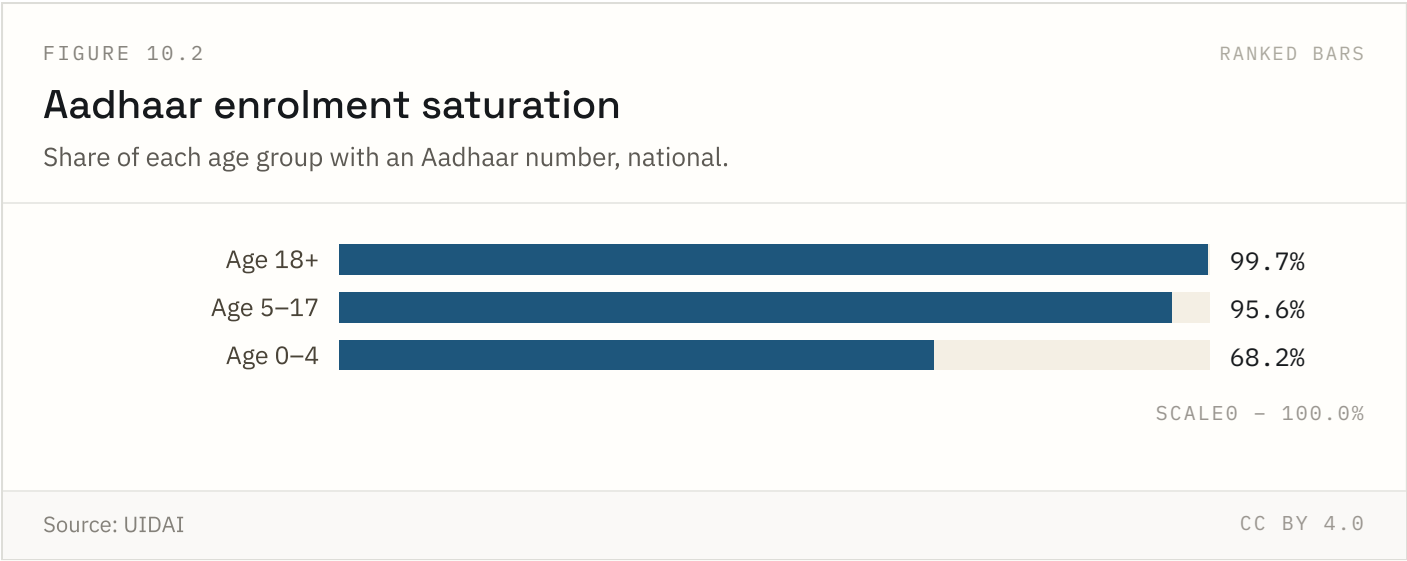
Digital & internet access

1 of 3 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 10.1 NATIONAL + STATE

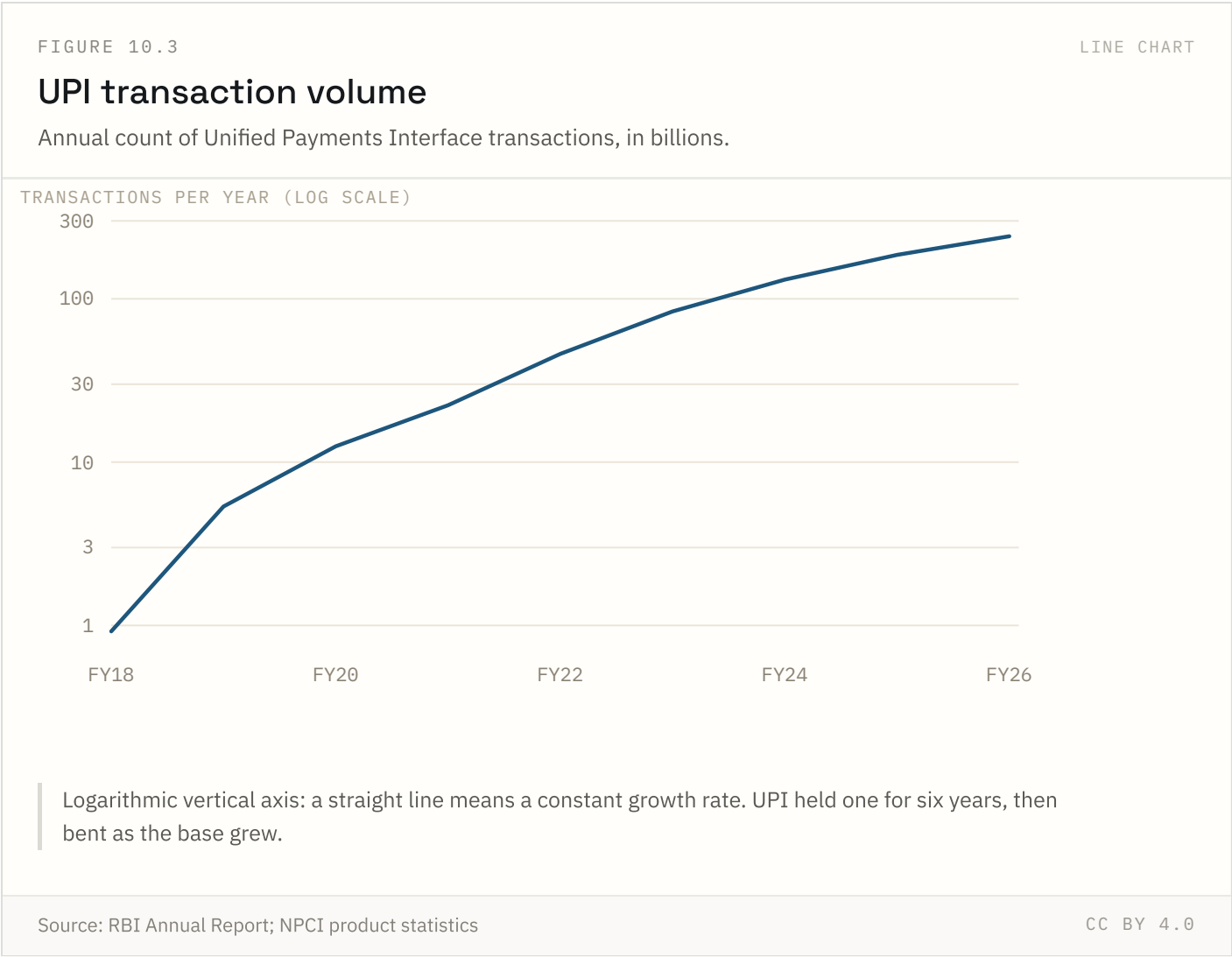


Subscriptions are not users: multi-SIM ownership inflates the numerator, while shared household devices deflate it. The rural–urban gap has narrowed since 2016 but remains roughly 30 points.



Saturation is near-complete for adults, the population that matters most for financial and welfare access. The lower figure for children under 5 mostly reflects a lag between birth and enrolment, not a policy gap — Aadhaar is issued from birth on parental consent.

FIGURE 10.3 NATIONAL ONLY

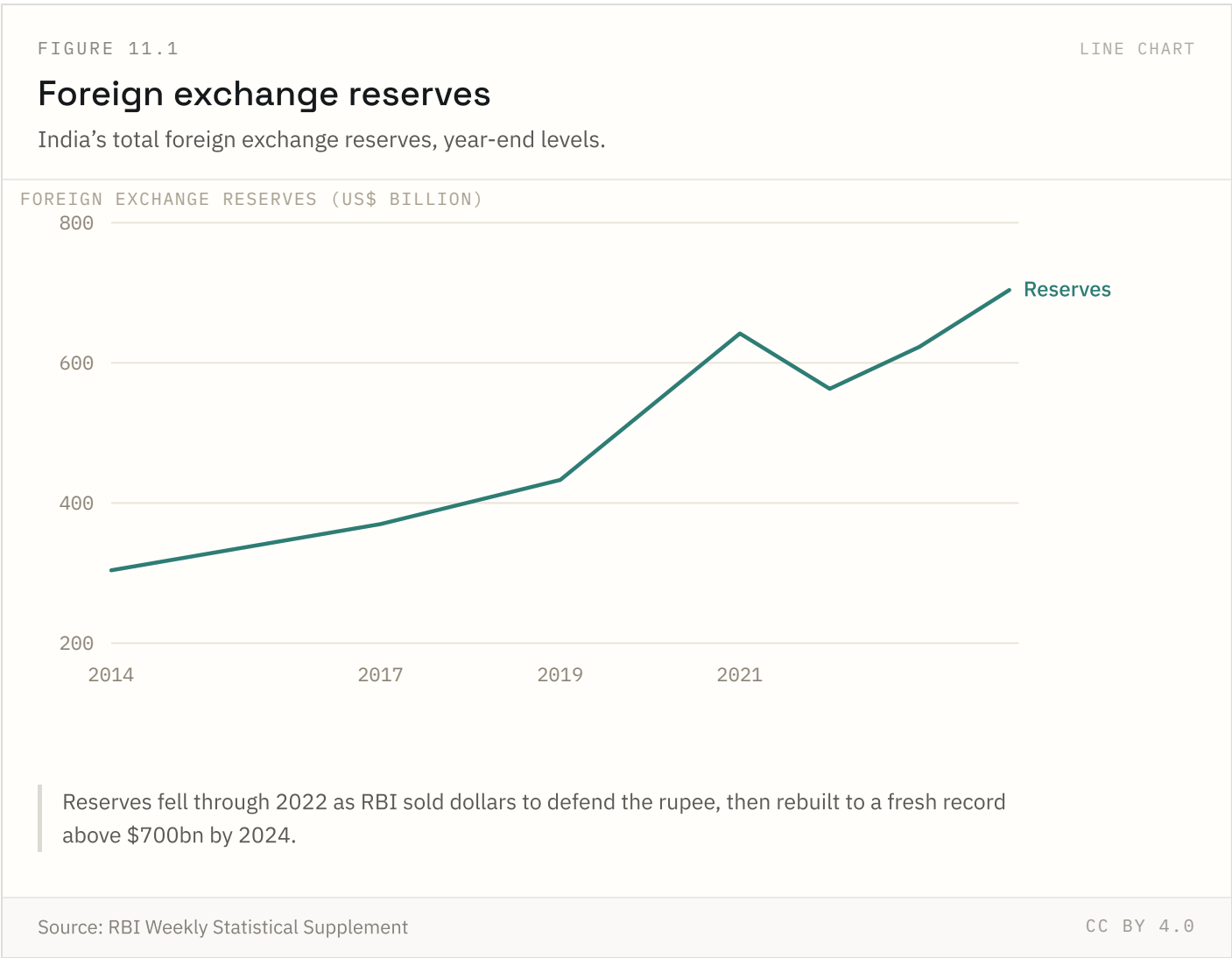


UPI passed 200 billion transactions a year within eight years of launch, making it the largest real-time retail payment system in the world by count. Average ticket size has fallen steadily as usage moved to small merchant payments.

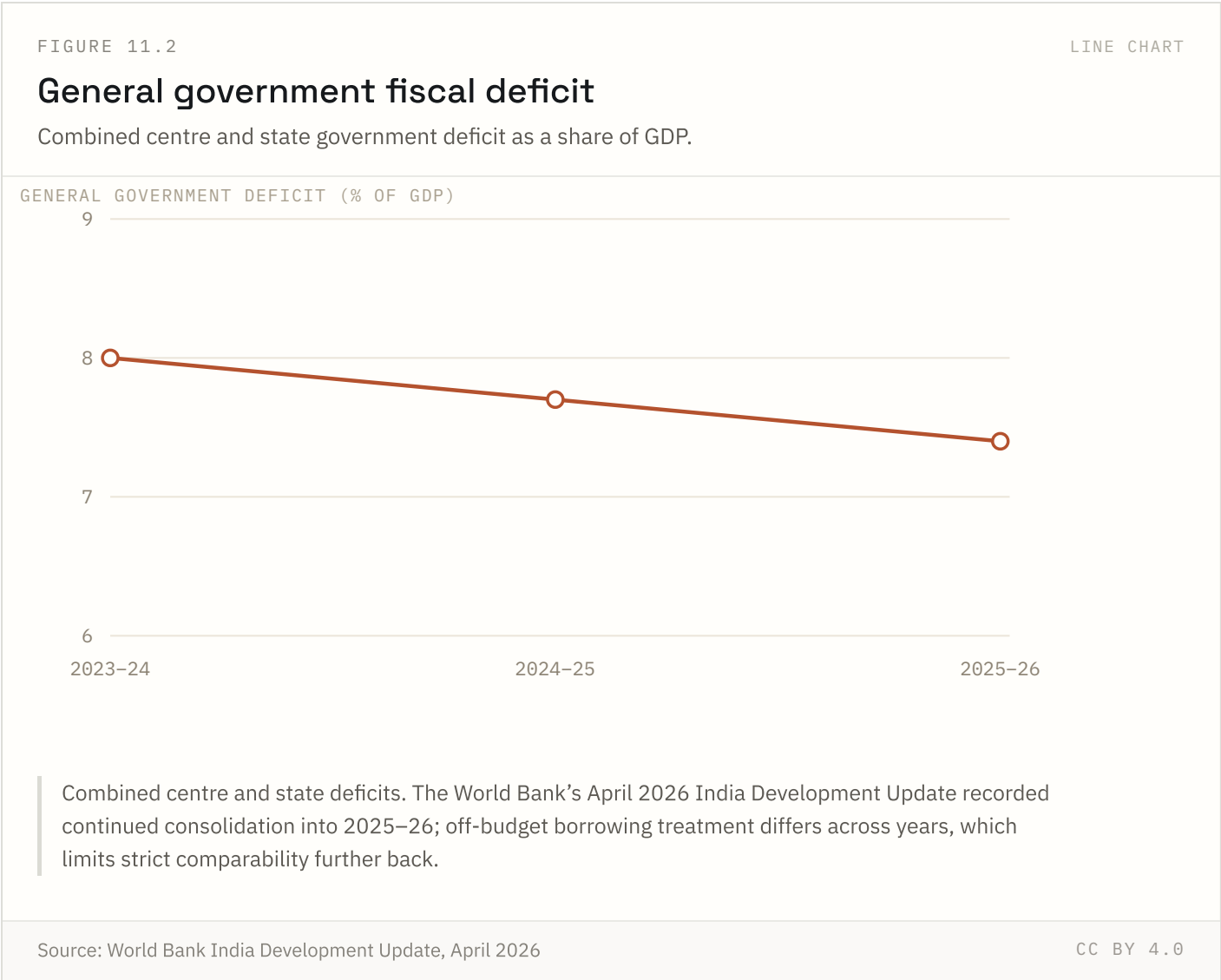
Economy & finance

1 of 13 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 11.1 NATIONAL ONLY

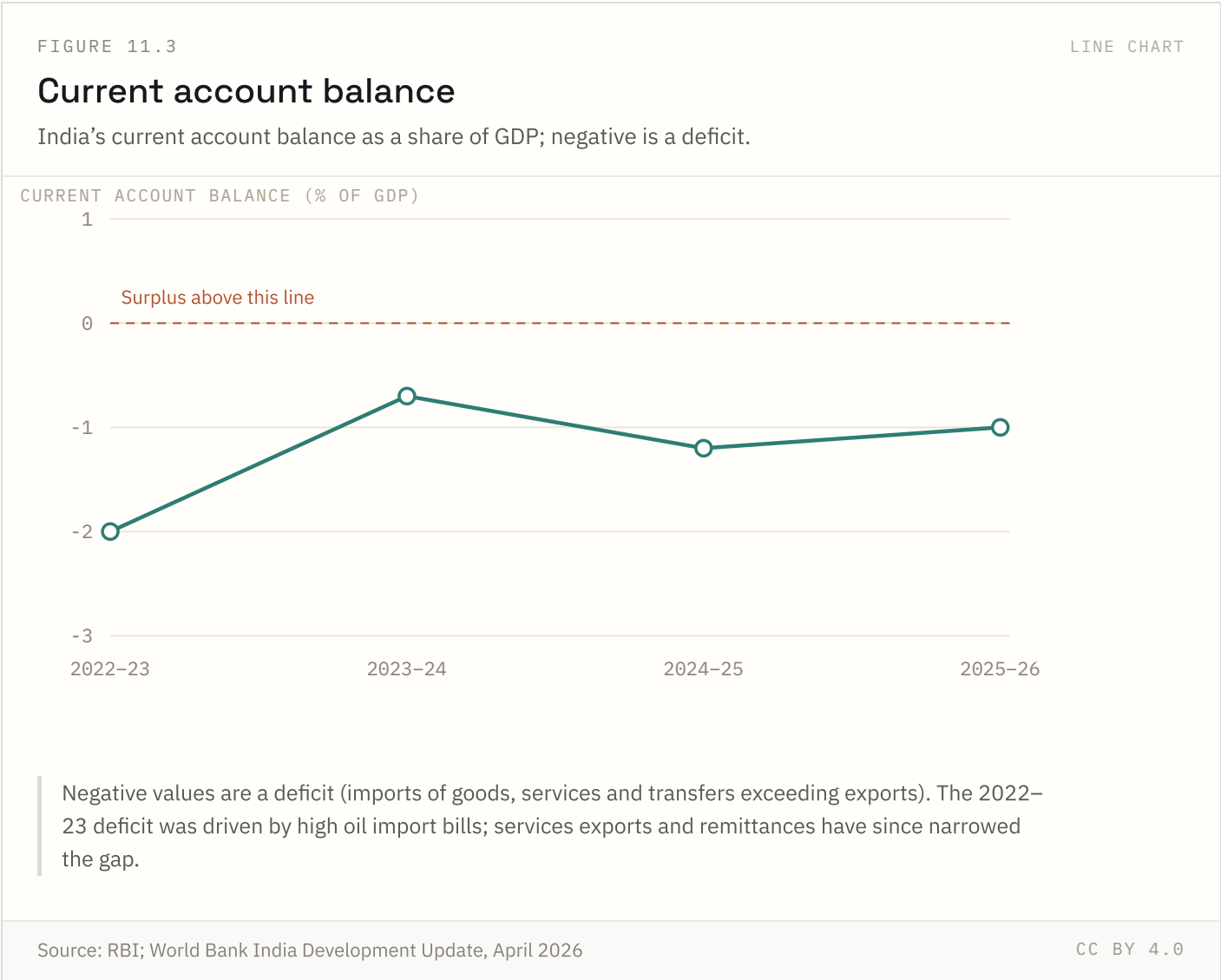


Reserves fell through 2022 as the RBI sold dollars to slow the rupee’s depreciation, then rebuilt past \$700 billion by 2024 — among the largest reserve stockpiles of any country.



The deficit has narrowed for three straight years as the centre held to its fiscal consolidation path and states’ combined deficit stayed stable. Off-budget borrowing is treated inconsistently across years and agencies, which can shift the level without a real change in underlying fiscal stance.

FIGURE 11.3 NATIONAL ONLY

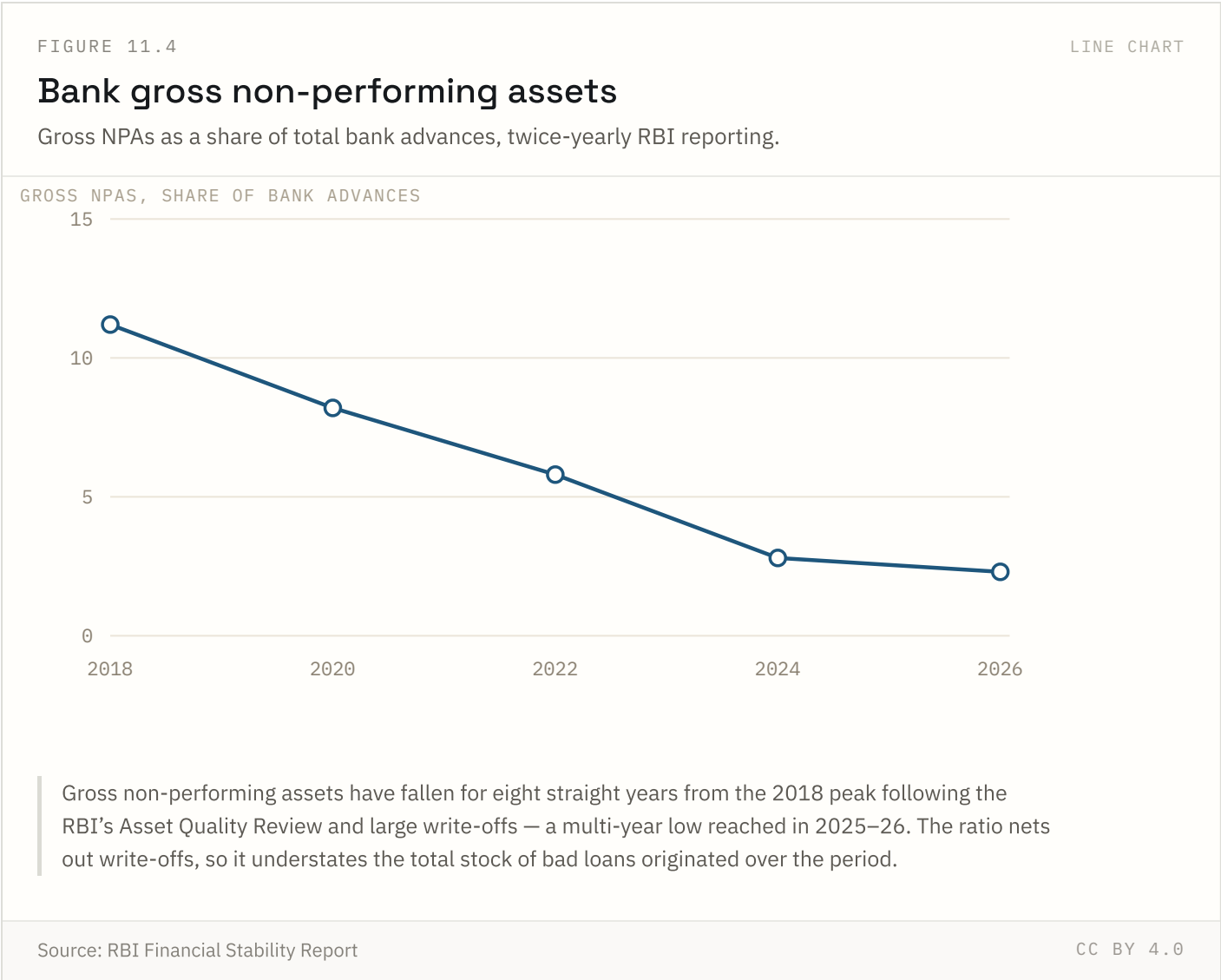


The 2022–23 deficit peaked on a high oil import bill; strong services exports and remittance inflows have since kept the deficit comfortably financeable. A current account deficit is normal for a fast-growing economy importing capital goods and energy.

Source: RBI; World Bank India Development Update, April 2026 Coverage: 2022–23 to 2025–26

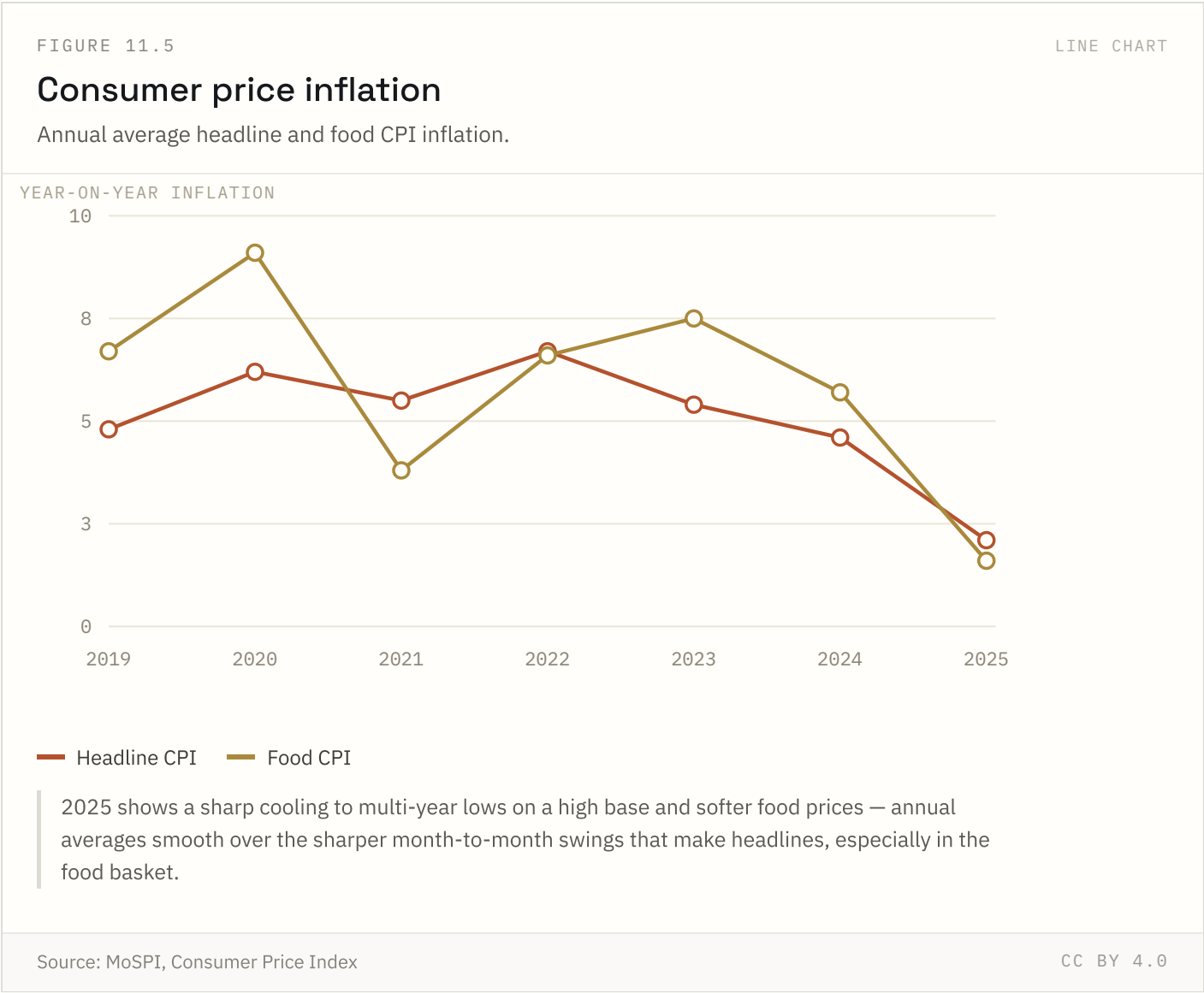
Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 11.4 NATIONAL ONLY



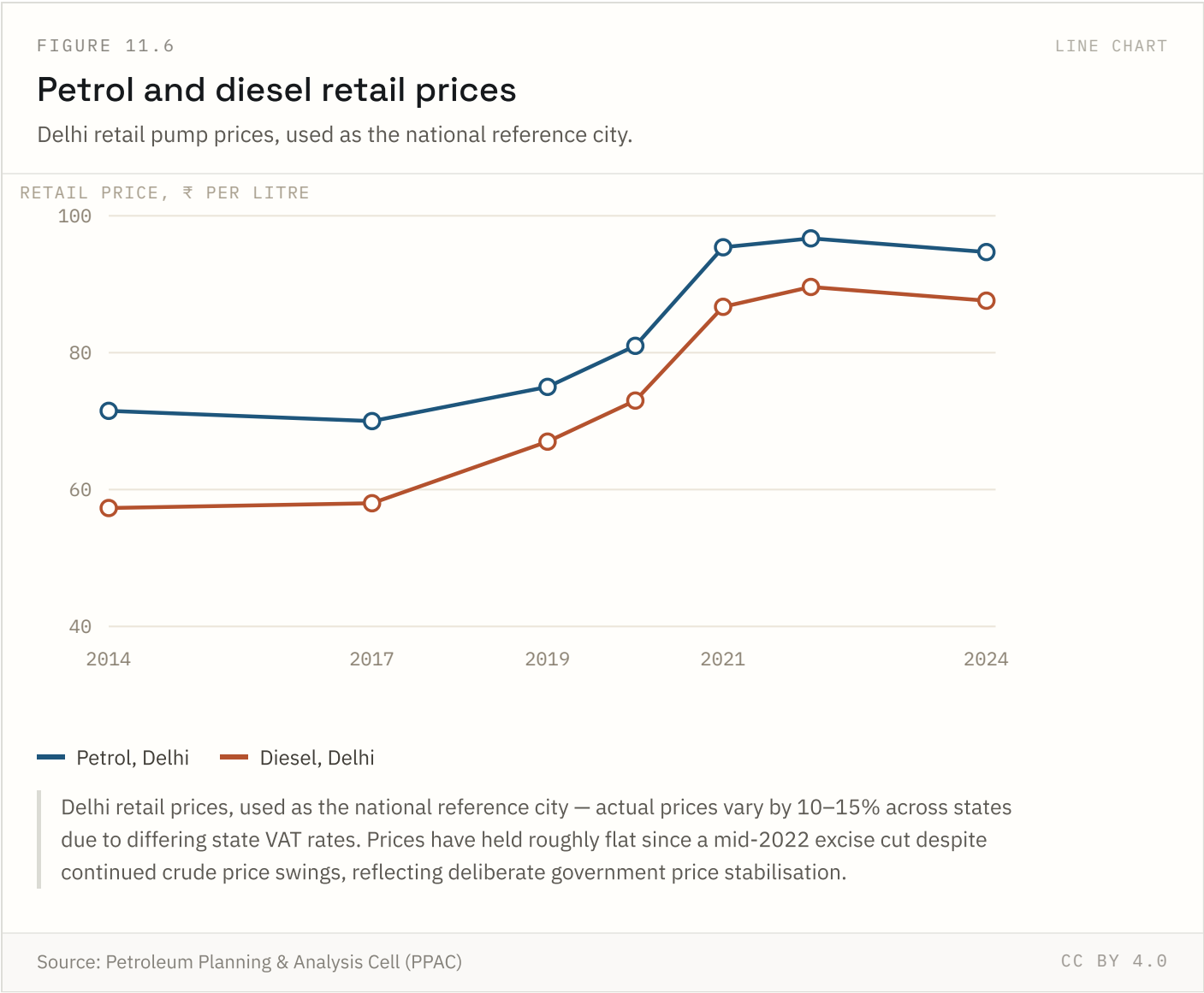
The ratio has fallen every year since the 2018 peak that followed the RBI’s Asset Quality Review, helped by large write-offs and improved recovery under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code. A falling ratio reflects both fewer new bad loans and banks removing old ones from the book, so it is not a pure flow measure.

FIGURE 11.5 NATIONAL ONLY

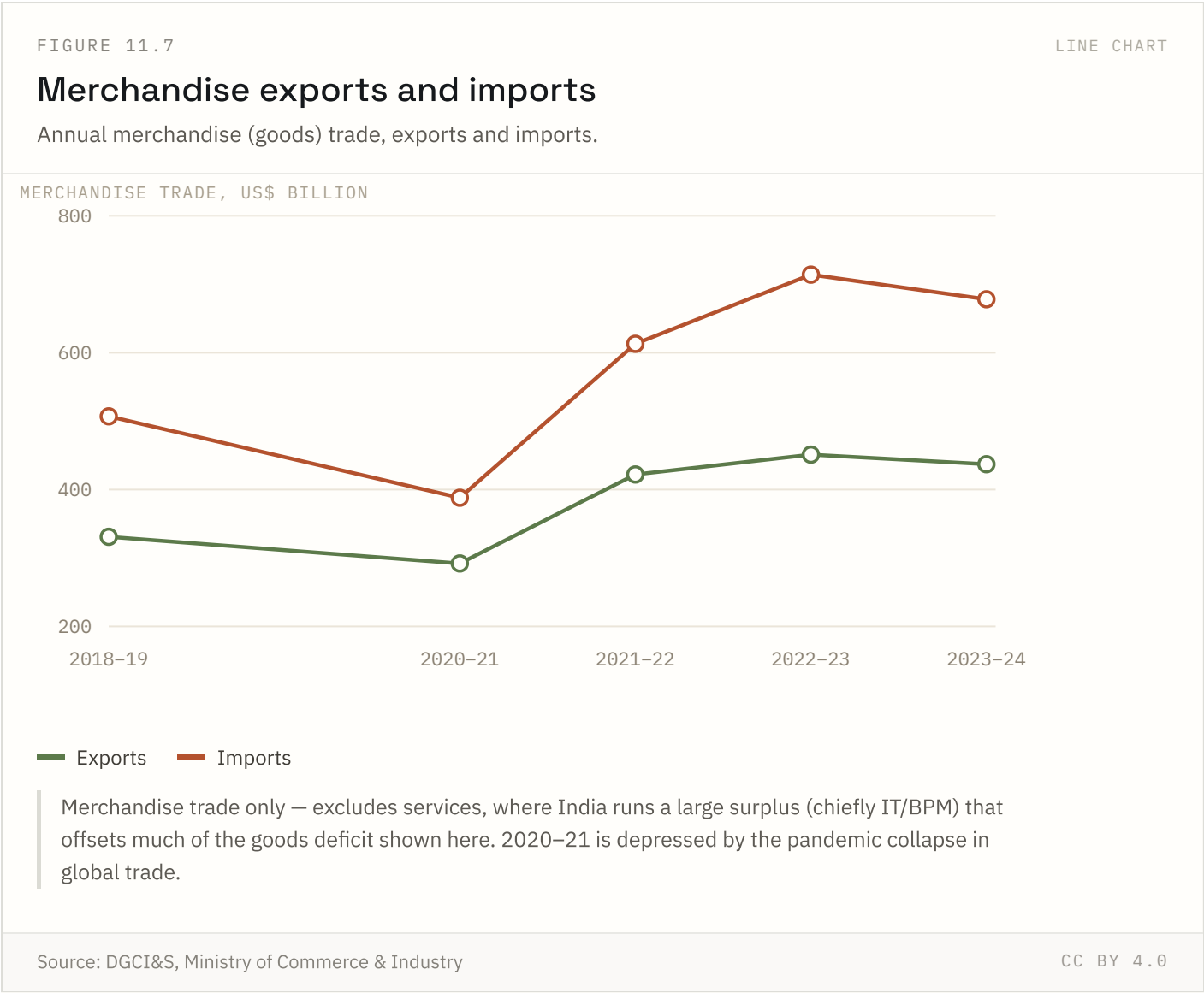


Food inflation runs more volatile than the headline rate in both directions, since it is exposed to monsoon shocks and global commodity swings that core inflation is not. Annual averages mask sharper month-to-month spikes, particularly around vegetable price shocks.

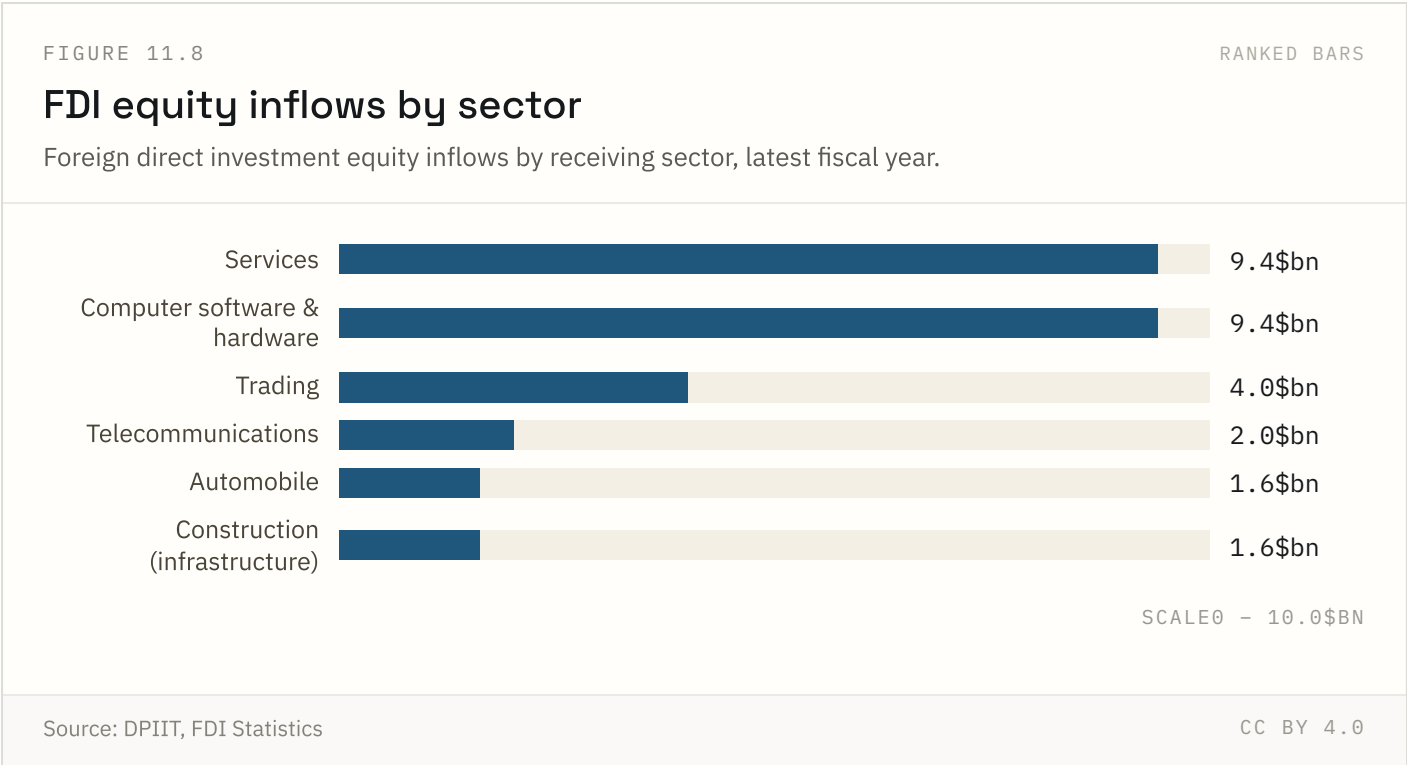
FIGURE 11.6 NATIONAL ONLY



Retail prices are a mix of global crude prices, the rupee exchange rate, and state and central taxes — taxes make up roughly 40% of the pump price. Prices have barely moved since mid-2022 despite crude volatility, a deliberate stabilisation choice rather than a market outcome.

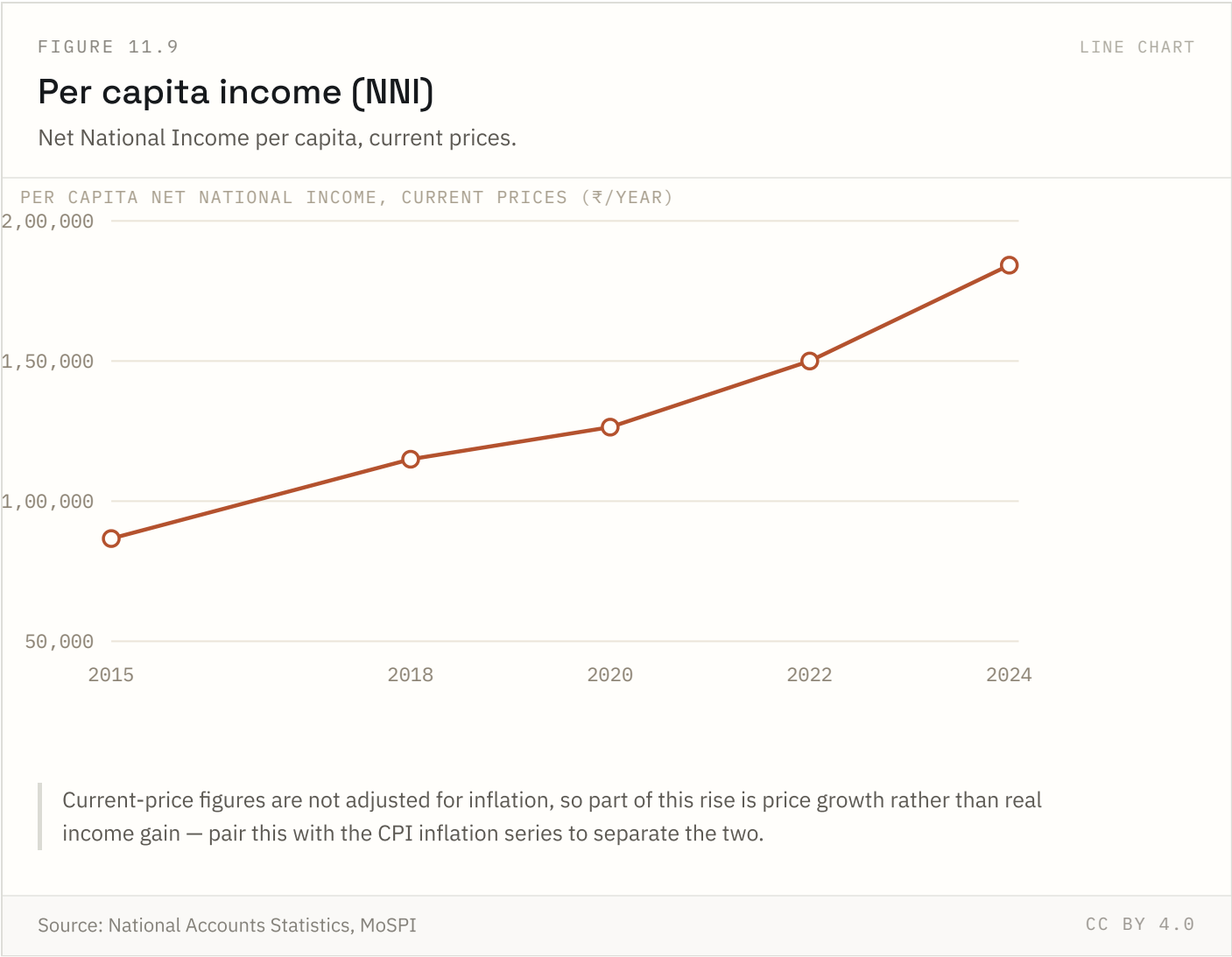


India runs a persistent merchandise trade deficit, financed in large part by a services trade surplus (led by IT/BPM exports) not shown here. The 2022-23 and 2023-24 import bills were pushed up by elevated global energy prices.

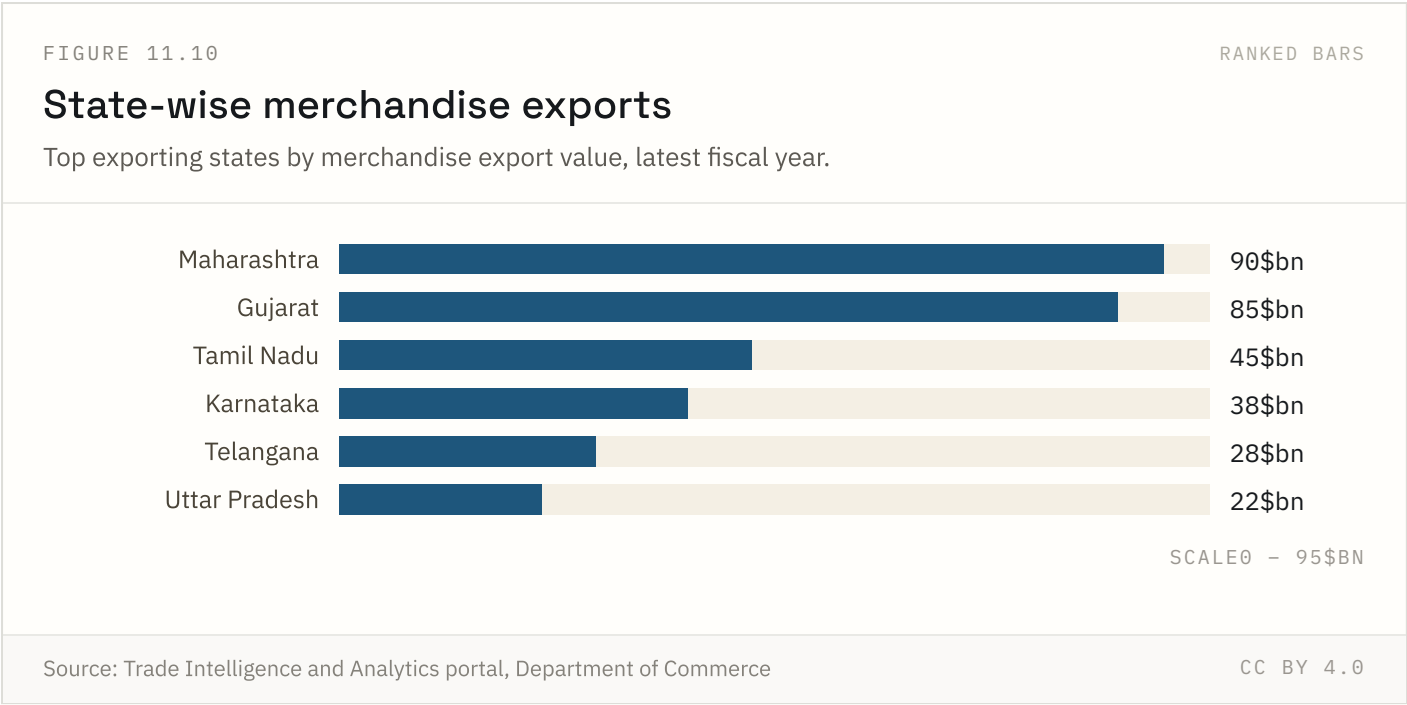


Services and computer software/hardware together draw in roughly as much FDI as the next four sectors combined, reflecting India’s pull for global capability centres and SaaS investment over manufacturing FDI. Reinvested earnings and other capital, tracked separately by DPIIT, are excluded.

FIGURE 11.9 NATIONAL ONLY



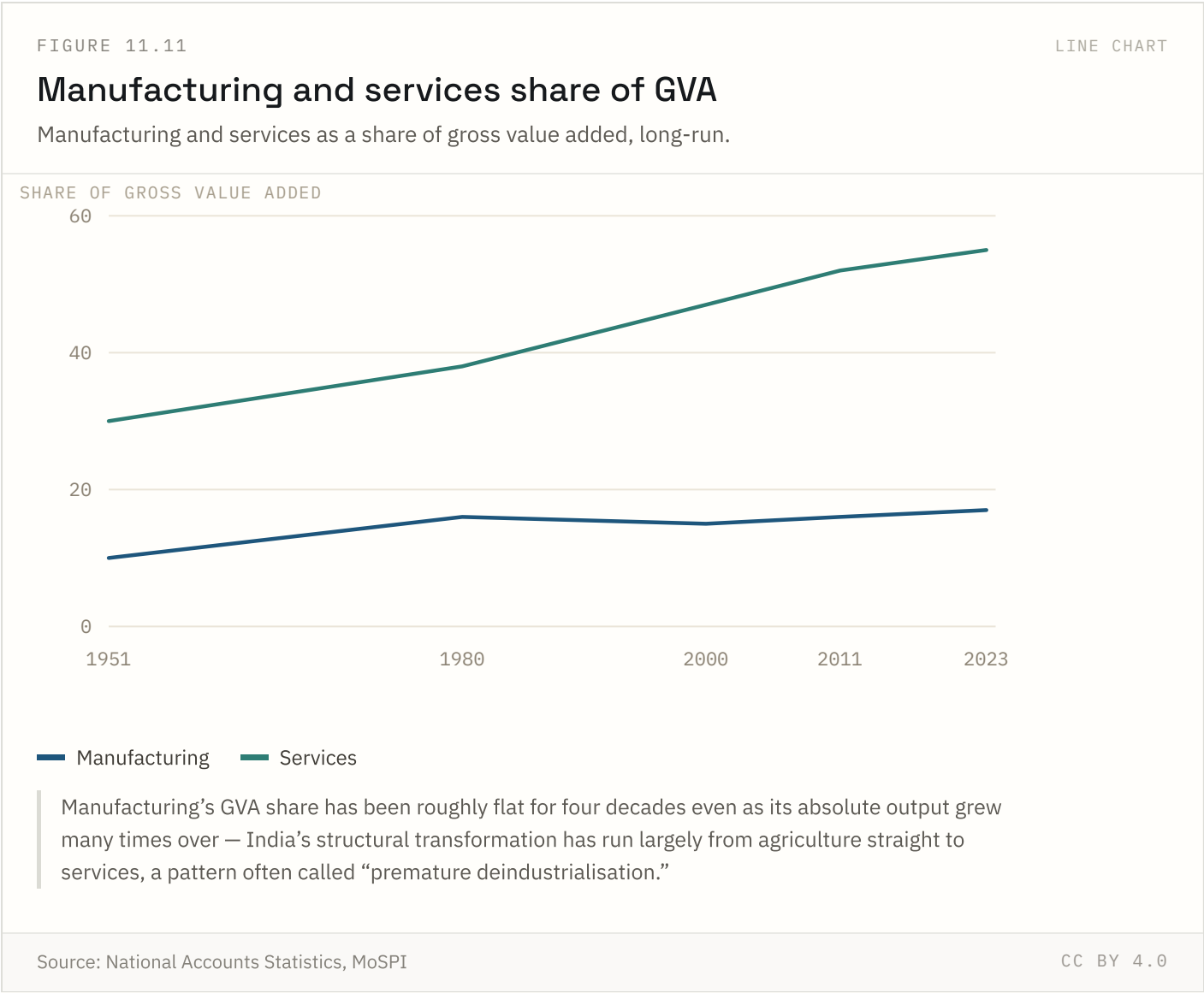
This translates aggregate GDP growth into a per-person figure, though as a national average it says nothing about distribution — pair it with the MPCE and Gini series in Poverty & incomes to see how income and consumption are actually shared.



Maharashtra and Gujarat together export more than the next four states combined, reflecting concentrated port access and established manufacturing and chemicals clusters — export capacity remains far more geographically concentrated than population or GDP.

Highest: **Maharashtra** at 90\$bn. Lowest: **Uttar Pradesh** at 22\$bn.

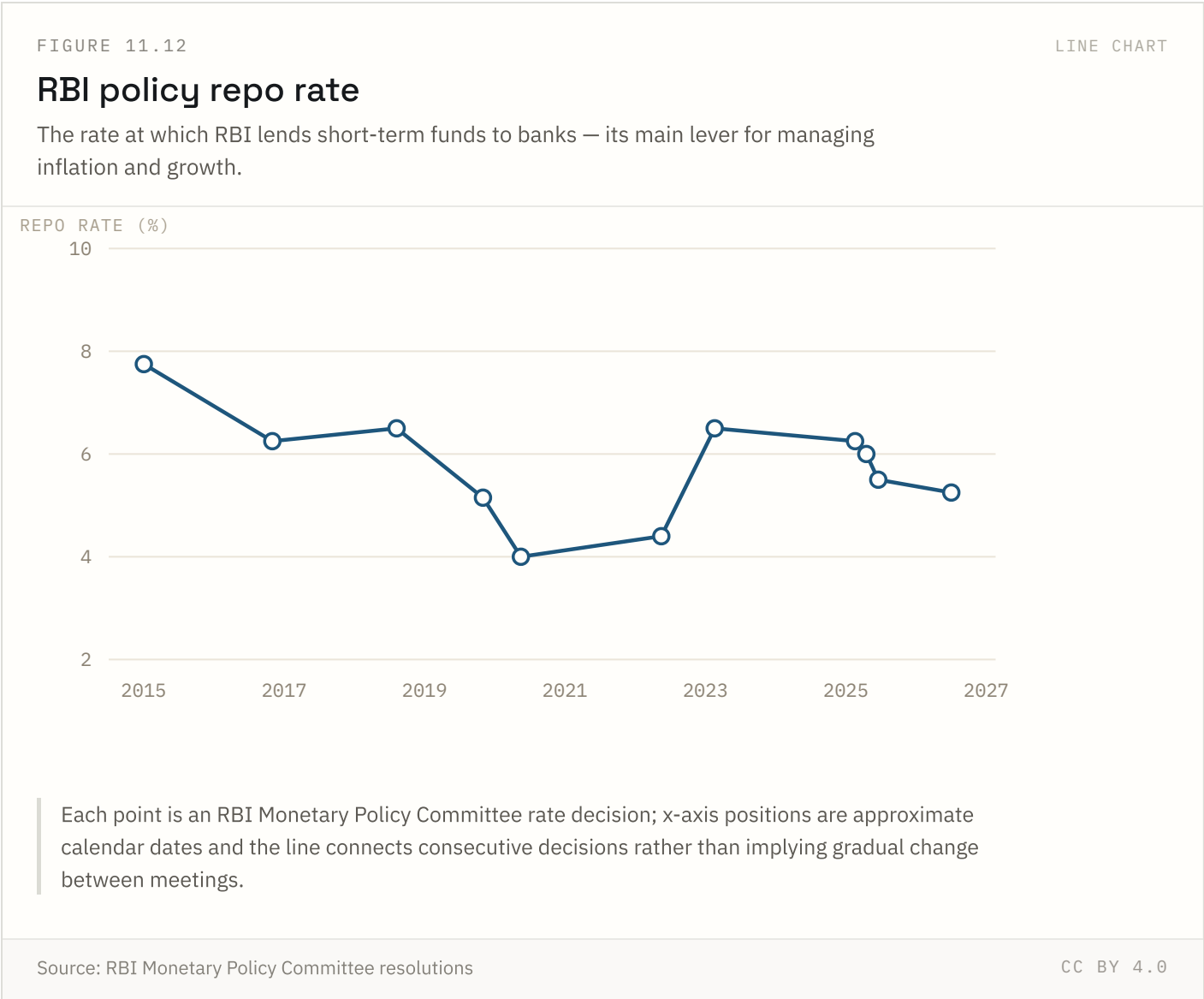
FIGURE 11.11 NATIONAL ONLY



Pairs with the Agriculture & food topic’s GVA-share chart to complete the picture: India’s economy moved from agriculture-dominated to services-dominated with manufacturing’s share barely moving — a structural pattern quite different from China’s manufacturing-led transition.

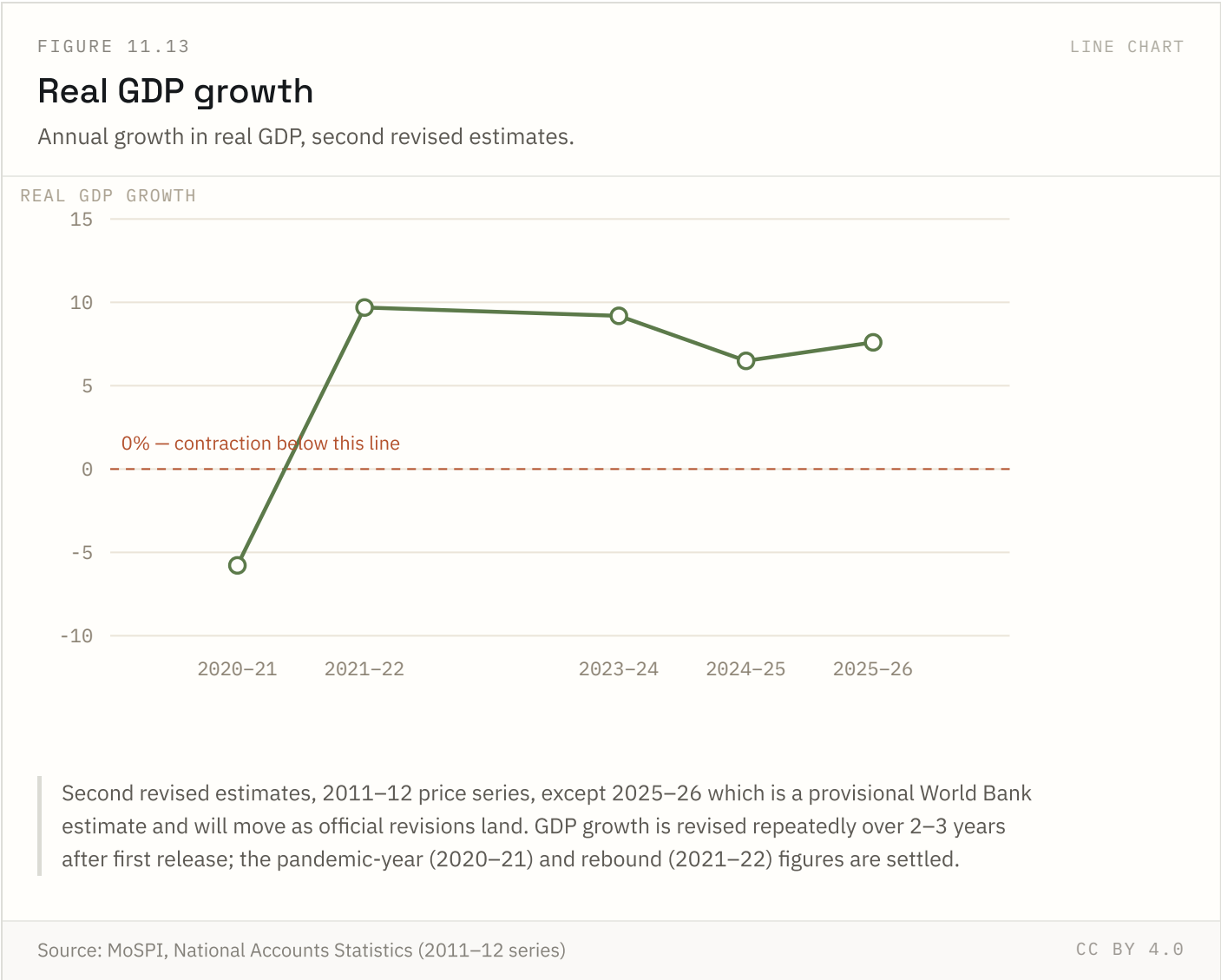
Source: National Accounts Statistics, MoSPI Coverage: 1951–2023 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 11.12 NATIONAL ONLY



Each point is an actual policy decision, not a smoothed average. The rate fell to a historic low of 4.00% during the pandemic, then rose 250 basis points across 2022–23 to fight inflation, and has eased since early 2025 as inflation moderated.

FIGURE 11.13 NATIONAL ONLY



GDP estimates are revised repeatedly over two to three years after first release. The 2020–21 contraction and 2021–22 rebound are now settled figures; 2023–24 and 2024–25 may still move in future revisions.

Source: MoSPI, National Accounts Statistics (2011–12 series) Coverage: 2020–21 to 2024–25

Updated: 16 Aug 2026

Governance & safety

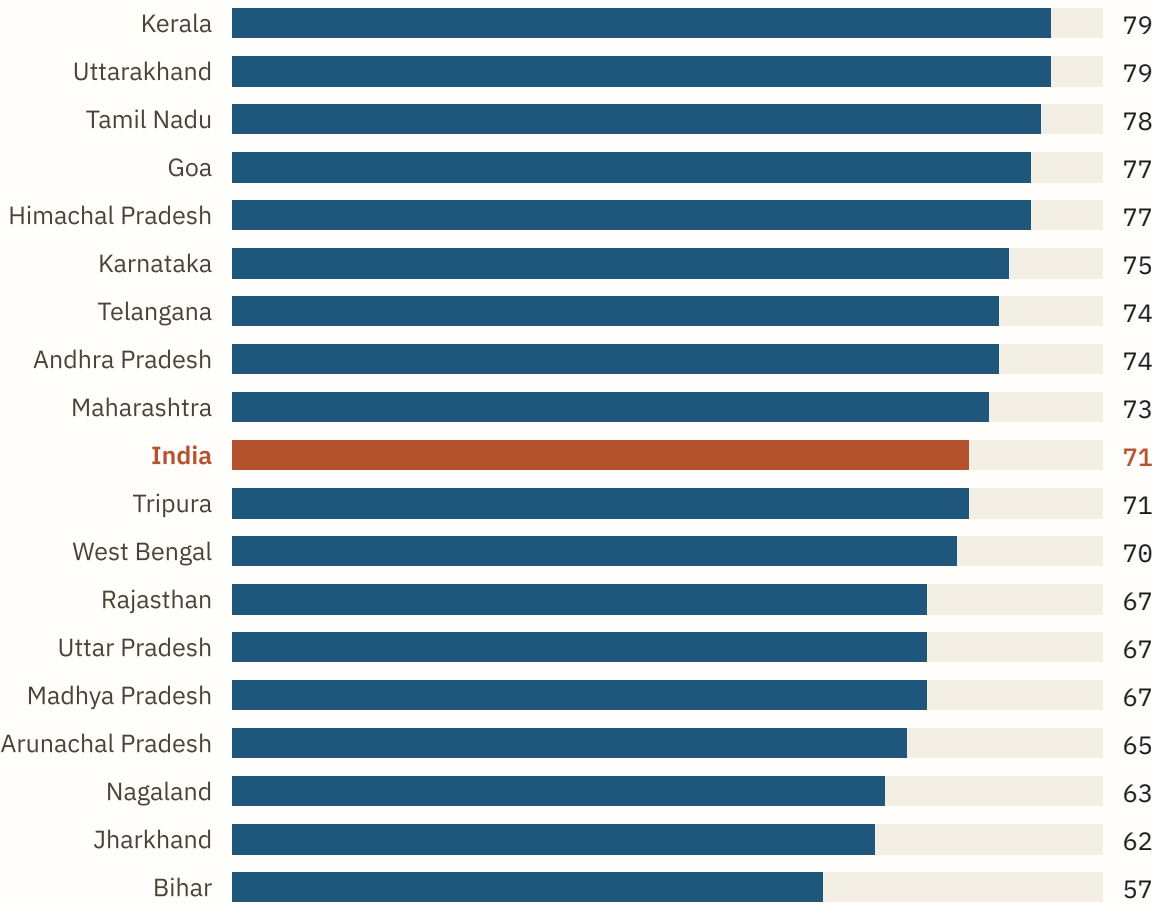
3 of 5 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 12.1

RANKED BARS

SDG India Index by state

State and UT composite scores, 2023–24 edition. The national figure is shown in rust.



SCALE 0 – 84

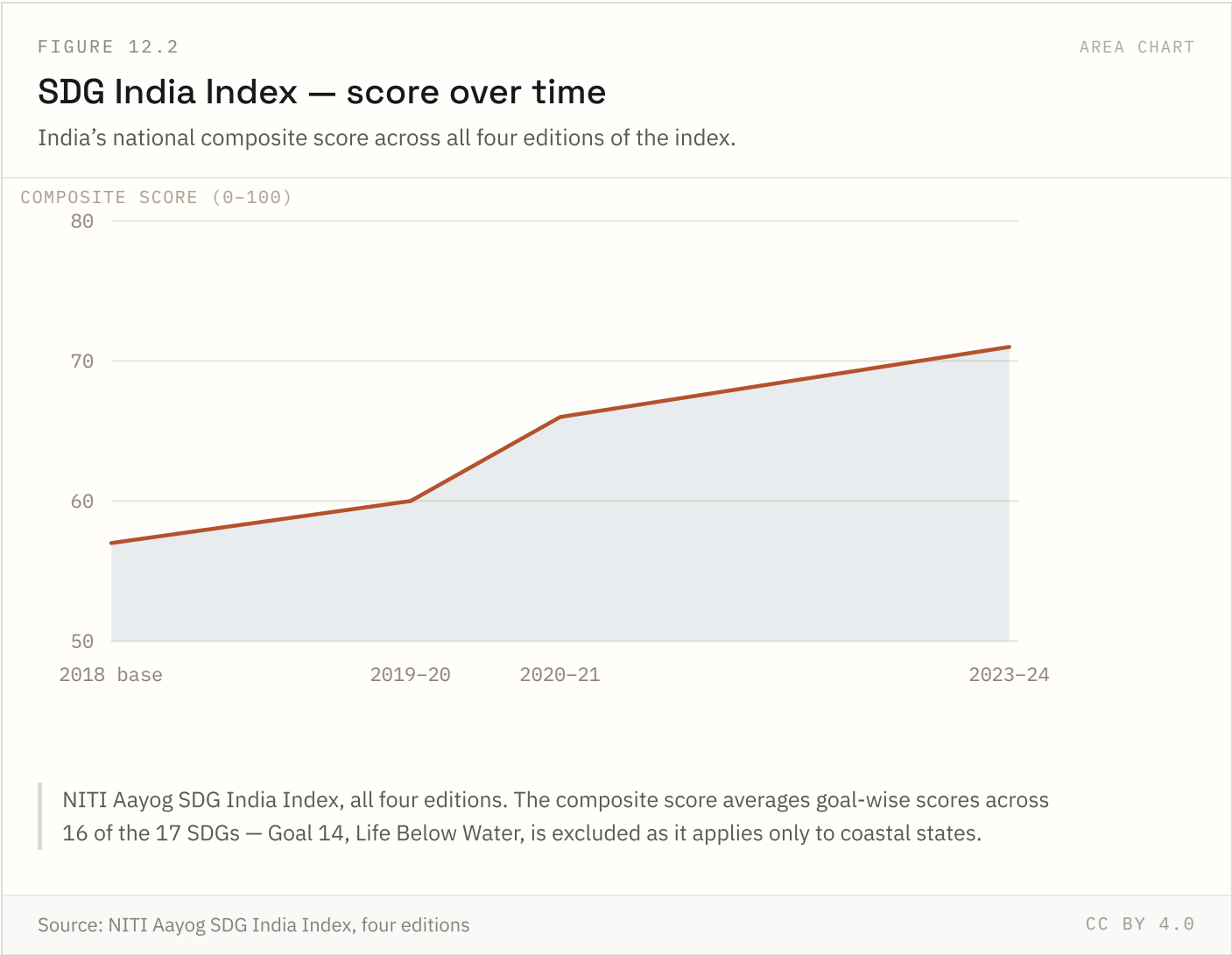
SDG India Index 2023–24. Uttar Pradesh recorded the largest gain of any state since the 2018 baseline, up 25 points, though it still scores at the national average.

Source: NITI Aayog SDG India Index 2023–24

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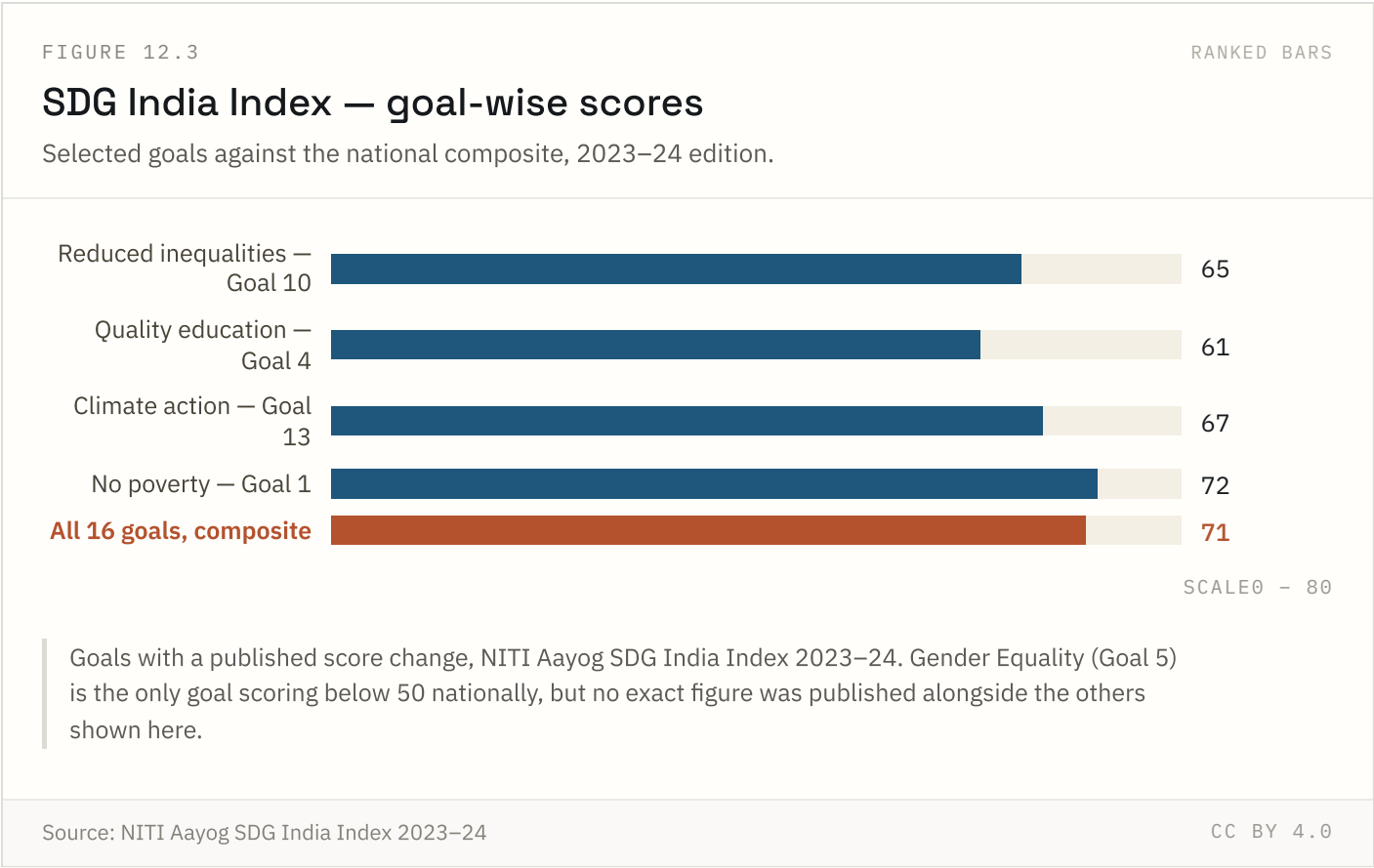
Kerala and Uttarakhand share the top rank at 79; Bihar is lowest at 57. Uttar Pradesh posted the largest improvement of any state since the 2018 baseline, gaining 25 points, though it remains at the national average.

Highest: **Kerala** at 79. Lowest: **Bihar** at 57.



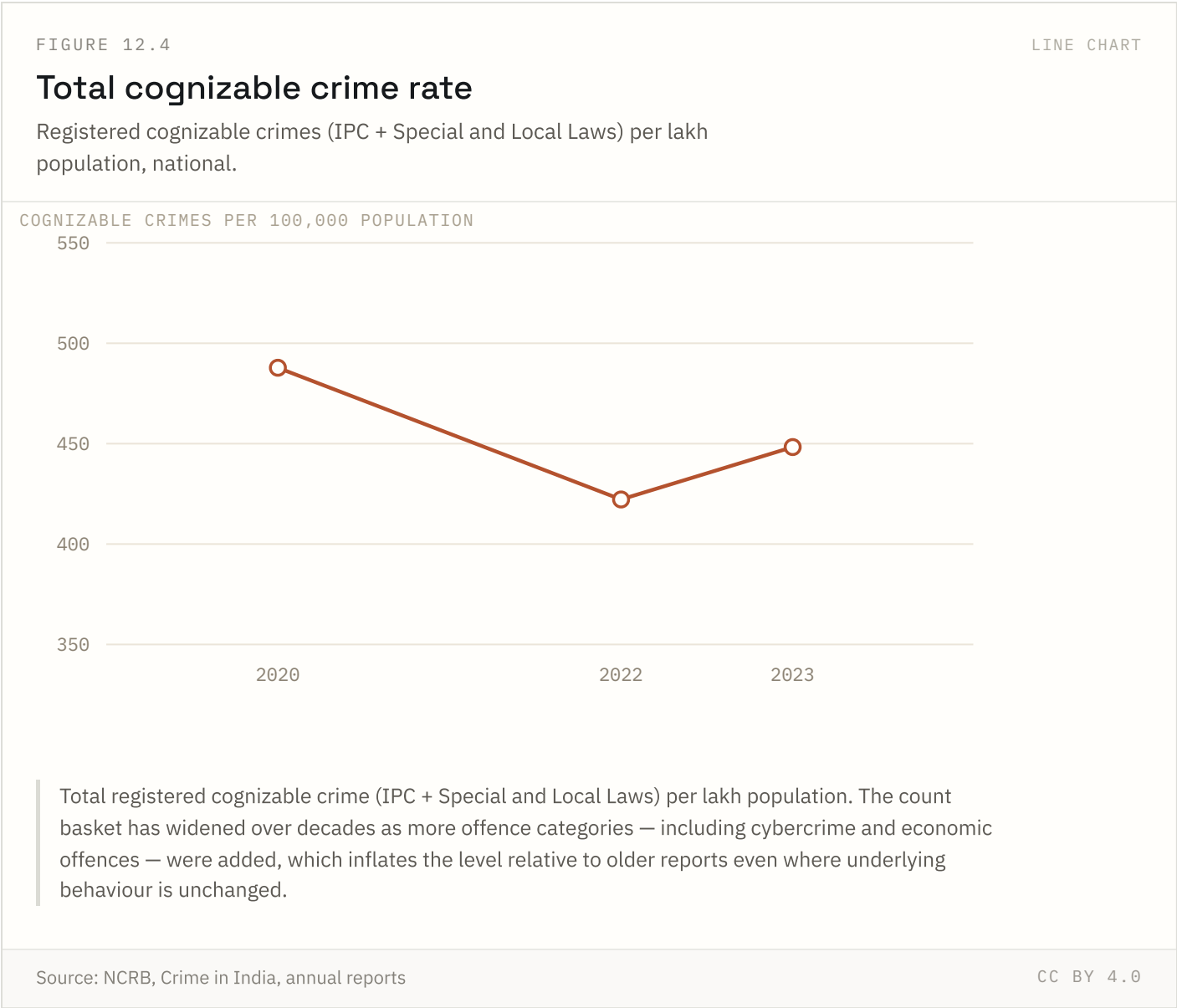
The composite score rose from 57 at the 2018 baseline to 71 in 2023–24. That is real progress, but a score of 100 would mean every 2030 target has already been met — India is roughly seventy per cent of the way there on the index’s own scale.

Source: NITI Aayog SDG India Index, four editions Coverage: 2018 to 2023–24 Updated: 17 Aug 2026

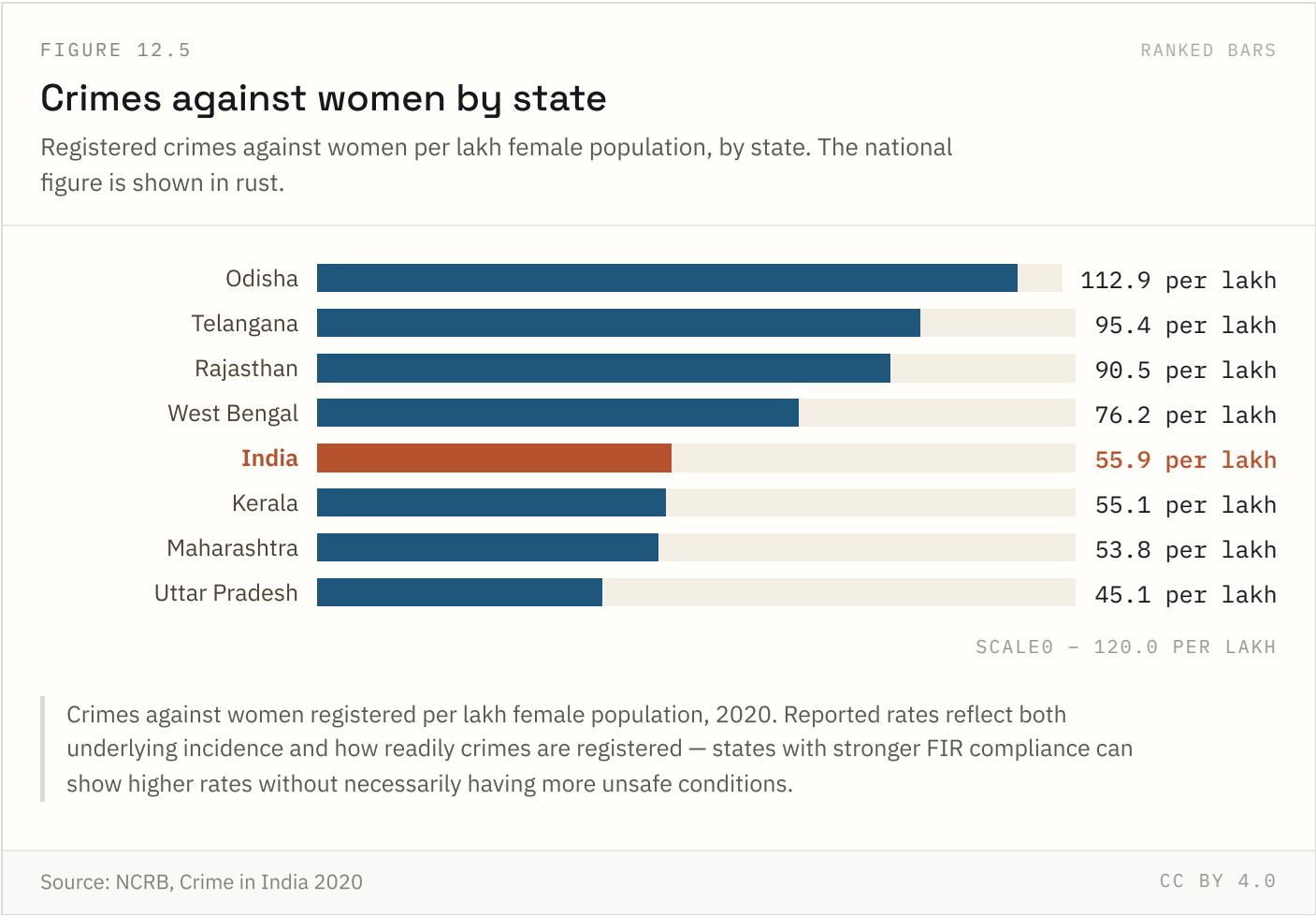


Climate Action (Goal 13) posted the largest gain of any goal since 2020–21, 54 to 67, followed by No Poverty (Goal 1), 60 to 72. Reduced Inequalities (Goal 10) was the only goal to fall, 67 to 65. Gender Equality (Goal 5) remains the lowest-scoring goal nationally, below 50.

Source: NITI Aayog SDG India Index 2023–24 Coverage: 2023–24 Updated: 17 Aug 2026



The offence basket has widened over decades — cybercrime and several economic-offence categories were added in recent editions — which raises the measured rate independent of any change in underlying behaviour. Compare same-basket years, not distant ones.

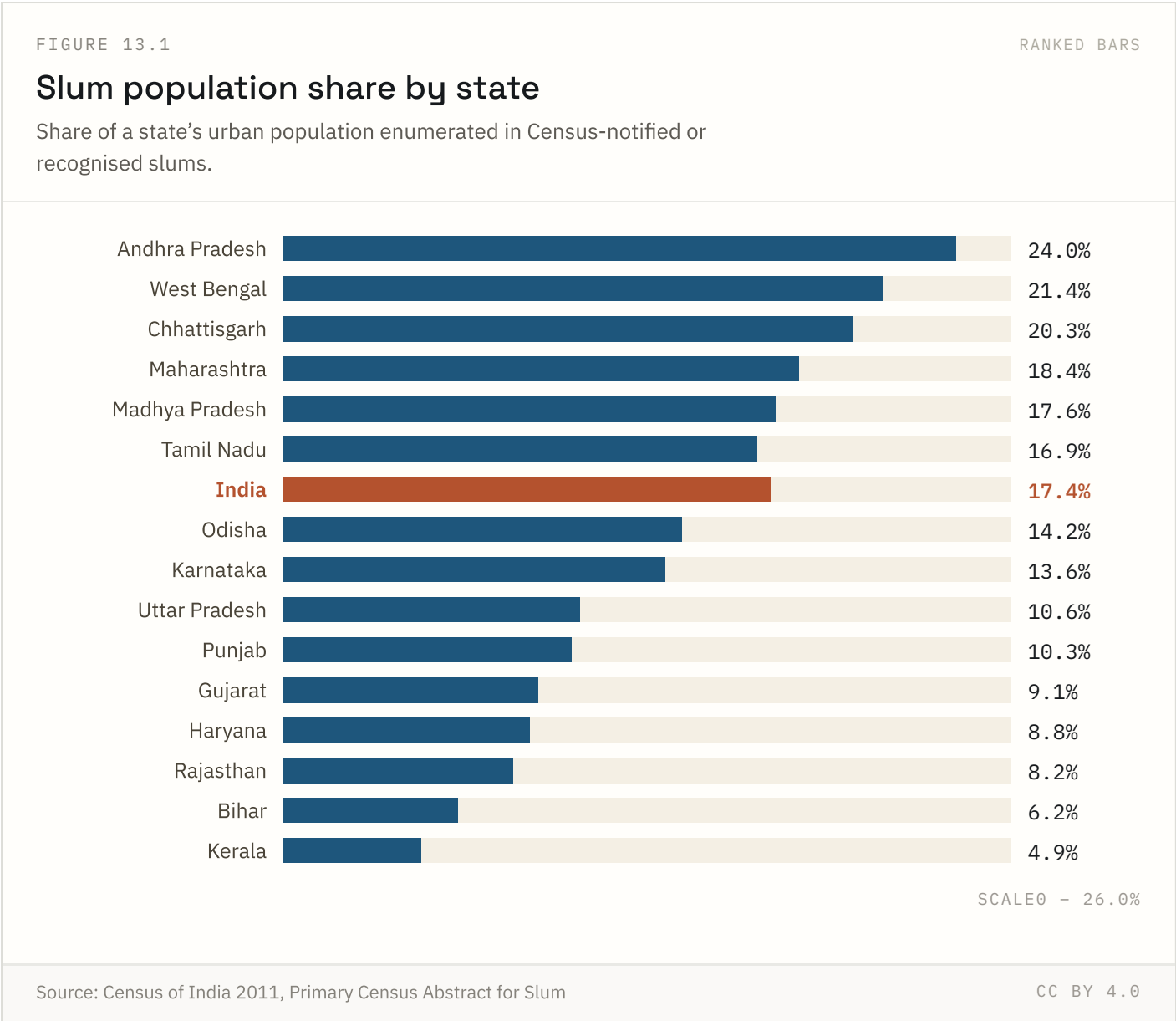


A higher reported rate reflects both underlying incidence and how completely a state registers FIRs — stronger compliance with mandatory registration can itself raise the measured rate. Read alongside conviction and chargesheeting rates before ranking states as more or less safe.

Highest: **Odisha** at 112.9 per lakh. Lowest: **Uttar Pradesh** at 45.1 per lakh.

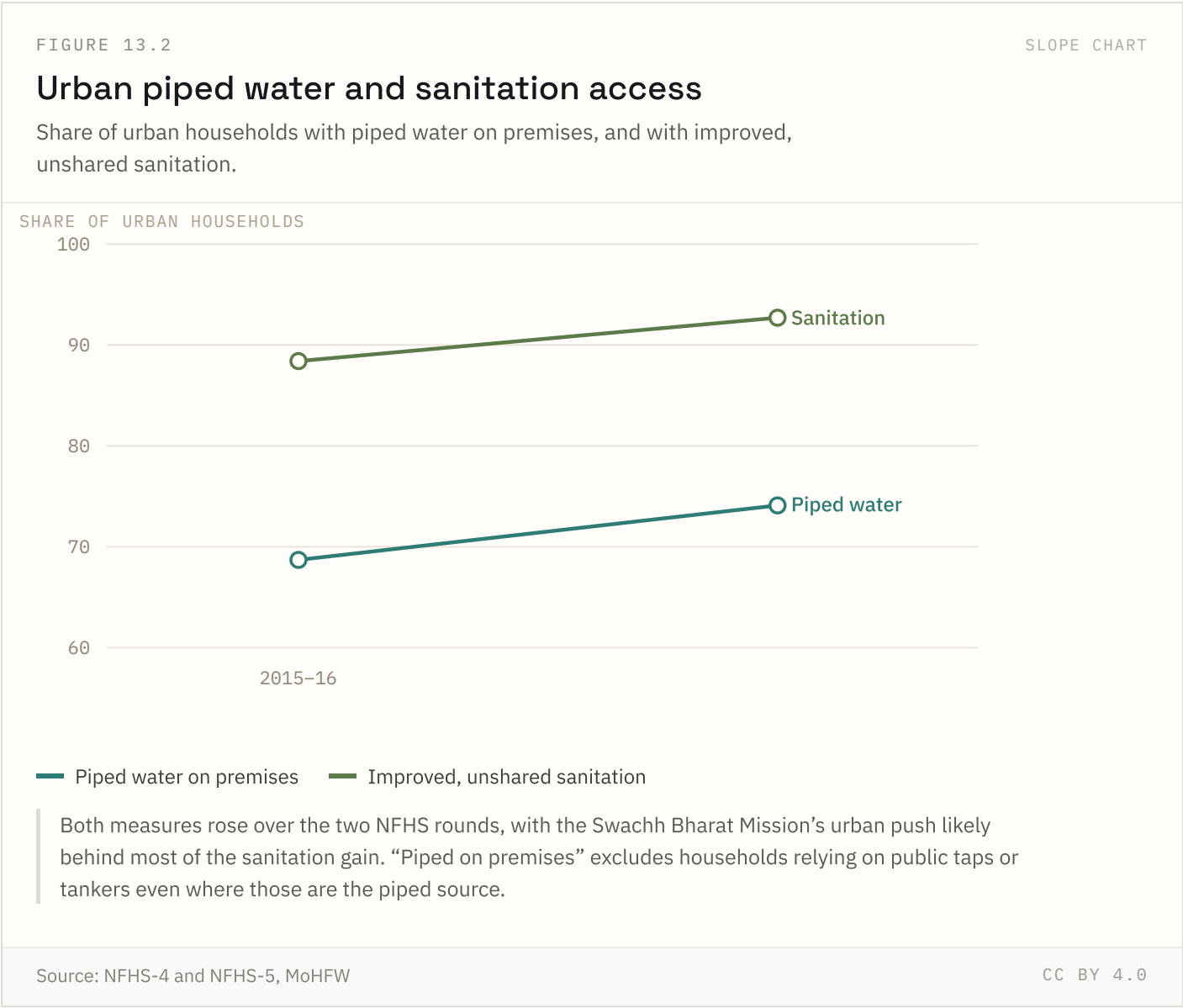
Urban development & housing

1 of 7 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

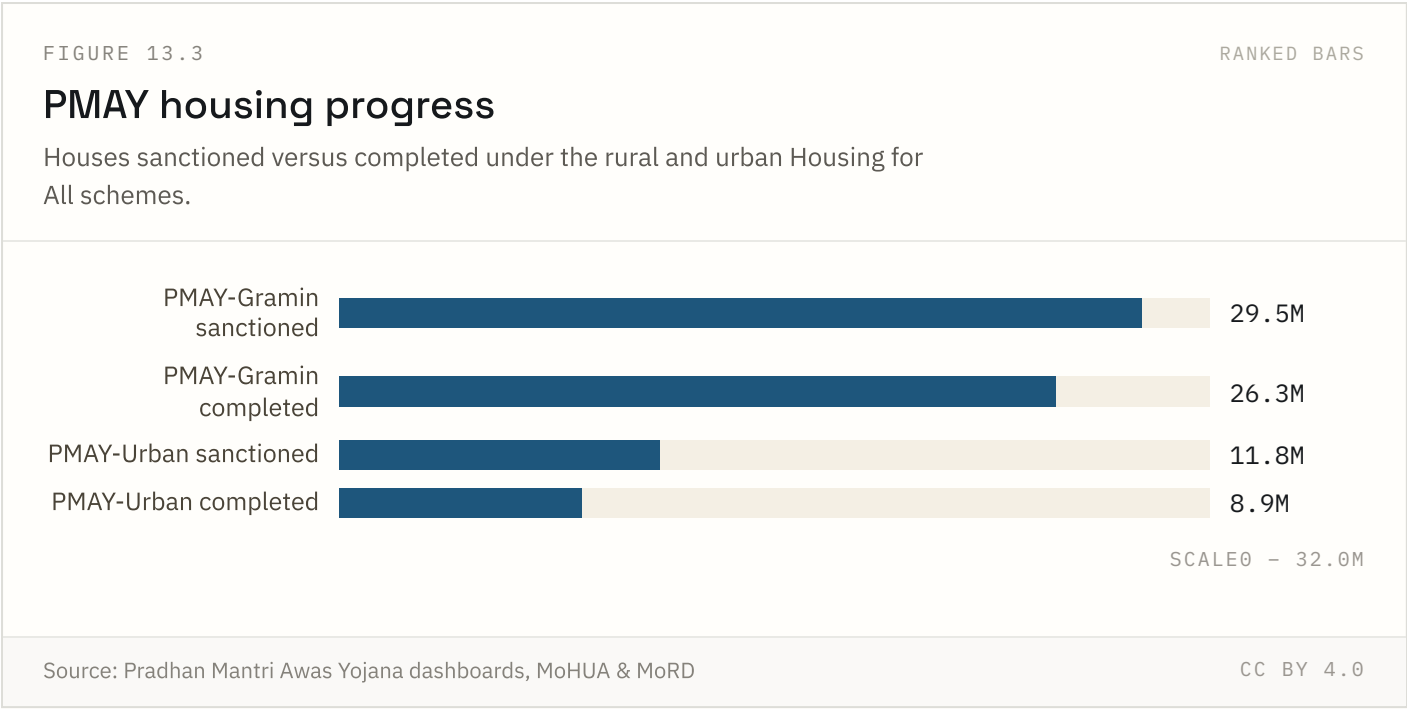


This is the last Census-based slum count available — no Census has been held since 2011, so growth in informal settlements over the past decade is not captured here. Definitions vary by state (notified, recognised and identified slums), which limits strict comparability.

Highest: **Andhra Pradesh** at 24.0%. Lowest: **Kerala** at 4.9%.



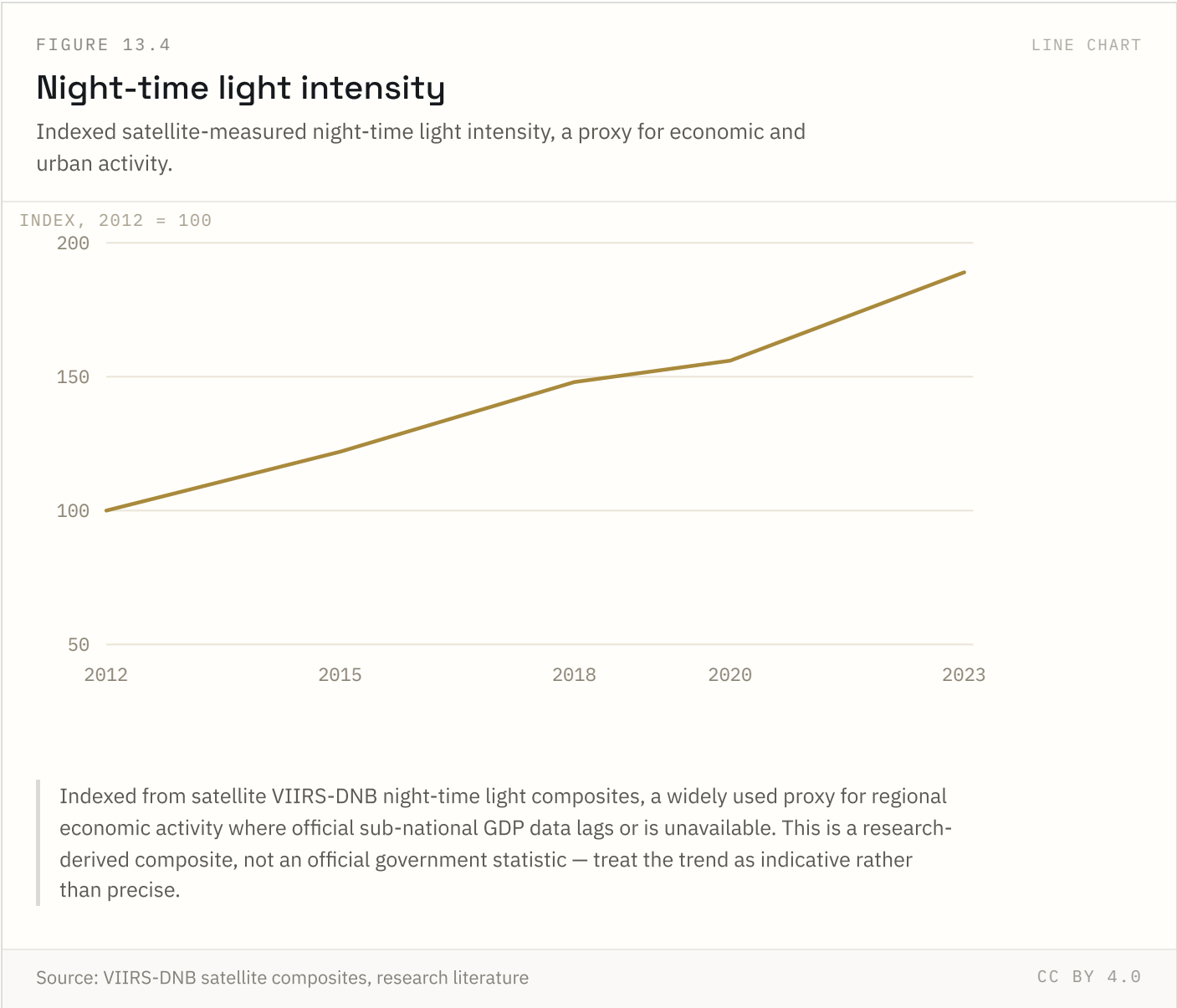
Both series improved between NFHS rounds. “Piped on premises” is stricter than “access to an improved water source” — it excludes households that rely on public taps, tankers or neighbours’ connections even if the underlying source is piped.



The rural scheme (PMAY-Gramin) is closer to its sanctioned target than the urban scheme (PMAY-Urban), where land acquisition and construction timelines run longer. “Completed” means handed over to the beneficiary, not merely under construction.

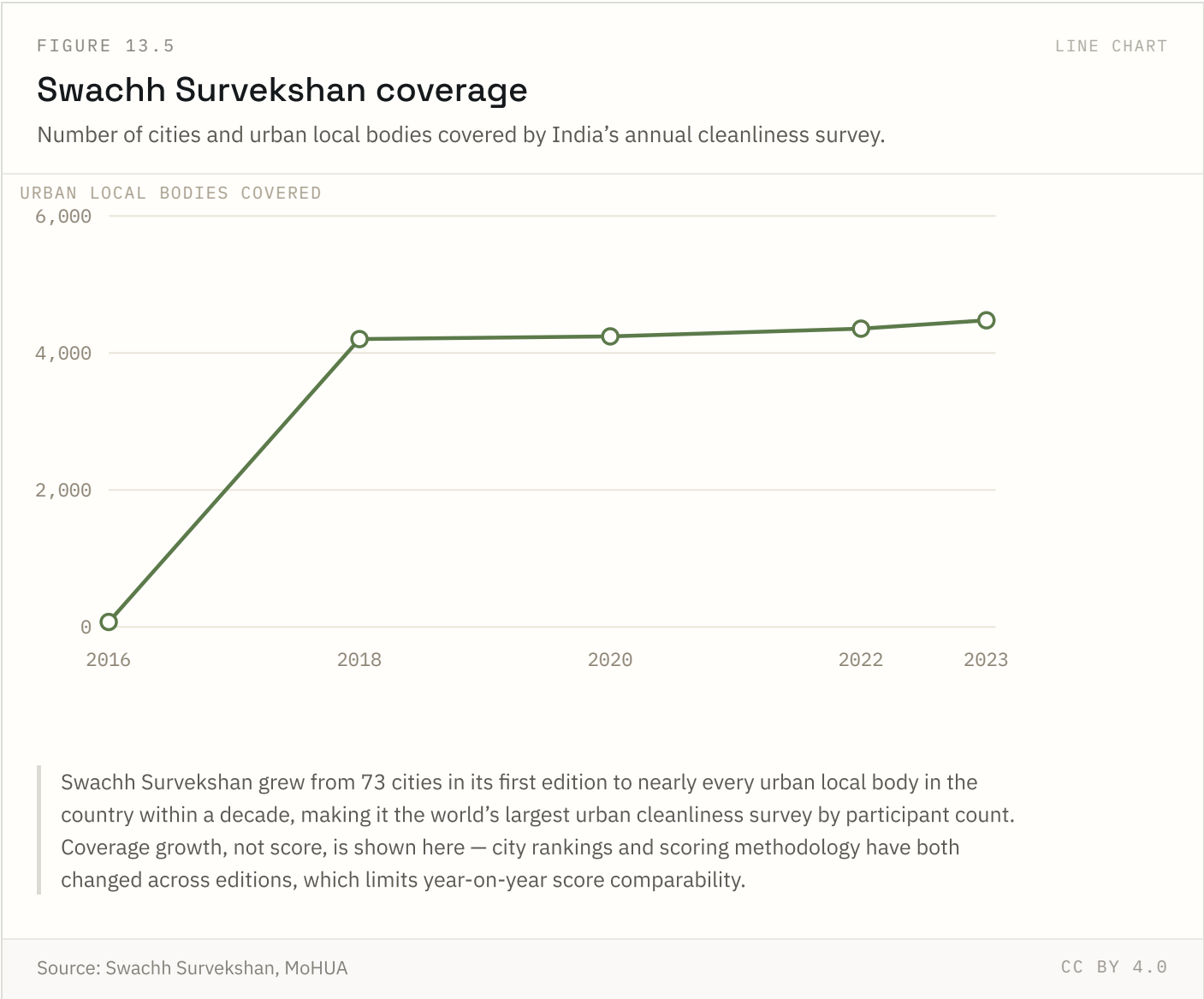
Source: Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana dashboards, MoHUA & MoRD Coverage: Cumulative to 2025 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 13.4 NATIONAL ONLY

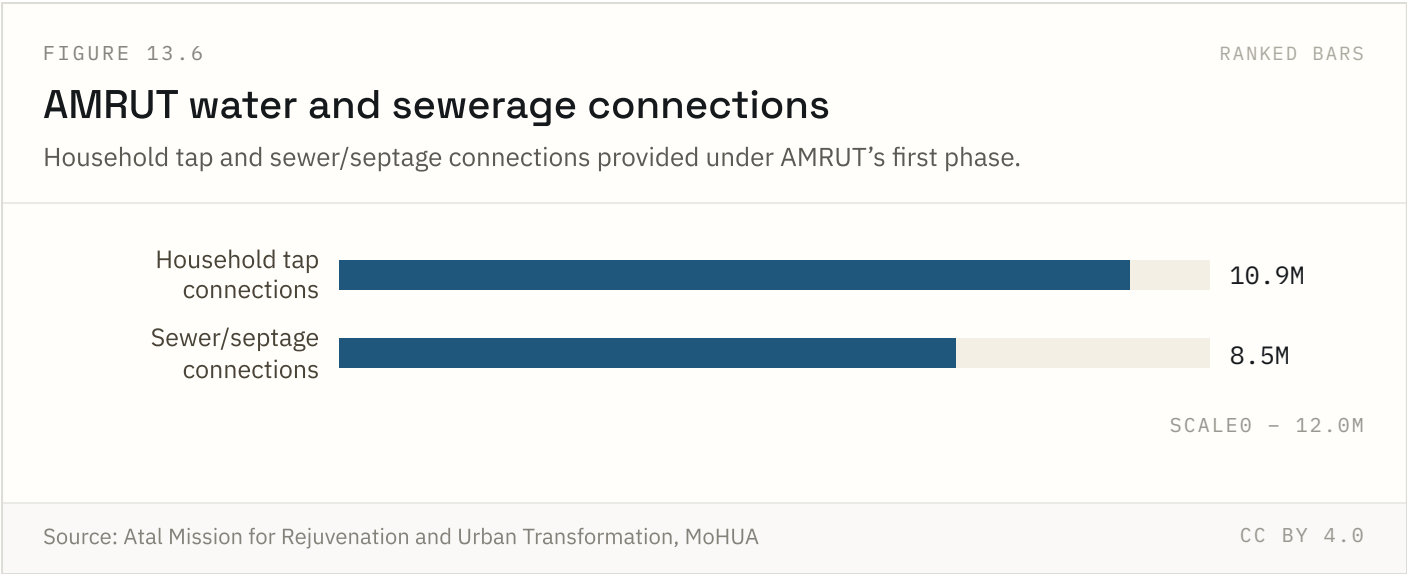


Night-time lights are used by researchers as a fast, sub-national proxy for economic growth where official data is thin or delayed. It captures electrified activity, not output directly, so it can overstate growth in areas that simply gained grid access rather than economic output.

FIGURE 13.5 NATIONAL ONLY



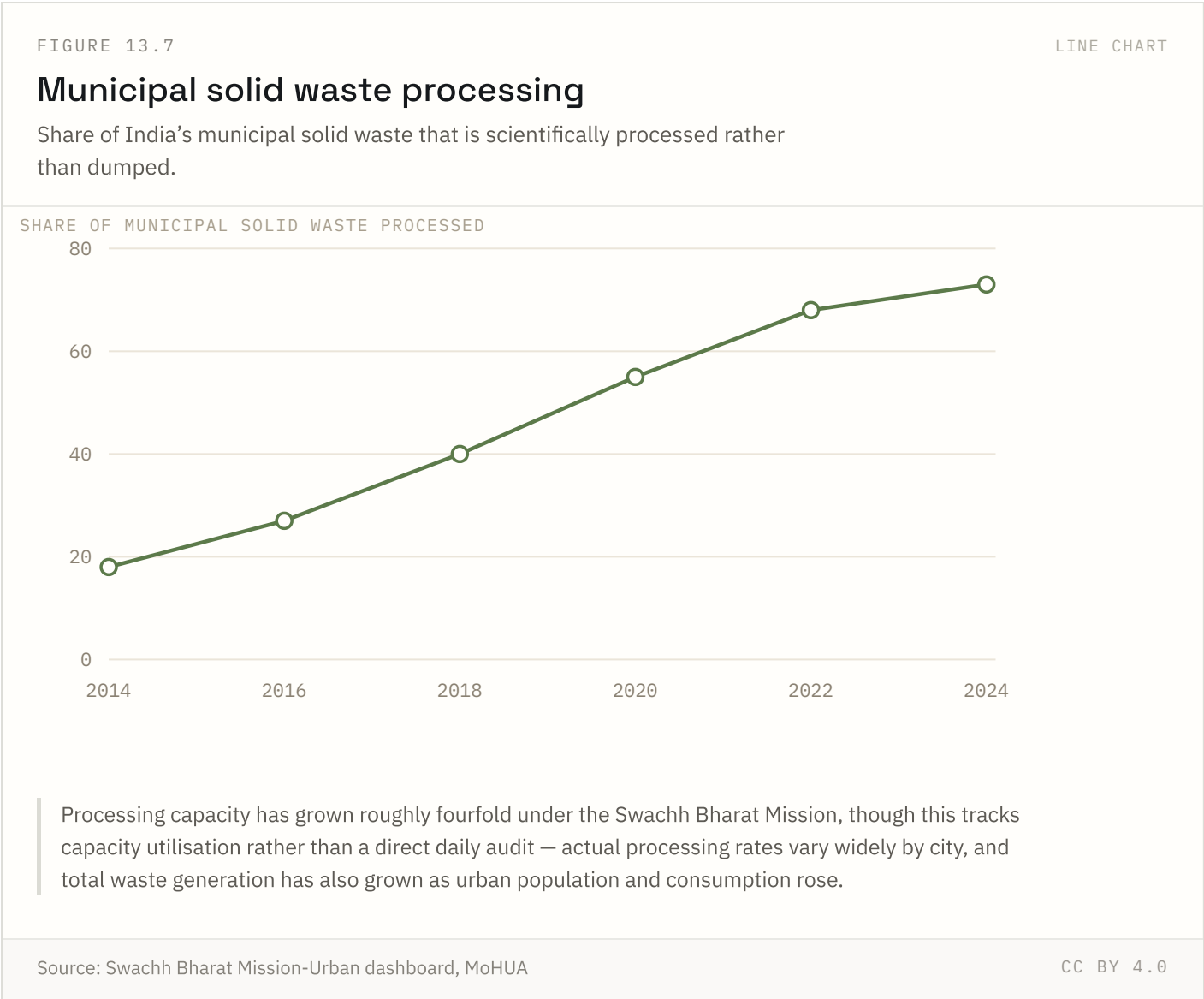
The survey has become close to universal across urban India, which is itself a policy achievement independent of any city’s score. Scoring methodology and weightings have changed across editions, so a city’s rank in different years is not a clean apples-to-apples comparison.



AMRUT 1.0 fell short of its full connection targets by its 2021 close; AMRUT 2.0 (launched 2021) aims at universal coverage. Sewerage lagged water supply throughout the scheme, reflecting the higher cost and longer build time of underground network projects.

Source: Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation, MoHUA Coverage: 2015–2021 (AMRUT 1.0)

Updated: 18 Aug 2026

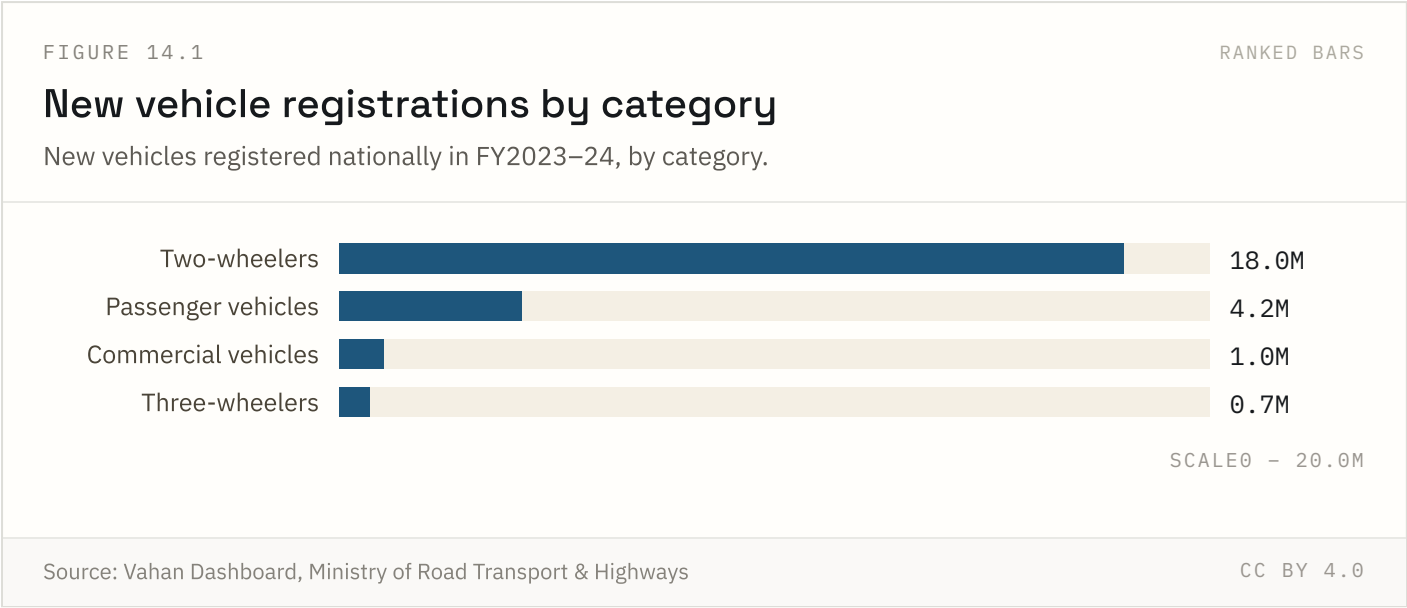


Processing capacity has grown roughly fourfold since 2014, but total waste generation has also risen with urban population and consumption growth — a rising processed share does not necessarily mean a falling absolute quantity dumped in landfills.

Transport & mobility

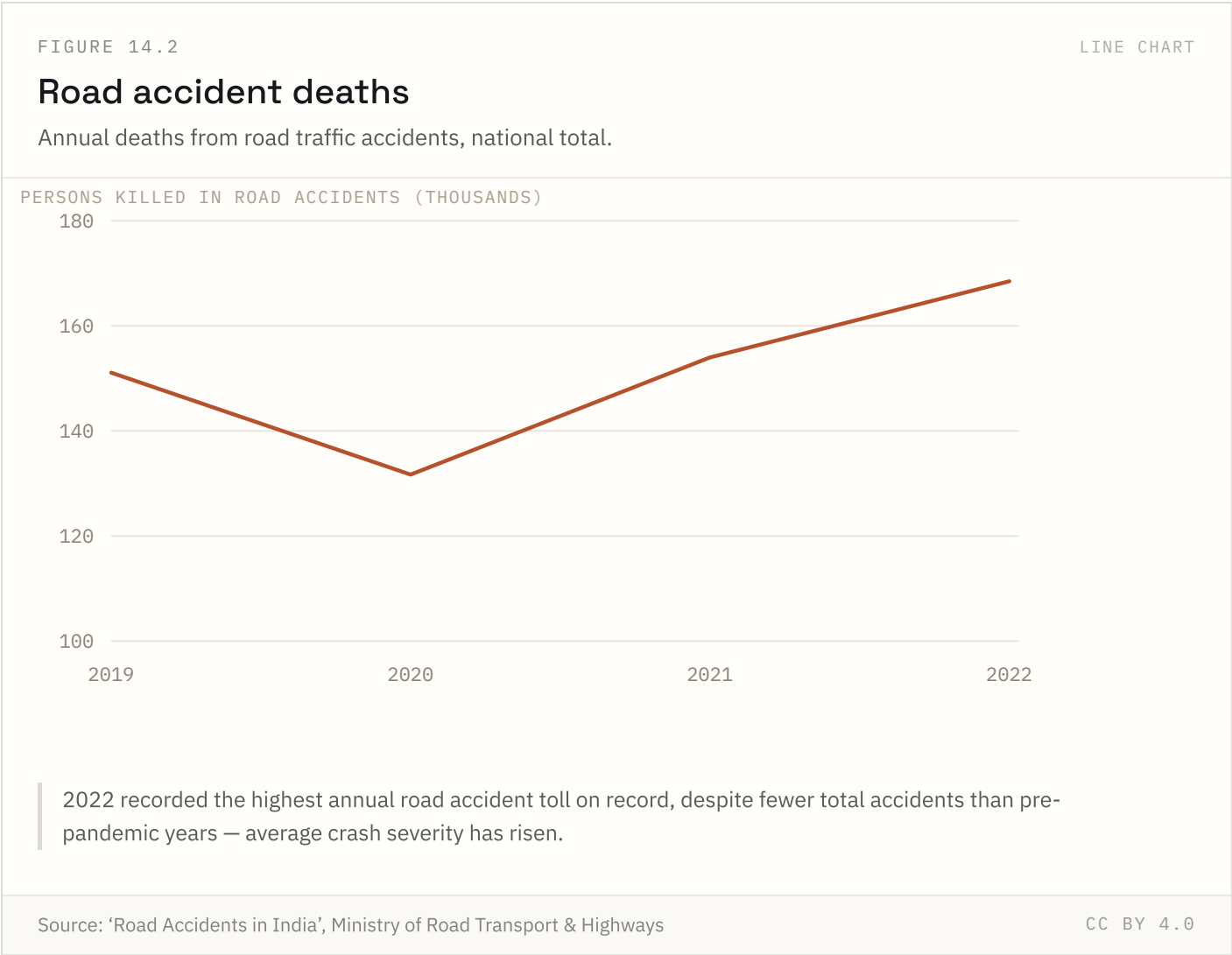
All 4 indicators in this chapter are published at national level only. No state breakdown is available from the sources used.

FIGURE 14.1 NATIONAL ONLY



Two-wheelers dominate India’s vehicle fleet by a wide margin — more than four times passenger vehicle registrations. Vahan records registrations, not sales, so figures can lag manufacturer-reported sales by weeks.

FIGURE 14.2 NATIONAL ONLY

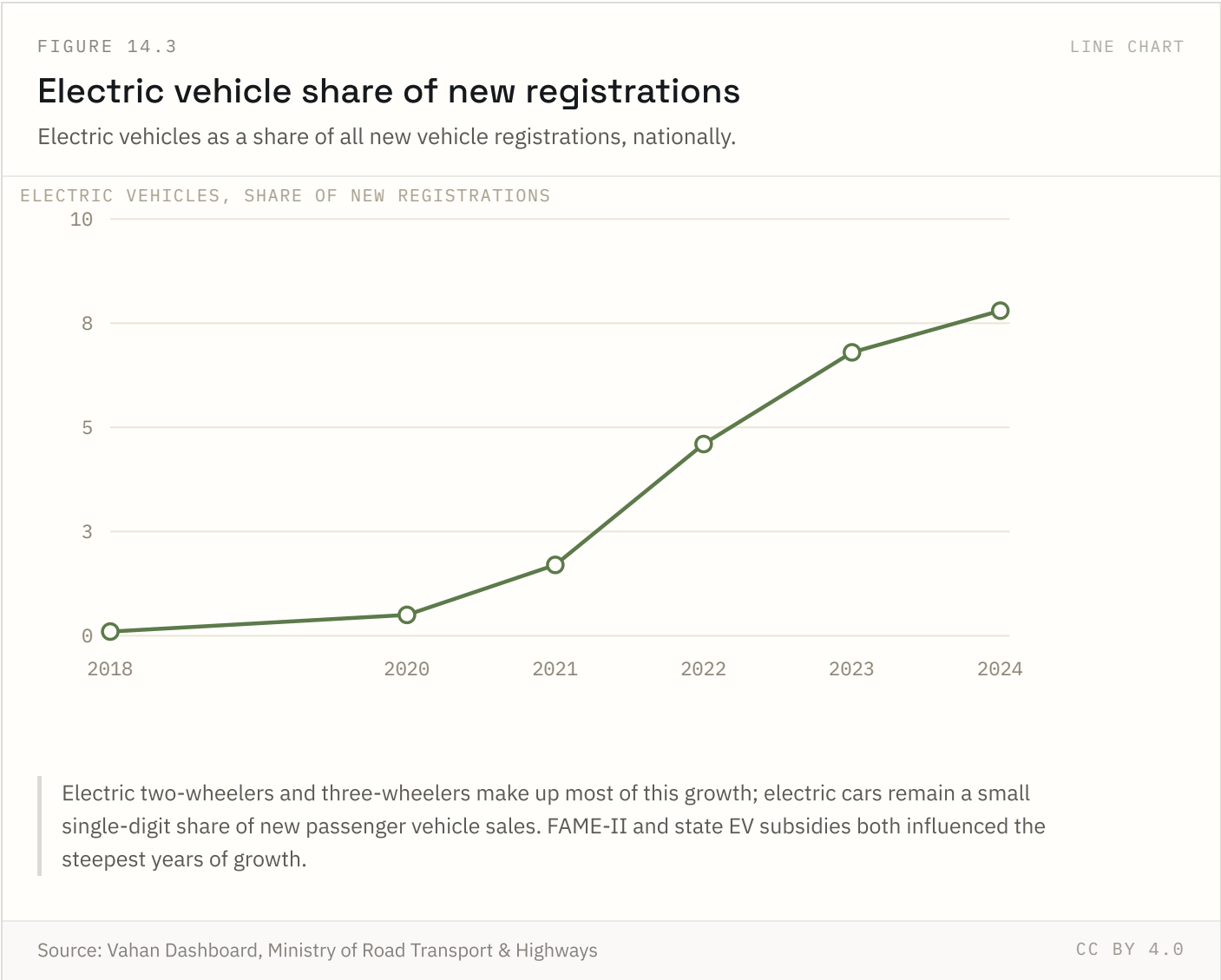


2022 was the deadliest year on record even though reported accident counts were below 2019 levels — severity per crash has risen, partly reflecting more high-speed corridors. State reporting definitions vary, which limits comparability across states more than across years nationally.

Source: 'Road Accidents in India', Ministry of Road Transport & Highways Coverage: 2019–2022

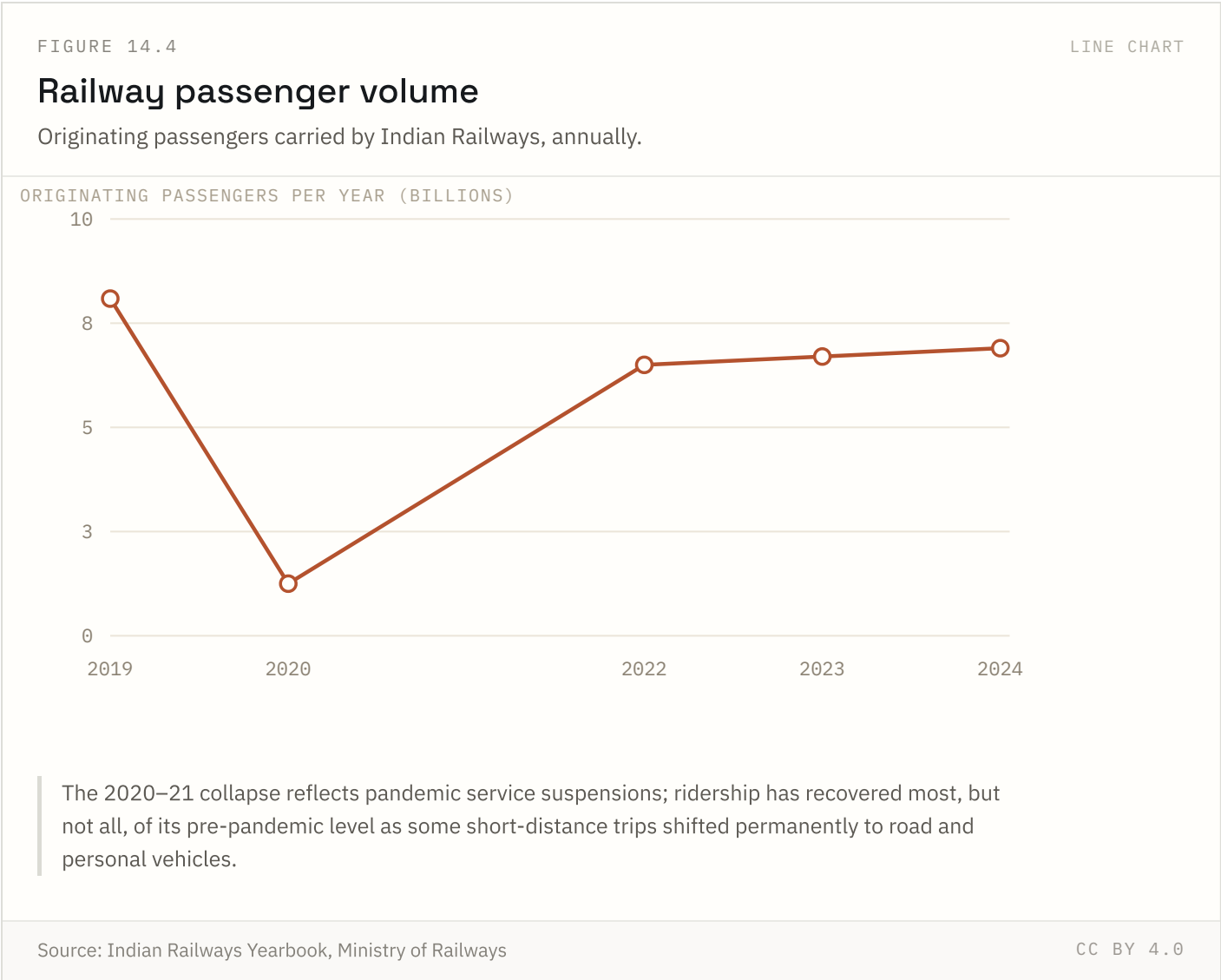
Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 14.3 NATIONAL ONLY



Electric two- and three-wheelers drive nearly all of this growth; electric passenger cars remain a small single-digit share of new car sales. Growth accelerated sharply after FAME-II and state-level EV subsidies took effect.

FIGURE 14.4 NATIONAL ONLY

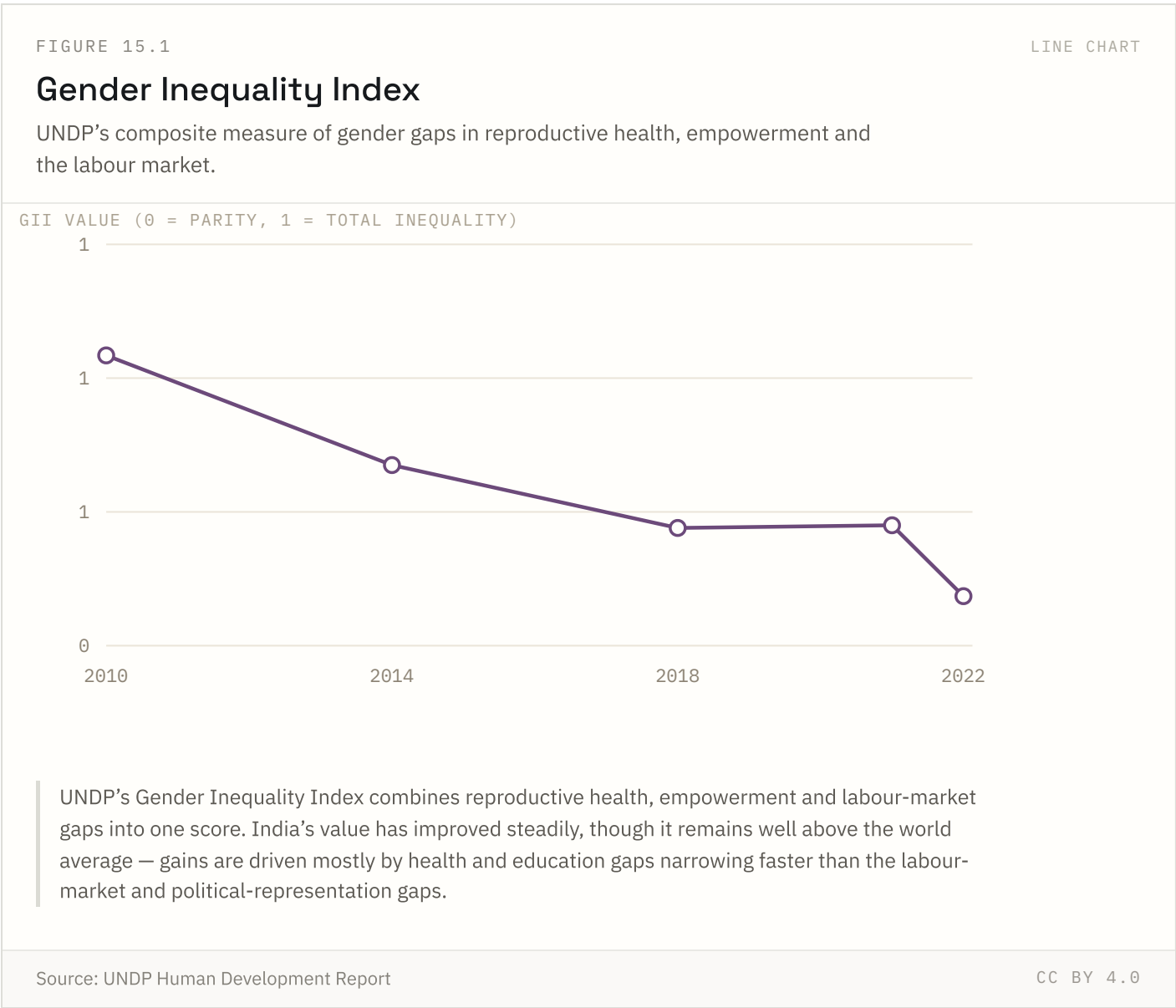


The 2020–21 collapse reflects pandemic service suspensions. Ridership has recovered most, though not all, of its pre-pandemic level — some short-distance trips appear to have shifted permanently to road and personal vehicles.

Human development & wellbeing

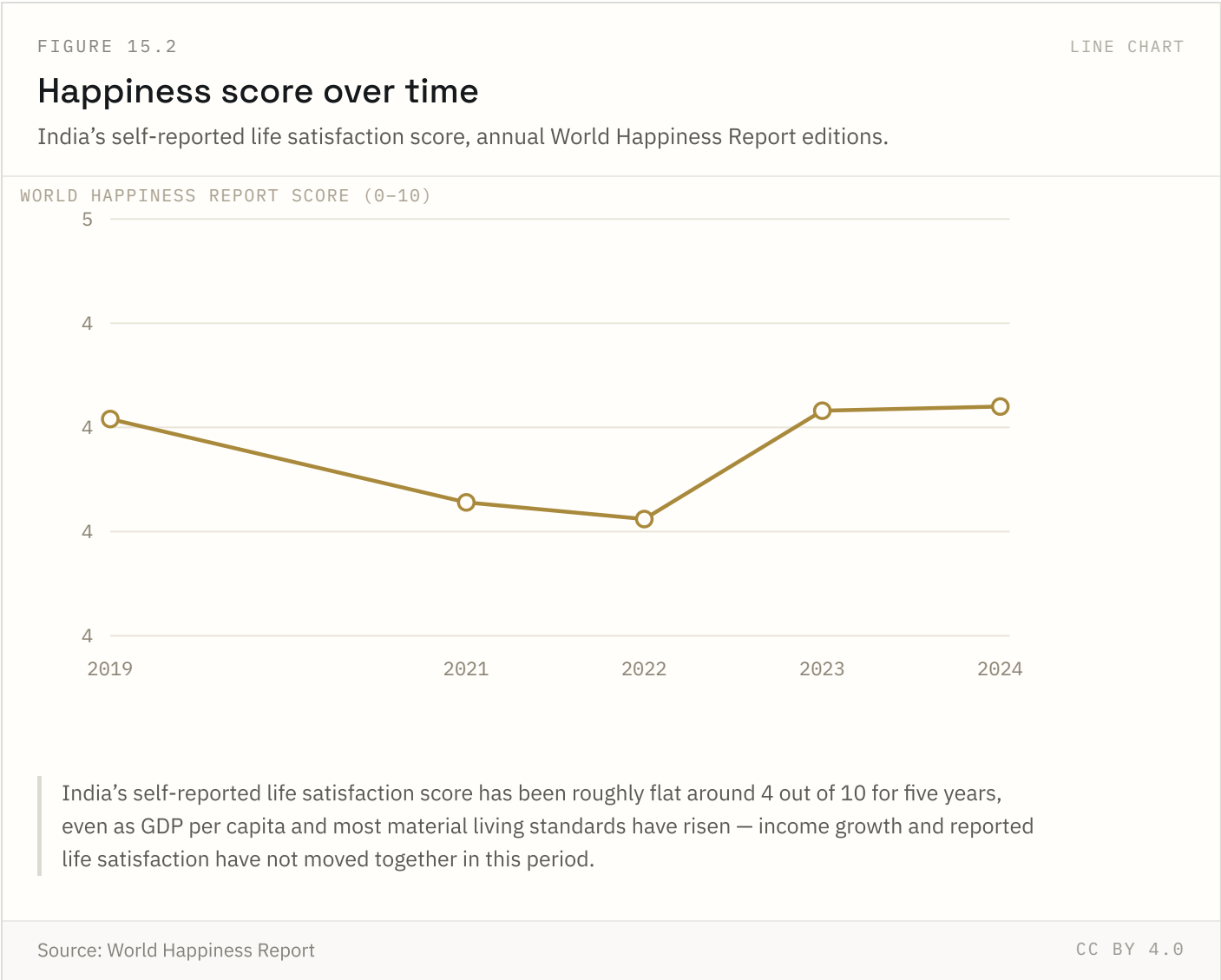
All 4 indicators in this chapter are published at national level only. No state breakdown is available from the sources used.

FIGURE 15.1 NATIONAL ONLY



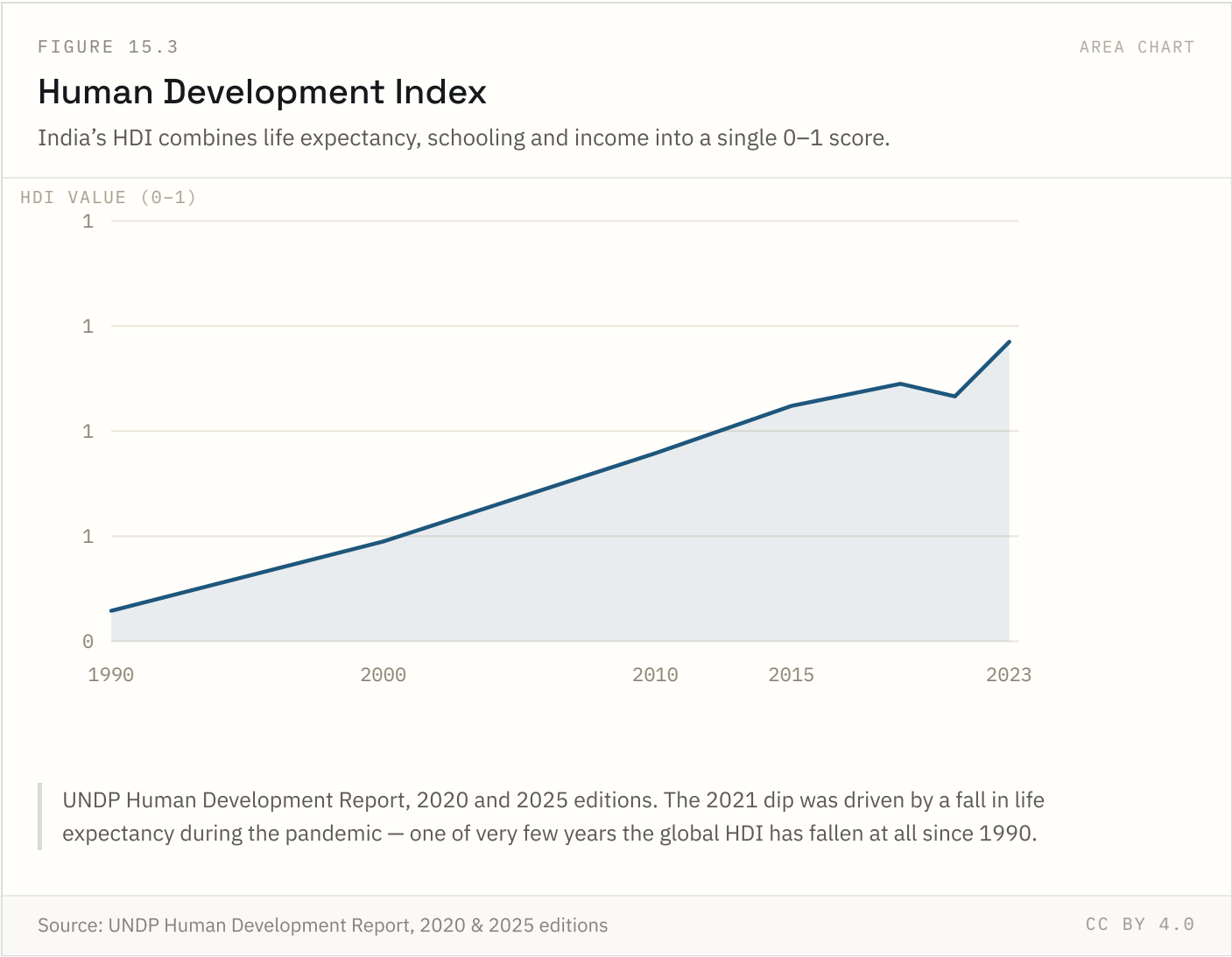
India's GII has improved steadily, mostly on faster progress in health and education than in labour-market participation and political representation — the index blends these into one score, so it can mask which underlying gap is moving and which is stuck.

FIGURE 15.2 NATIONAL ONLY

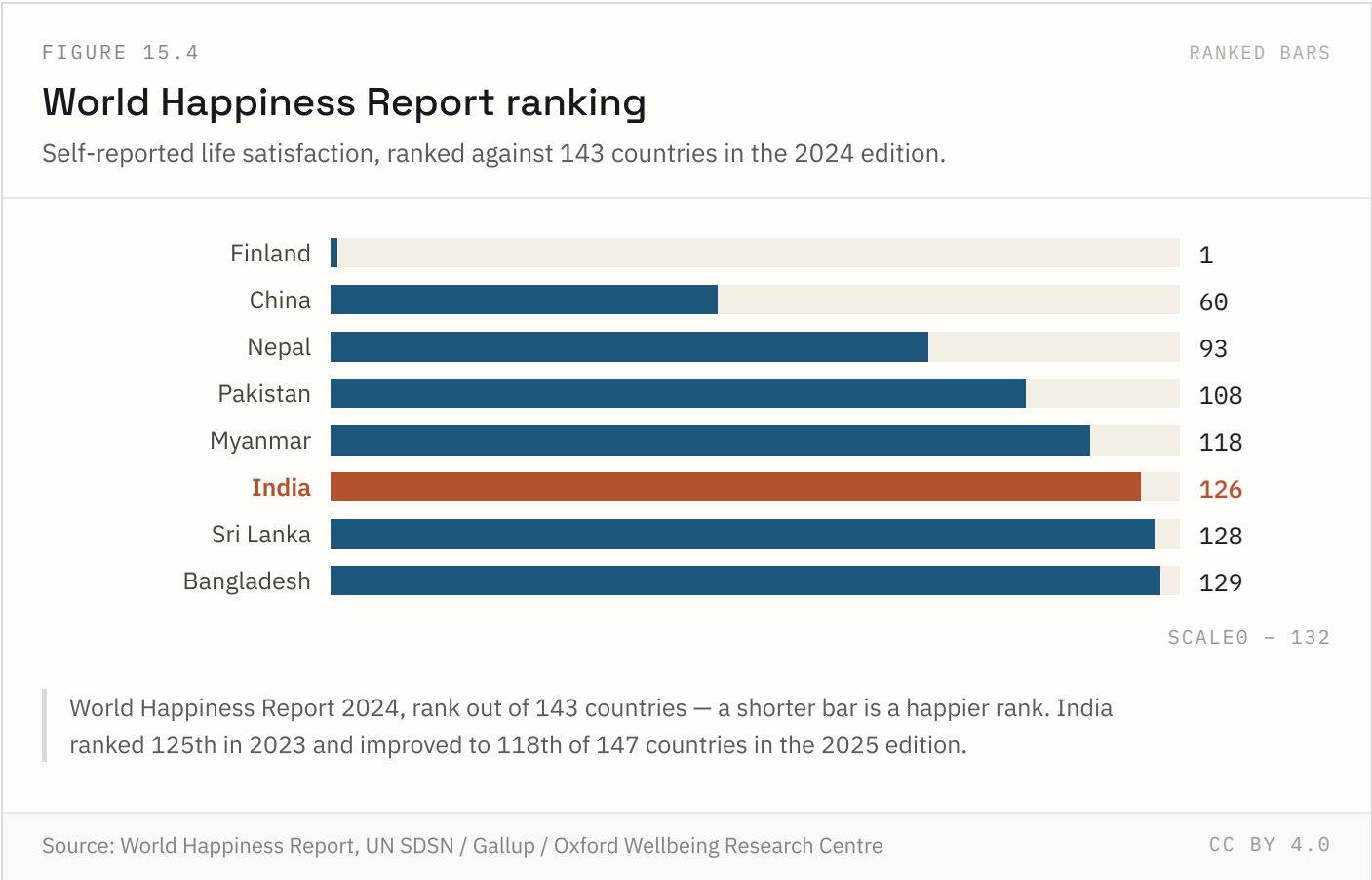


The score has stayed close to 4 out of 10 for five years even as GDP per capita and most material indicators in this dataset have risen — a reminder that self-reported wellbeing and income growth do not move in lockstep.

FIGURE 15.3 NATIONAL ONLY



India's HDI rose from 0.429 in 1990 to 0.645 in 2019, then fell for two straight years as life expectancy dropped during the pandemic — one of very few declines the global HDI has recorded since 1990. It recovered to 0.685 in 2023, ranking India 130th of 193 countries, still in the medium human-development band, just below the 0.700 threshold for 'high'.



India ranked 126th of 143 countries in 2024, behind China by 66 places and behind every neighbour shown except Bangladesh and Sri Lanka. The ranking is built from self-reported life satisfaction (the Cantril ladder) alongside GDP per capita, social support, healthy life expectancy, freedom, generosity and corruption perception — it measures reported wellbeing, not an objective standard of living. India improved to 118th of 147 countries in the 2025 edition.

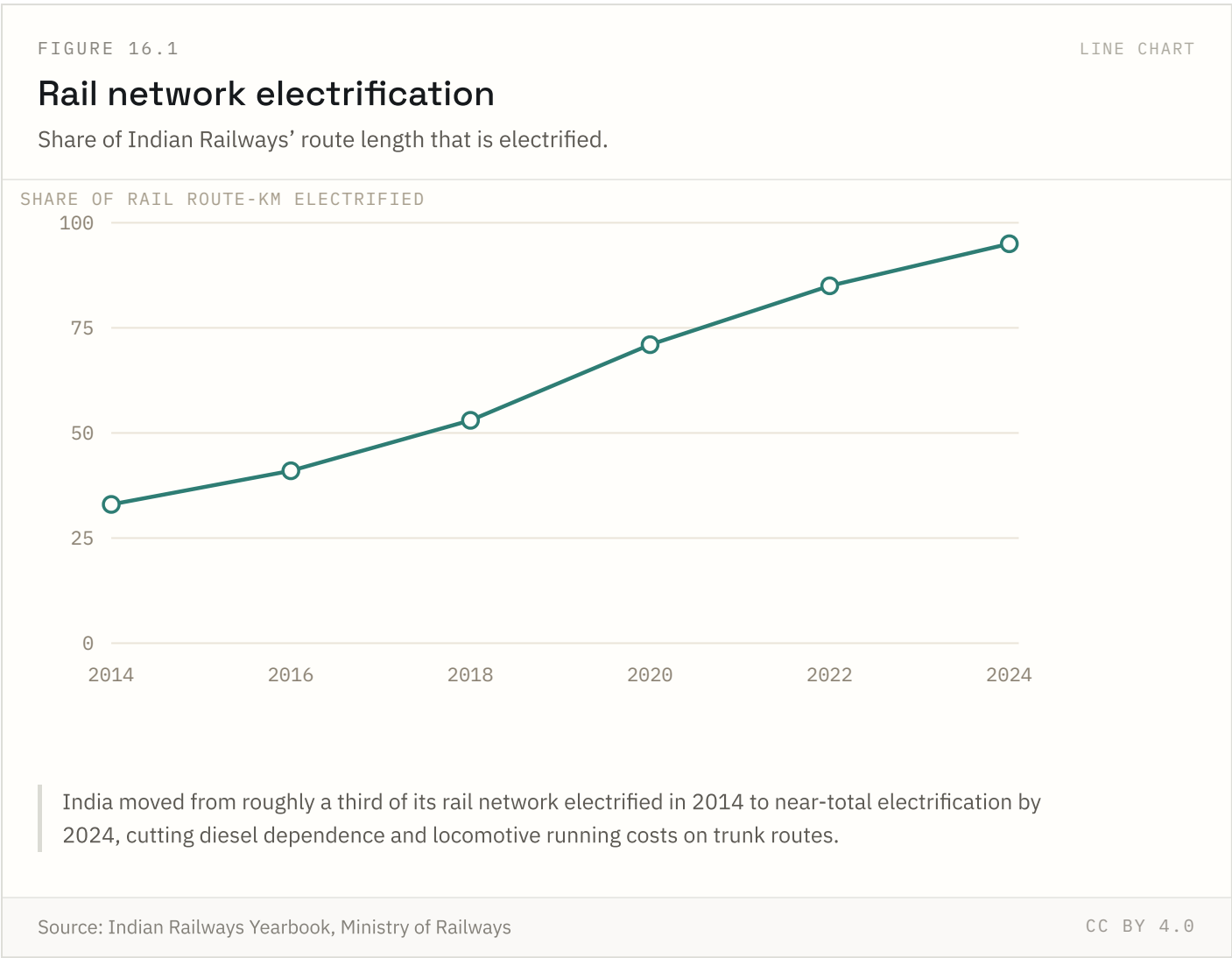
Source: World Happiness Report, UN SDSN / Gallup / Oxford Wellbeing Research Centre Coverage: 2024

Updated: 17 Aug 2026

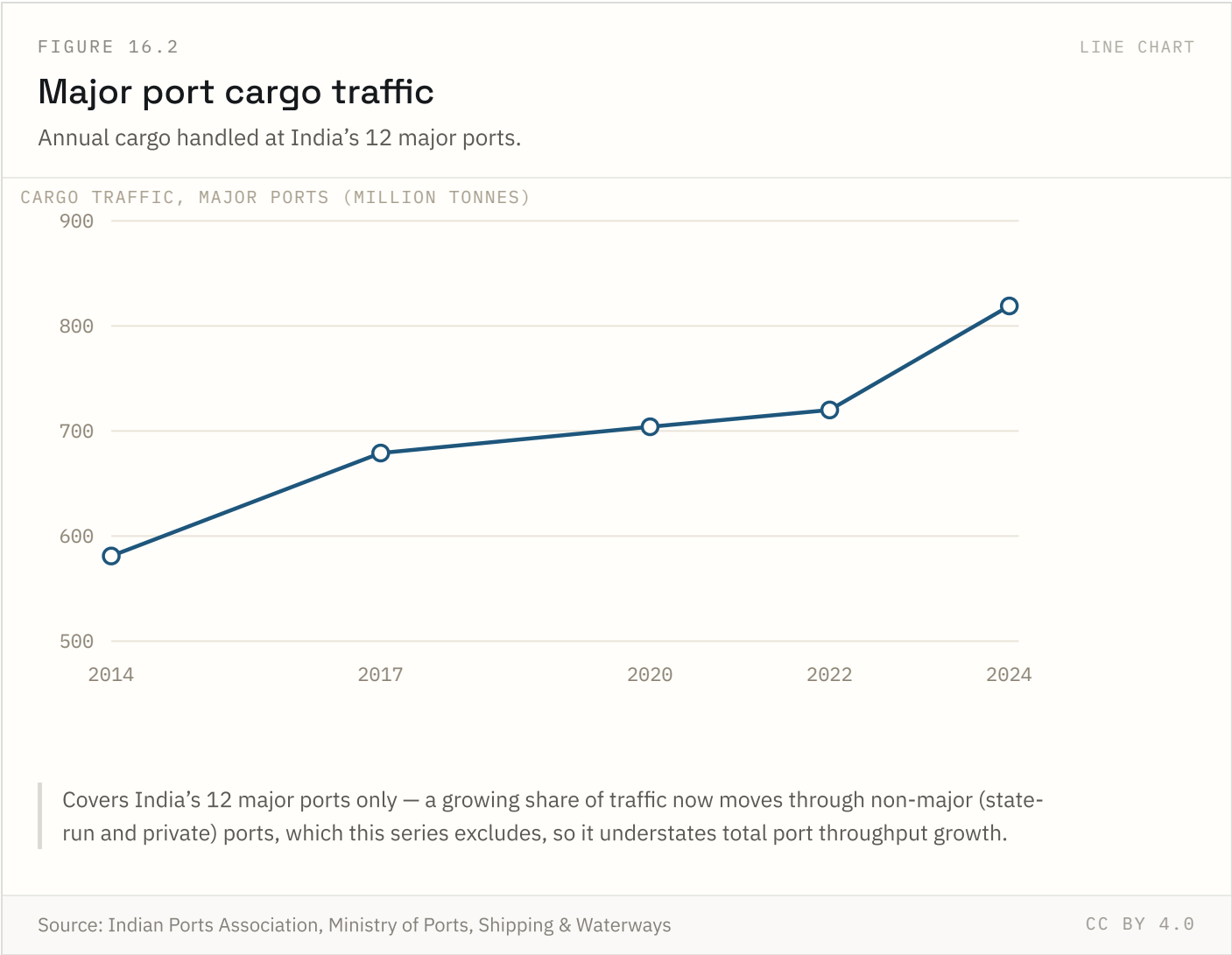
Infrastructure & connectivity

All 3 indicators in this chapter are published at national level only. No state breakdown is available from the sources used.

FIGURE 16.1 NATIONAL ONLY



India went from roughly a third electrified in 2014 to near-total electrification a decade later, one of the fastest rail electrification programmes of its scale worldwide, cutting diesel costs and emissions on trunk routes.

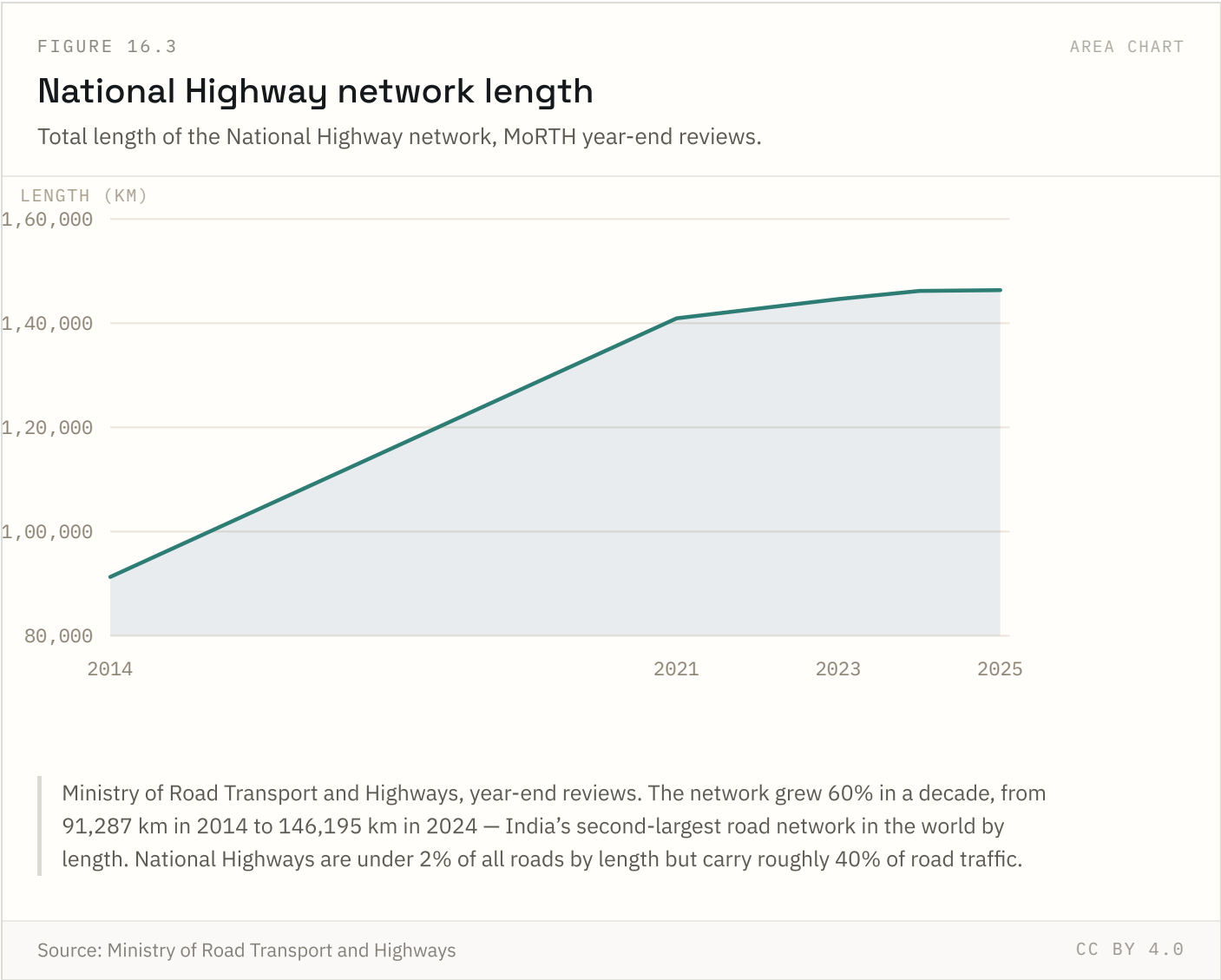


Covers only the 12 centrally administered major ports; a growing share of India's port traffic now moves through state and private non-major ports, which are not included here, so total throughput growth is understated.

Source: Indian Ports Association, Ministry of Ports, Shipping & Waterways Coverage: 2014–2024

Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 16.3 NATIONAL ONLY



The network grew 60% in a decade, from 91,287 km in 2014 to 146,195 km in 2024, making it the world’s second-largest by length. National Highways are under 2% of India’s total road length but carry an estimated 40% of road traffic — length alone understates their economic weight.

Source: Ministry of Road Transport and Highways Coverage: 2014–2025 Updated: 17 Aug 2026

Methodology and limitations

Every figure in this report is reproduced from a published source without adjustment. India Insight Lab does not estimate, model or interpolate the values shown. Each chart carries the source it came from, the years it covers and the date the series was last updated.

Three limitations apply to everything above, and are stated rather than worked around:

- **Geographic depth.** Indicators reach national and, for 27 of 88 series, state level. District and city figures are not included because comparable data is not yet integrated.
- **Comparability across sources.** Series drawn from different sources use different definitions, reference periods and sampling designs. They are shown side by side but are not adjusted onto a common basis.
- **Currency.** Update dates vary by series; the most recent revision date is shown beneath each figure. Some official series lag by several years.

Nothing in this report is projected. Where a series ends, the report ends with it. No forecast, scenario or extrapolation has been added to extend a trend beyond its published data.

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11	Census of India; UN World Urbanization Prospects
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Source URLs, licence terms and retrieval dates are not yet recorded for every series. Adding them is scheduled work, and until it is done these references name the publication rather than link to it.